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Democracy Dies in Darkness

TUESDAY, AUGUST 25, 2026 • \$4

Trade war vs. Trump is Carney's biggest test

Canada's PM is making an open show of defiance in the battle over tariffs

BY ELLEN FRANCIS

Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney has presented himself as the voice of the world's middle powers against the bullying of President Donald Trump. In a new era of great power rivalry, he told global leaders in Davos, Switzerland, this year, that defending national sovereignty would require "the ability to withstand pressure."

Now Trump is putting the Carney doctrine to its biggest test yet. As trade negotiations between Washington and Ottawa collapsed, his administration announced 50 percent tariffs on \$20 billion worth of Canadian goods from hockey sticks to whisky.

Carney responded with a pledge: Canada will match the levies "dollar for dollar."

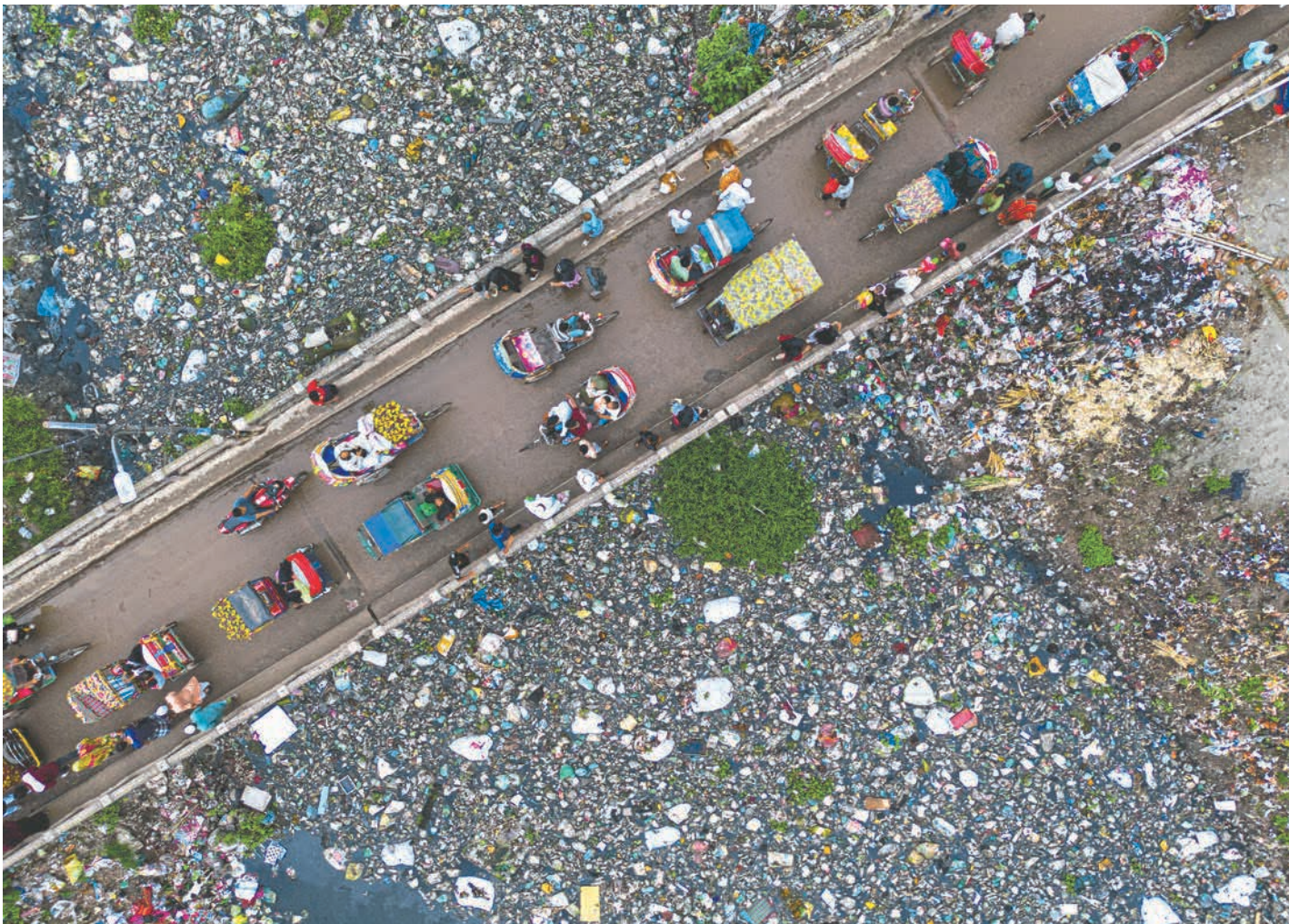
"You're at war when you're attacked, and we got attacked," he told Canadians on Saturday. "We're going to hit back."

The leaders of other close U.S. partners, including Britain and the European Union, have rushed in the face of Trump's tariff threats to cut deals. Carney, in contrast, is making a rare show of open defiance as the president deals with multiple challenges: rising consumer prices, a stalemated war against Iran and fast-approaching midterm elections in which Republicans are expected to take a drubbing.

"Carney is signaling to Washington that the old assumption that Canada is a country that will accommodate, that we will go along to get along, it is no longer true," said Fen Hampson, a professor of international affairs at Carleton University in Ottawa. Administration officials, he said, "mistake good manners for meekness. You know, because Carney's very polite and professional, they thought that he would be a pushover."

In his latest remarks, Hamp-

SEE CANADA ON A16



BIPUL AHMED/NURPHOTO/GETTY IMAGES

People travel along a road across a branch of the Buriganga River on Aug. 16 in Dhaka, Bangladesh, where plastics and other waste cover the waterway. A memo reviewed by The Washington Post argues any agreement must not undermine supply chains.

U.S. targets plastic production limits

BY CONOR MCGLONE, JAKE SPRING, EMMA BRYCE AND BENARD OGEMBO

The United States has doubled down on its opposition to plastic production limits in global treaty talks, according to a diplomatic memo reviewed by The Washington Post, pushing to create a broad loophole to disregard the treaty on national security grounds.

A year after the Trump administration worked with other major oil-producing nations to block strict plastic pollution limits, leading to a failed U.N. conference in Geneva, environmentalists and other observers argue this same group is helping steer negotiations toward a weaker agreement.

Involving delegates from nearly 180 countries, the talks have reached a critical point after four years. Global plastic pollution has ballooned to more than 57 million tons per year, and a coalition of dozens of countries — including most members of the European Union and many from Africa and Latin America — say this waste will become overwhelming

Leaked memo shows administration's aims as talks on plastics treaty reach critical point

unless the world imposes meaningful restrictions soon.

The leaked document, which a foreign diplomat confirmed was circulated this summer to governments involved in negotiations, calls for a "pragmatic" treaty that includes a provision allowing for countries to take any measures they consider necessary to protect national security.

The memo, which emphasizes the need for waste management and private sector investment, argues any agreement must not undermine national security, critical infrastructure or supply chains. It warns restricting plastics and chemicals could limit access to defense-related products such as weapons materials and protective gear.

The overwhelming majority of plastic is

made from chemicals derived from petroleum or other fossil fuels, and the Trump administration has pushed to expand oil and gas drilling and domestic production. Negotiators under Trump have become far more vocal in opposing binding limits on plastic production, compared with a more conciliatory tone under President Joe Biden.

The negotiating position also reflects a broader administration strategy of citing national security concerns to promote fossil fuels, such as when it declared a national energy emergency last year, blocked the development of wind farms and exempted oil and gas firms from Endangered Species Act requirements in the Gulf of Mexico.

The State Department said in an email that it generally does not comment on "purported" U.S. diplomatic communications.

"The United States seeks to negotiate an agreement that all countries can join and implement as an outcome that will be most effective in reducing plastic pol-

SEE PLASTICS ON A8

Bessent unveils his plan for Iran

SWEEPING NEW SANCTIONS REVEALED

Treasury secretary's goal: 'economic asphyxiation'

BY RILEY BEGGIN, DAVID J. LYNCH AND AOIFE WALSH

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent on Monday unveiled a sweeping campaign of financial sanctions and diplomatic pressure designed to sever Iran's remaining links to the global economy, but he declined to say which countries would be targeted or when new penalties on Iran's trading partners would take effect.

Dubbed "Operation Economic Outcast," the initiative is aimed at closing loopholes in the existing U.S. financial dragnet around Iran and, Bessent said, forcing an "endgame" in the conflict that President Donald Trump launched in February.

Treasury officials said they are adding five sectors of the Iranian economy to their target list: cryptocurrency used by the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps and regime insiders; weapons-related technologies; gold used to stabilize the plummeting Iranian currency; Iran's airlines; and shipping that carries weapons components and oil. They also announced sanctions on 60 entities, individuals and vessels that enable Iran to procure nuclear or missile technology, conduct cyber operations, and sell oil.

Bessent said Trump is contacting other world leaders to demand that they support the United States in seeking the "economic asphyxiation of this regime." He would not identify the leaders contacted or provide a deadline for action. Iran's top trading partners include China, the United Arab Emirates, Turkey and Iraq.

"The United States expects action," Bessent told reporters

SEE IRAN ON A13

Trump wants U.N.'s next boss to be in sync with his plans

U.S. can veto in secretary general race; a woman has never held the title

BY KAREN DEYOUNG

This year, for the first time in its 80-year history, the United Nations may select a woman to serve as its secretary general. Of the eight candidates nominated so far for the position, five are women, and many U.N. members argue that it's finally their turn.

But as the U.N. Security Council undertakes its months-long, ultrasecret selection process, hopefully making its choice before Portugal's António Guterres reaches the end of his five-year term on Dec. 31, other factors are at play beyond gender.

The Trump administration, which has veto power on the council, is working overtime to ensure that the new leadership is in sync with its plans to continue cutting the U.N. budget and workforce. Beyond long-standing funding concerns, it wants

to effect fundamental change across the global body, in particular the way it handles the three "pillars" of its charter — peace and security, development, and human rights — and adherence to international law.

"This institution desperately needs strong, effective leadership," Mike Waltz, the U.S. ambassador to the U.N., told a Senate hearing this spring. U.S. priorities, he said, were "reform, reform, reform ... and getting back to basics on peace and security will be at the top of our criteria."

This summer, high-level officials at the U.S. mission to U.N. headquarters in New York have conducted multiple interviews with six of the candidates — two new ones emerged this month, and there may be further nominations before any final decision.

President Donald Trump has not commented on a report last month by the New York Post that he wants Gianni Infantino, head of the world soccer federation FIFA, to have the job. But "there are tons of rumors about an October surprise," said a longtime

SEE U.N. SECRETARY ON A13

Some Texas conservatives are pledging to vote Democratic

Republicans who are angry at Gov. Greg Abbott's refusal to block data centers are giving his challenger, Gina Hinojosa, hope for an upset



JOEL ANGEL JUAREZ/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Texas Democratic state Rep. James Talarico, who is running for the U.S. Senate, and Democratic candidate for Texas governor Gina Hinojosa greet voters in Killeen on Aug. 14.

BY MOLLY HENNESSY-FISKE

TEMPLE, TEXAS — Twyla Lowry plans to do something this November she could not have imagined doing even a few months ago: She's going to vote for a Democrat.

That would be Gina Hinojosa, running to prevent Republican Greg Abbott from winning a record fourth term as governor. Hinojosa, 52, has a fairly standard platform of Democratic issues — end state school vouchers, and lower health care, grocery and utility costs. She has even promised to send every Texan \$1,500 from the state rainy day fund.

But for Lowry, a retired social worker and special education teacher in this Central Texas city of about 100,000, all that matters is that Hinojosa wants to impose a moratorium on data center projects and Abbott doesn't.

"He's pushing for them. Everything's so shady," said Lowry, 56, who had voted for Abbott all three times.

Lowry, a conservative Christian and lifelong Republican,

SEE TEXAS ON A7

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Officer convicted in 2024 Sonya Massey killing has died

BY AOIFE WALSH

Sean Grayson, the former Illinois sheriff's deputy convicted of fatally shooting Sonya Massey in her home in 2024, has died six months into his 20-year maximum sentence for second-degree murder, his attorney said.

Daniel Fultz, who represented Grayson in the Massey case, told the Associated Press his client died Sunday but did not share his cause of death.

Grayson, 32, had been diagnosed with colon cancer before Massey's death, according to a copy of his application for early medical release published by Capitol News Illinois. The Illinois Prisoner Review Board rejected that request last month. The Illinois Department of Corrections did not immediately respond to a request for comment early Monday.

Grayson, who is White, shot Massey, a 36-year-old Black



Sean Grayson shot Massey after she called 911 to report a prowler outside her home in Illinois.

woman, after she had called 911 to report a prowler outside her home in Springfield, Illinois, early on July 6, 2024.

Body-camera footage of the shooting showed Grayson and another deputy speaking to Massey in her home as she heated a pot of water on the stove.

Grayson asked her to take the pot off the burner, and as she did so, he backed away and said he was moving to avoid “your hot, steaming water,” the footage showed. Massey replied, “I rebuke you in the name of Jesus.”

According to the footage, Grayson, who was some distance from Massey, drew his gun and threatened to shoot her as she moved the pot of water.

Massey apologized and ducked for cover, the video showed. He approached Massey and fired his gun three times, hitting her once in the face.

Grayson later said he believed Massey was making a threat to

kill him.

An autopsy found Massey, who had two teenage children, died of a gunshot wound to her head.

Her killing drew widespread condemnation and prompted protests across the country.

Sangamon County Sheriff Jack Campbell stepped down a month after the shooting, as his office faced criticism for hiring Grayson despite past convictions for driving under the influence and disciplinary issues at previous law enforcement agencies.

In August 2025, Illinois lawmakers passed the Sonya Massey Act, which created stricter hiring practices for law enforcement across Illinois.

The law requires law enforcement to thoroughly investigate an applicant's background, especially past discipline or misconduct history with other departments, before hiring them.

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CORRECTION

• An Aug. 24 Metro section article misstated the speed the Artemis II spacecraft reached while returning to Earth. It was 39 times the speed of sound, not 39 times the speed of light.

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DANIEL COLE/REUTERS

A man navigates the receding waters of Lake Mead, the largest reservoir in the United States by water capacity, this month.

Nevada sues over federal mandate to limit Colorado River use

BY SARAH KAPLAN

Nevada sued the Trump administration Monday over a plan requiring it and two other states to cut Colorado River water use, the first legal challenge to the federal government's attempt to rescue the waterway, which is on the brink of collapse.

The state in its challenge filed in U.S. district court said the Interior Department's long-awaited drought management plan would cause “devastating environmental, socioeconomic, and health and human safety impacts to southern Nevada and its citizens.”

The federal plan was developed after the seven states that rely on the river failed to reach a compromise over how to share the pain of mounting water shortages.

The move escalates long-running tensions over the dwindling body of water, which supports some 40 million people across the southwestern United States and Mexico. Some experts say it could herald a torrent of high-stakes lawsuits among

states and the federal government that eventually ends up before the Supreme Court.

Yet Nevada officials argue the potential cuts included in the federal plan — which they say could amount to as much as 71 percent of the state's annual Colorado River allocation — left them with no choice but to sue. The river supplies roughly 90 percent of water used by Las Vegas and the surrounding region.

“This isn’t about political posturing,” Nevada’s Republican governor, Joe Lombardo, said in a statement Monday. “This is a matter of survival for a community that represents about two-thirds of our state's citizens and the lion's share of its economy.”

Representatives for the Interior Department and the Bureau of Reclamation, which oversees the Colorado River's dams and reservoirs, did not respond to requests for comment.

Years of overuse, combined with an unprecedented drought worsened by climate change, have pushed the Colorado River to a crisis point, researchers say. Bureau of Reclamation

data shows the amount of water flowing through the river this year is about 37 percent of the average amount. Water levels in the river's two biggest reservoirs, Lakes Powell and Mead, have fallen to all-time lows.

The shortage has created a standoff between states in the upper part of the basin (Colorado, New Mexico, Utah and Wyoming), where the river originates, and those in the lower basin (Arizona, California and Nevada), which is home to a majority of the river's users.

Interior Department officials say their plan for managing the river, finalized on Friday, will prevent reservoir levels from dropping so low that their dams can no longer produce hydropower. It will require Arizona, California and Nevada, which draw their water from Powell and Mead, to curb their use by roughly 20 percent over the next two years.

But the agency's longer-term framework also raises the possibility of much deeper Lower Basin cuts if water shortages continue. It does not consider

mandatory usage cuts in the Upper Basin.

“While the three Lower Basin states are not happy about the scheduled cuts over the next two years, it's year three and beyond that are the issue,” Douglas Kenney, director of the Western Water Policy Program at the University of Colorado at Boulder, wrote in an email. “Those could be devastating to some users.”

The lawsuit brought by the state of Nevada, the Colorado River Commission of Nevada and the Southern Nevada Water Authority alleges that the framework violates the complex set of rules governing the river and fails to consider the economic effects of cutting water deliveries to urban areas.

The complaint also notes that Nevada has already implemented stringent water conservation measures. Some 99 percent of Las Vegas's indoor water use is recycled and sent back to the river. Use of Colorado River water is heavily restricted at golf courses and on lawns. This leaves the state with little wiggle

room to absorb additional water cuts, the complaint says.

The Nevada suit is likely to be the first of many, said Anne Castle, a former chair of the Upper Colorado River Commission and longtime water expert.

Arizona, which stands to face the deepest cuts under the federal plan, has amassed a multimillion-dollar war chest to prepare for potential litigation. In a recent letter to the Interior Department, the state's top water official offered a list of objections to the agency's approach, saying it would “inflict catastrophic harm on Arizona's citizens.”

While litigation between Lower Basin states and the federal government was expected, Kenney said a lawsuit between multiple states would be the “worst-case scenario.” An interstate suit would go directly before the Supreme Court and could result in a binding decree that upends more than a century of water negotiations.

“It's pulling the pin on this grenade,” Kenney wrote. “Hopefully we don't get there.”

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THE NATION



The first day of school at Columbine Elementary School in Denver on Aug. 18, 2025. Trump's tax credit scholarships represent a dramatic departure from how the federal government supports schools.

Trump's voucher program could benefit public schools

Experts suggest the scholarships could help districts access funding

BY NEAL MORTON
Hechinger Report

Forget student fun runs, PTA bake sales and Saturday morning car washes.

The future of public-school fundraising may soon look more like a payroll deduction. Or perhaps door-to-door campaigns each tax season asking filers to earmark donations to support nearby public schools.

When President Donald Trump's tax overhaul known as the One Big Beautiful Bill last year created the first national school-voucher-style program to help families pay for private schools or home-school costs, it allowed public schools to benefit as well.

According to U.S. Treasury guidelines released in June, the program allows specific nonprofits to collect donations that people direct from their federal taxes for a vast array of public school costs, such as transportation or tutoring.

Sara Hazel, president of the Denver Public Schools Foundation, the fundraising arm for Colorado's largest school district, is among a small but growing number of district leaders who have said they plan to take advantage of the financial opportunity. She said she plans to tell potential donors, "Do you want that money going to the IRS or going to local kids?"

The program doesn't officially start until the new year, but its resemblance to private-school vouchers has inspired opponents of school choice to line up against it. Still, supporters and even cautious critics say the Republican-backed initiative could mean a financial boon for public schools.

The program works like this: Taxpayers can contribute up to \$1,700 to what's known as a scholarship-granting organization and receive a credit on their federal income taxes. It's a dollar-for-dollar credit, meaning every pledged dollar reduces what an individual owes to the Internal Revenue Service by the same amount.

These new intermediaries could be formed by an array of nonprofits, including public-school foundations, with approval from their state. The scholarship-granting organization would then pass on the money to private school and home-school applicants in the



East High School's clocktower in Denver. Sara Hazel, president of the Denver Public Schools Foundation, is among a small but growing number of district leaders who have said they plan to take advantage of the financial opportunity.

form of scholarships — or to school districts so they could cover certain services for student applicants.

Marguerite Roza, a school finance expert, has advised school districts — many of which have banded their slashed budgets by shuttering campuses or issuing pink slips — that they can't afford to ignore this new source of funding. "Any time there's an available revenue source, generally we don't see districts saying, 'No thank you,'" said Roza, director of the Edunomics Lab at Georgetown University.

States must opt into the program, and so far, 30 states have done so. Now it's up to individual school district leaders in those states to decide if they want to try to tap into the money.

School finance experts suggest the scholarships could help districts access funding comparable to 3 percent of their entire budget. But tapping into this unexpected revenue risks political backlash and logistical headaches. Governors and superintendents may face fierce resistance from teachers unions, which in many states have portrayed the new program as a Trojan horse for the expansion of vouchers in education because it also allows mon-

"The reality is this program exists, and if there are dollars on the table that can go to our children and families, I don't understand the purpose of not trying to do everything we possibly can."

Justin Dayhoff, chief financial officer for Nevada's Clark County School District

ey to be funneled to families to pay for private school.

Some opponents also raise concerns about creating a new funding system that could favor school districts with a ready pool of wealthy donors over those in low-income communities where few residents may owe enough in federal taxes to contribute to the scholarships.

"In low-income areas, you're going to find it's not easy for school districts to raise this money," said Thomas Toch, director of the think tank FutureEd at Georgetown University.

He said he worried that the inclusion of public school districts in the legislation was little more than a ploy, a shrewd political strategy to further school choice in states otherwise unlikely to support it.

"It was designed to make the case that this program can support the public sector in order to win support in blue states," Toch said.

The mechanics of the tax credit scholarships represent a dramatic departure from how the federal government supports schools.

The money for the scholarships never flows through federal Department of Education coffers, entirely bypassing Congress and its spending decisions.

Treasury regulators will soon issue formal rules to set additional guardrails for the program. But the law suggests the scholarships could be used to cover an expansive list of expenses that public schools often struggle to fund including costs

such as field trips, textbooks or support services.

The inclusion of public schools now places some governors, superintendents and school boards in a new dilemma: Do they choose to tap into a Trump-backed program that could boost their bottom line, or leave the tax-credit cash on the table for others to claim?

"The reality is this program exists, and if there are dollars on the table that can go to our children and families, I don't understand the purpose of not trying to do everything we possibly can," said Justin Dayhoff, chief financial officer for Nevada's Clark County School District, which includes Las Vegas.

His district, like many around the country, is strapped for cash as health insurance and other costs increase and fewer students enroll in public school due to population decline. Enrollment in Clark County — the nation's fifth-largest district — has dwindled by more than 35,000 students, or 11 percent, since before the pandemic and it laid off five dozen staff ahead of this new school year.

How big a financial difference the voucher-style program would make for school districts remains to be seen.

Some school finance experts

expect soliciting donations could be as simple as districts partnering with employers to enroll their workers in the tax credit program, perhaps as another form in their regular HR paperwork. (Many employers already partner with nonprofits like United Way to collect pre-tax donations from paychecks.)

Roza, of Georgetown, estimated a district could bring in about \$200 per student by enrolling its own employees into the program. Convincing major companies to do the same — directing proceeds to nonprofits supporting students who attend local public schools — could push that figure higher. City and county governments might participate as well.

"Local employers are an absolutely critical piece of this puzzle," said Hazel, with the Denver Public Schools Foundation.

Her organization hasn't officially approached any of its corporate partners yet about enrolling their employees in the tax credit program. (Past donors to the foundation have included Chevron, the Colorado Rockies and United Airlines.) But Hazel's already thinking about whether Denver Public Schools will have to compete with other Colorado districts attempting to woo the same business leaders.

"We're the largest school district in Colorado, so we already have an advantage," Hazel said. "But how can we go to a company and say, 'Your employees must choose between all these great school districts?'"

But her new fundraising plans will come with steep operational hurdles.

Under the new law, at least 90 percent of all donations to scholarship-granting organizations like Hazel's must go directly to student scholarships, leaving relatively little to cover marketing, staff, annual independent audits and payment processing. Fees already take 4 percent of each credit card transaction, Hazel said.

Yet even as she awaits further clarity from Treasury on how organizations can collect donations, she's imagining what the money could mean for Denver schools.

"My dream is I can give every second grader a tutor and we get everyone to grade-level reading and math," Hazel said. "There are things like that that are so scalable and would support every student."

This story about the One Big Beautiful Bill was produced by the Hechinger Report, a nonprofit, independent news organization focused on inequality and innovation in education.

This document causes headaches for candidates on left

Democratic Socialists of America platform is tripping up its contenders

BY TEO ARMUS

As soon as Angie Nixon pulled off a surprise victory in Florida’s Democratic primary for U.S. Senate last week, the questions began.

The Democratic Socialists of America “calls for abolishing the Senate,” an NBC anchor said to her. “Do you support abolishing the Senate?”

“Many people are very frightened of their positions,” a CBS host said, before launching a similar line of questioning.

Then, on MS NOW: “What about abolishing prisons, which is one of the platforms of the national DSA?”

Nixon, a three-term state lawmaker who joined the DSA earlier this summer but was not endorsed by the group, denied supporting any of those policies.

But the pile-on was yet another sign of how the ambitious, long-term policy ideas that have driven enthusiasm for the group can cause problems for candidates who need to appeal to the mainstream.

The DSA’s national platform, which includes universal rent control and abolishing the Senate and the Supreme Court, is meant to offer bold alternatives to the status quo — a posture that its leaders say has powered the group’s rapid rise.

The ensuing response, though, epitomizes how the organization’s dual goals — to reimagine what’s possible politically and to win elections — are not always compatible.

“I see this document as symptomatic of a broader problem,” said Rodericka Applewhaite, rapid-response director at the political action committee Majority Democrats, which supports moderate Democratic candidates. “Voters were sick of a political system that felt stale, insular and disconnected.”

But if the DSA’s alternative approach is a draw to disillusioned voters, she added, it also gives Republicans low-hanging fruit to hurt all Democrats by portraying them as radical.

DSA leaders spent the past year revising the platform, known to its members as the “program,” in a year-long process meant to include its various



Attendees of the Democratic Socialists of America summit in Chicago this month.

ideological wings.

In addition to abolishing the Senate, the Supreme Court and, eventually, prisons and police, it calls for universal child care, phasing out fossil fuels, and ending military and economic aid to Israel.

“We need a big, transformational, long-term conversation, or else people will continue to check out of the political process,” said Frances Gill, who led a committee to revise the document.

She and other DSA leaders said the group does not expect candidates to align with every piece of its platform as they try to win elections, though some in the group have floated incorporating that into the endorsement process.

Party platforms for Democrats and Republicans often reveal divisions between core party activists and more moderate voters, but seldom to this degree. In 2020, the GOP decided not to even write a platform, in part to avoid fights over issues like abortion restrictions.

But for a group founded outside the mainstream whose primary wins have suddenly pulled it onto a much bigger political stage, the effect has been magnified: Those victories are bringing the group into the spotlight while also demonstrating how harsh that spotlight can be.

“I don’t think the DSA program idea is a moon-shot idea. It’s a crazy idea,” said Rep. Bradley Schneider (D-Illinois), the chair of the moderate New Democrat Coalition in the House. “Many of the things in there are just rank, stupid ideas that aren’t going to make life better.”

The DSA counts just two members in Congress but is on track to see its presence on Capitol Hill at least quadruple next year. Schneider noted that actually passing legislation in the House will require far more votes — 218 — than adherents to the group can offer.

The most radical ideas, like abolishing a chamber of Congress, would need a constitutional amendment, requiring supermajorities in Congress and of state legislatures.

Patrick T. McHenry, a former GOP congressman from North Carolina, said he expected his party to focus heavily on the platform ahead of the November midterm elections. The tail, he added, could be long.

“Everybody’s hot to trot on these crazy ideas now,” McHenry said. “The wider electorate

for a presidential election cycle will not be as favorable to these socialist policies as a midterm will.”

The DSA, which saw an explosive rise following the presidential campaigns of Sen. Bernie Sanders (I-Vermont) and again after Zohran Mandani was elected New York mayor, first adopted a platform during its 2021 national convention.

It has been redrafted and revised every two years since, most recently by a committee that pored over each line, before being green-lit by the DSA’s top elected body.

Titled “Workers Deserve More,” it is divided into sections on foreign and domestic policy and democratic-system changes. Several of its 16 points are largely in step with the progressive wing of the Democratic Party,

such as Medicare-for-all and the Green New Deal.

More ambitious ideas, including those that would reshape the American form of government, have generated the most attention.

Cliff Connolly, a member of the DSA’s top committee, said including Senate abolition could precisely force that idea further into the mainstream.

He compared it to the abolition of slavery in the 1830s and ‘40s. People viewed it negatively and wanted to limit or reform it, he said, but within 10 years, the idea became mainstream.

“Maybe it sounds weird at first because it’s not something people have thought of,” he said, but the Senate “is a place where good ideas that most people agree with go to die.”

What that means for people running for Congress — including for the Senate — is another question.

Nixon, the first and only DSA member to win a statewide primary this year, did not receive the group’s backing. She has called herself a “capitalist” after being grilled on the DSA’s platform during cable news interviews, noting that she owns a small business.

Chris Rabb, the Democratic nominee for a deep-blue House seat in Pennsylvania, was endorsed by both his local DSA chapter and the national group. He also distanced himself from the platform, which in some cases goes further than his own.

Rabb advocates overhauling the Supreme Court, for example, but not abolishing it entirely.

He engaged in a lengthy process to win the local endorsement, he said, but it did not include any discussion of the national platform. The national endorsement, which came later, did not require him to sign off on the platform either, he said.

Ashik Siddique, one of the DSA’s national co-chairs, said he hopes to eventually incorporate the platform into the national endorsement process — in part, to get everyone on board.

But he said that even if candidates are enduring criticism for the platform, particularly on conservative platforms like Fox News, the scrutiny is sharpening their ideas and bringing them attention with new audiences.

After Siddique’s first appearance on the network earlier this summer, he said he received an email from an elderly truck driver in rural Georgia, telling him he liked the group’s ideas.

Trump moves to begin larger project to reshape White House’s South Lawn

Wants to change slope to bring it flush with his new helipad

BY DAN DIAMOND

President Donald Trump has begun a larger project to redo the White House’s lawn, seeking to bring its slope flush with his new helipad.

Construction crews, which have been working round-the-clock to complete the helipad project before Chinese President Xi Jinping’s planned state visit next month, have torn up much of the White House’s South Lawn and are working to raise its level, according to photographs of the site and two people who spoke on the condition of anonymity to describe planned construction.

A White House official said Monday afternoon that the helipad project would involve adjusting the slope of the lawn around the site.

“The lawn will gently be reshaped to meet the new helipad,” the official said, speaking on the condition of anonymity to describe in-progress construction.

Trump’s work on the helipad, the lawn and the ballroom are part of his broader effort to remake the physical grounds of the White House in his second term — a project that involves at least \$900 million in new spending, The Washington Post reported.

The helipad project, which also includes changes to the White House driveway and South Portico, was set to cost \$13 million, according to a contractor’s records obtained by The Post.

The White House did not immediately respond to questions about whether Trump’s efforts to change the slope of the White House’s South Lawn would add any additional cost or time to the helipad project.

The Post reported earlier this



Construction continued on a new helipad on the South Lawn of the White House over the weekend. Crews have been working round-the-clock to complete the project.

month that Trump had ordered contractors to redo weeks of work on the helipad because the president was unhappy with the helipad’s slope. Trump expressed a desire for a landing pad that sits level with the horizon, compared to the slightly sloped helipad that was taking shape. Workers subsequently redid the project, winning Trump’s public praise.

“We had a lot of slope on it, and I felt it was too much slope,” Trump told reporters last week, when he gave them a tour of the project. He later told construction workers that the decision to lift up the helipad’s slope “was one of the best things we’ve ever done.”

He also discussed his efforts to address damage to the White House lawn stemming from the Ultimate Fighting Championship match he hosted earlier this

summer, thanking ScottsMiracle-Gro for making a donation of new sod and pointing out fresh topsoil.

Trump also had been considering an effort to regrade the White House’s South Lawn and raise its slope, The Post reported. The lawn, which has been used for decades by helicopters that transport the president, slopes downward, away from the White House.

Trump ordered the construction of the helipad to accommodate the next generation of Marine One helicopters, which run the risk of burning the White House grass. Trump has said he is hoping to use the 100-foot-wide, granite helipad, which is emblazoned with a presidential seal, to also host events in conjunction with his planned White House ballroom.

“They can have cocktails and

everything outside of the White House, and then they go into the ballroom,” Trump said last week.

The president on Monday afternoon invited White House guests on another tour of the helipad project as he wrapped up remarks on education policy in the Rose Garden.

“When I hear all that banging out there, some people say, ‘Oh, that’s too bad,’” Trump said. “And I say, ‘I love it.’”

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At least 7 injured as wildfire rages near Reno, Nevada

BY AOIFE WALSH
AND BRIANNA SACKS

A fast-moving wildfire burning with high intensity near Reno, Nevada, has forced thousands of residents to evacuate and injured at least seven people, with strong, unpredictable winds complicating firefighting efforts. The blaze was caused by human activity, officials said.

The Hawk Fire was first reported Saturday morning and quickly was fueled by red-flag wind conditions, Chief Richard Edwards, of Truckee Meadows Fire Protection District, said in a news conference Sunday. It spread to about 15,000 acres in about a day. As of Monday afternoon, fire crews had gained an upper hand, bringing containment from zero to 27 percent.

Officials were also able to considerably reduce evacuations, dropping orders and warnings that had affected nearly 90,000 people in the Washoe County area, along Nevada's border with California. As of Monday afternoon, 23,000 residents were under Go Now orders and 40,000 others under warnings.

Officials said flames have destroyed 32 houses, particularly in the North Valleys suburbs and in some canyons, but the full scale of the damage is not yet known. Reno City Council member Devon Reese said several city employees lost their homes, as did a first responder.

The fire is primarily burning in mountainous and rural terrain with extremely dry brush and trees, but it has been threatening the northwest part of Reno, which is heavily residential.

And while the threat has diminished significantly, officials said there is still the potential for extreme heat and winds to exacerbate the fire and threaten communities.

The Washoe County School District shuttered nearly all of its schools, affecting about 65,000 children just as they



The Hawk Fire comes just weeks after the Bug Fire, also in Nevada, reached more than 93,000 acres.

were returning from summer break, Reese said, calling the situation “very disruptive.”

Shane Ackerson, an incident commander with the U.S. Forest Service, described the fire as “human-caused” but provided no more detail, saying it was still under investigation. He did not say whether it was intentional.

Reese said the fire sparked in an area where many people go

for recreation, such as riding ATVs. Human-caused, he explained, means they have ruled out lightning or utility infrastructure, but it does not necessarily mean arson. A spark from a vehicle or a burning cigarette could have lit the blaze during the hot, dry conditions.

At least seven people — four civilians and three firefighters — were injured, officials said. The firefighters sustained minor

burns, officials said.

The area was also just recalibrating after a woman admitted to intentionally starting multiple fires earlier this month, which merged and burned more than 40,000 acres of extremely dry fuels, prompting evacuations. The Reno area has faced hot, dry and windy weather for weeks.

“It kind of feels like this is the new normal as we have and continue to build into wildland urban interface areas, and as our globe has gotten hotter,” said Reese, who was born in Reno and has lived there for all his 51 years. “Reno is one of the faster warming cities I believe in the country, and we have just found ourselves really experiencing the effects of this heat.”

Reno’s population has also been growing as more people look for cheaper housing with

TREVOR BEXON/GETTY IMAGES

Texas attorney general unveils anti-data-center plan as voter anger mounts

Senate hopeful is locked in a competitive race with Democrat James Talarico

BY MOLLY HENNESSY-FISKE
AND SHIRA OVIDE

HOUSTON — Texas Attorney General Ken Paxton released a “data center plan” Monday that included proposing federal legislation to block their use of Chinese technology and holding centers criminally liable if they power AI chatbots that “undermine children’s safety.”

“Texans deserve a fighter to lead and represent them as we address the growing presence of data centers in Texas and stop their negative impact on our neighborhoods,” Paxton said in a statement that avoided calling for a moratorium on the massive projects that have become increasingly unpopular among rural conservatives.

“This plan will ensure that happens while putting Texas first, protecting our culture and land, and safeguarding our families and communities,” Paxton said. “My plan will also work to ensure that data centers are not utilized to power AI platforms that endanger our children.”

Paxton — a controversial MAGA populist who won his primary runoff despite national Republicans spending millions of dollars to support incumbent Sen. John Cornyn — is locked in a competitive race with Democratic state Rep. James Talarico. Many polls show them tied; Cook Political Report rated the race a toss-up last week.

Talarico, who has called for tighter regulations on data centers but not a moratorium, responded to Paxton’s plan Monday by noting, “Paxton has taken nearly half a million dollars from the data center industry, voted to flood Texas with data centers by giving them billions in tax handouts, and has refused to use his power as attorney general to respond to Texans’ requests to block data center development in their communities.”

He noted that Paxton’s campaign post about the plan featured a graphic that X flagged as “Made with AI.”

“He’s scared his ties to big data center companies will lose him the election, so he’s making a sad attempt to reverse course by releasing a plan he literally used AI to make,” Talarico said.

But Madison Cercy, Paxton’s campaign spokeswoman, said



BRANDON BELL/GETTY IMAGES

Texas Attorney General Ken Paxton’s plan includes proposing federal legislation to block data centers’ use of Chinese technology.

the data center plan came from the attorney general, not AI.

She said the Paxton “spent months crafting a plan with input from local communities, state leaders, and policy analysts” that’s “centered around putting Texas first in the AI race.”

Cercy dismissed the “poor attempt by James Talarico’s team to distract from the 11 million dollars he took from people with data center interests.”

Data centers have clearly angered voters, particularly in reliably red rural areas, and Republicans are starting to respond in Texas and nationwide.

Paxton’s four-point plan includes an endorsement of Republican Gov. Greg Abbott’s data center plan, announced earlier this month, that paused new centers until companies agree to electricity, water and other development limits. President Donald Trump criticized the governor’s plan, warning that Texas communities could miss out on development and jobs.

But the governor, running for reelection against a Democrat who has polled within a point



MIKALA COMPTON/AUSTIN AMERICAN-STATESMAN/AP

Activists protest data centers outside the Capitol in Austin on Aug. 19. Democratic state Rep. James Talarico responded to Paxton’s plan on Monday by noting Paxton’s ties to the centers.

of the three-term incumbent in part due to data center anger among conservatives, defended the restrictions as necessary “guardrails,” noting how many companies have already agreed to comply.

Paxton has yet to take action on his data center plan, but he’s been a trendsetter in GOP technology regulation, including seeking to protect children from perceived harms.

As attorney general, Paxton sued or investigated several social media companies due to concerns they harmed children or violated privacy. He also enforced several Texas technology laws that became blueprints for other states, including those requiring smartphone app stores and adult content websites to verify users’ ages and block minors.

Brendan Steinhauser, a Texas GOP strategist and CEO of the Alliance for Secure AI, a non-profit focused on educating the public about the technology’s implications, said Paxton’s plan “helps him politically” but “the chatbot part might be a bit difficult to figure out, technically.”

Concerns about AI’s impact on the economy and society, and general mistrust of Big Tech, has been unifying people across the state in opposition to data center construction, Steinhauser said. “You go to very progressive downtown Austin and they’re saying similar things to rural Fayette County,” he said.

This explains, he said, the wave of Republicans turning against data center construction and the tech industry in general. “They’re telling Big Tech, it’s your fault,” he said. “They’re going to cut bait.”

Adam Thierer at the R Street Institute, a think tank that promotes limited government, criticized Paxton’s track record of pushing expansive government intervention in technology. But Thierer said Paxton is going one step further with the proposal to hold data center companies criminally liable if they power AI that harms children. He called it “really, really radical stuff” and said the proposal would be like holding companies that make ink criminally liable for what people write with it.

“A lot of politicians are playing a game of one-upmanship to see who can propose the craziest ideas” to respond to data center backlash, Thierer said, but allowed, “Some of the crazy ideas might stick.”

Gerrit De Vynck contributed to this report.

In Texas, some on the right debate voting for a Democrat

TEXAS FROM A1

said she's not switching parties. In fact, she plans to vote for Republican Attorney General Ken Paxton in his race for U.S. Senate. But her willingness to split her ticket for even one race is a sign the Texas political landscape — at least this cycle — is scrambling in unprecedented ways that could result in surprising statewide wins for the Democratic Party.

A recent Fox News poll showed Hinojosa, a lawyer and state legislator based in Austin, within a point of Abbott, a sign of weakness in a state where the GOP usually boasts a nine- to 12-point advantage. Last week, the non-partisan Cook Political Report shifted the governor's race from "solid" to "likely" Republican. The picture in the U.S. Senate race to replace John Cornyn is even tighter, according to Cook, which lists the contest as a "toss up" between Paxton and Democratic state Rep. James Talarico.

This wouldn't be the first time polls have given Democrats reason to hope for an upset, only to be disappointed on Election Day. And Texas Republicans have shown a reluctance to split tickets over the past several decades. Republicans control the levers of power in Texas, and a Democrat hasn't won statewide office since 1994. Texas last elected a Democratic governor in 1990 (Ann Richards) and a Democratic senator in 1988 (Lloyd Bentsen). But now some conservatives and right-leaning independents say they plan to vote Democratic in protest, dissatisfied with how the GOP is handling issues such as data centers, water, electricity, schools and the economy.

Even more unusual is how vocal some of these conservatives are about their dissatisfaction. They've adopted a slogan "Break Rank," an indication that they are not content simply to sit out the election but want to punish their party with a vote for the opposition.

Lifelong Republican voter Tom Weeks met with Hinojosa recently wearing a homemade "Break Rank" T-shirt.

"My party has failed," said Weeks, 66, who retired from the paper supply business to the North Texas suburb of Granbury where he's been fighting both data centers and a bitcoin mine that arrived a few years ago, bringing round-the-clock noise.

"Nothing has been done by our party to help," Weeks said. "Any Republican who has been in office since we started this fight, I'm not going to vote for them."

Conservative friends accused Weeks of "making a deal with the devil," but he's defiant. "We're going to vote for whoever we think understands our plight, and she does," he said of Hinojosa.

Rena Schroeder, who ran unsuccessfully in a Republican primary election for a state Senate seat in March, recently attended a Talarico campaign event featuring Hinojosa at the civic center in Killeen and said she plans to vote Democratic. Schroeder, who now identifies as independent, helped start a "Break Rank" group that she said has drawn about 100 voters.

"We're calling it 'breaking rank' because of the level of corruption," in the Republican Party, she said. "We the people are breaking rank."

Hinojosa is hopeful she can shave off enough votes among independents, rural and suburban conservatives to win. Before she spoke at the packed event near Temple, Hinojosa met with local



PHOTOS BY JOEL ANGEL JUAREZ/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Gina Hinojosa, a Democratic candidate for Texas governor, appears to be in a close race with Republican Greg Abbott, who is seeking a fourth term.

Democrats to discuss their pitch to swing voters. A volunteer asked Hinojosa, who's from the border city of Brownsville, how to persuade Latinos who voted for President Donald Trump to return to the Democratic Party.

"A lot of them have buyer's remorse," Hinojosa said, noting she'd spoken with some upset by recent fatal ICE shootings. "We can invite them back in. That creates an opportunity for us. They're not saying 'Yay, Democrats!' But they are saying 'We don't want this.'"

In an interview afterward with The Post, Hinojosa emphasized the national implications of her race. A Democratic governor, she said, would block a Republican-controlled Texas legislature from further congressional gerrymandering in favor of the GOP.

"There can be no path to a Democratic-controlled Congress when that happens," Hinojosa said. "Once they hold on and rig those elections, how do you get it back?"

This week, Hinojosa debuted an ad attacking Abbott on data centers.

"Our job is to raise enough money to tell people who I am and what I'm about. We don't have to raise as much money as him, just enough to do that," she said, noting that Republicans poured millions into Cornyn's campaign yet he still lost his primary.

Abbott's campaign, so far, has largely focused on Democrats broadly rather than singling out Hinojosa.

"The contrast in this election couldn't be clearer. Democrats want higher taxes and support policies like defunding the police, abolishing prisons, and boys playing in girls' sports. Governor Abbott is focused on the issues that matter to Texas families: slashing property taxes and low-

ering the costs of healthcare, insurance, electricity, housing, and education," Eduardo Leal, press secretary for the Abbott campaign, said in a statement.

If Texas Republicans split their tickets, it's not clear which Texas Democrats stand to benefit most. Weeks and Lowry said they won't vote for Talarico because they consider him too liberal. Others like Glenda Berg plan to vote for Talarico and Hinojosa.

Berg, 84, a retired bookkeeper and lifelong Republican who lives near Temple in Belton and whose daughter attended the Hinojosa event, said she voted for Abbott and Trump three times but has been "appalled" by the president acting "against what democracy is based on." In particular, she said she is opposed to the mid-decade congressional redistricting that Republicans championed at Trump's urging.

"I'm very disappointed with the way [Abbott] follows everything Trump says and does," she said.

Some Texas political experts question whether Hinojosa can win without Talarico prevailing at the top of the ticket.

"The question is: Will there be this rising tide, this blue wave? If it takes out Paxton, who will be next?" said Mark Jones, a political science professor at Rice University. "For Hinojosa to win, she needs to do three things: Win an overwhelming majority of the Democrat vote, which she seems on track to do. Second: Win the support of independent voters by a 2-1 margin, which she seems to be doing. And three: Win at least 10 to 15 percent of the Republican vote."

Still, Texas is reliably Republican, and Abbott has a record of turning out the base. "Abbott going down would be an earthquake," Jones said.

Jones predicted Abbott will

hammer Hinojosa in the coming weeks with attack ads highlighting her liberal legislative record. As a state lawmaker for the past nine years, Hinojosa fought the state school voucher program, helped lead a legislative walkout in 2025 that delayed passage of a new congressional redistricting map, and voted against restricting transgender medical care for minors and limiting abortion access in the state.

"That might give pause to those voters who say they're go-

ing to vote for Hinojosa as a protest against Abbott," he said.

James Henson, director of the Texas Politics Project at the University of Texas at Austin, said the unusually competitive election is challenging Republicans' allegiance, but cautioned that in Texas, "It's going to take a lot for a Republican to vote for a Democrat."

Logan Olson stopped by the Talarico-Hinojosa event in Killeen last week. A single mother and substitute teacher run-

ning a livestock business, she voted for Trump last election. Now she's upset about data centers but encouraged by Abbott's proposed regulations, noting "at least he acknowledged the people."

"Our government needs to govern our economy," said Olson, 36, railing against the culture wars. "We're getting so lost with stuff that should be discussed behind closed doors."

So will she vote for Hinojosa? "I'm not sure yet."



Vietnam veterans Tommy Baird, Juan Salinas and Jim Babb attend a Democratic rally in Killeen, Texas, which included U.S. Senate hopeful James Talarico and gubernatorial candidate Gina Hinojosa.



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U.S. aims to weaken global limits on plastic production

PLASTICS FROM A1

lution,” the department said, adding the treaty should not interfere with military readiness or critical national-security applications.

It said the administration backed “common-sense” measures to reduce plastic pollution while rejecting proposals that would “damage the American economy, drive inflation, and restrict consumer choice.”

Andreas Bjelland Eriksen, Norway’s minister of climate and the environment, said the memo was “in line with what the US has communicated” during recent negotiations.

“We do not share the view that restricting specific plastic items that contribute to plastic pollution would pose a threat to economic growth,” Eriksen said, adding that in countries that have imposed limits on plastic pollution, “new and improved business solutions emerge.”

“The treaty must lead to real changes to tackle plastic pollution, if not, there is no point having it,” Eriksen added.

Barirega Akankwasah, executive director of Uganda’s National Environment Management Authority, defended the U.S.’s right to advance its views: “International law must reflect the needs and aspirations of negotiating countries and international law can only succeed based on national implementation which in turn is a reflection of national capabilities and circumstances.”

The dispute comes after what experts described as a sharp shift in the U.S. position under the Trump administration. Youngman, a legal and policy specialist at advocacy group Environmental Investigation Agency said the U.S. under the Biden administration was open to provisions reducing plastic production, even though it did not support a global cap.

But the U.S. has since vocally opposed limits on production and sought to narrow the treaty’s scope, including through new language invoking national security.

Alexandra Harrington, an international legal expert, said the



Workers pull on a plastic boom as they remove waste clogging a river amid heavy rain in the Philippines's Metro Manila area this month. EZRA ACAYAN/GETTY IMAGES

U.S. was not acting alone and had “come back in as a disrupter” in the talks.

Harrington, also the chair of the International Union for Conservation of Nature’s plastic pollution task force, added the U.S. proposal went far beyond the narrow military exemptions sometimes found in environmental treaties, and appeared aimed more at shielding economic and petrochemical interests than addressing a specific plastics-related defense risk.

“I think for them the national security argument is convenient, it’s useful,” she said.

The memo was circulated in the months before treaty chair Julio Cordano published a new “Aid to Negotiations” document earlier this month. The text, intended to steer governments toward a final agreement, has also been criticized by environmental groups and some legal experts for creating a system based on national pledges rather than binding global controls.

Cordano did not respond to a request for comment.

Harrington said the chair’s new text was “very clearly” bending toward the agenda of countries seeking a less ambitious treaty, like the U.S.

She pointed to the removal of trade provisions that would have regulated the cross-border movement of plastics, from polymers and products sold abroad to plastic waste shipped for disposal or recycling. Harrington said trade rules are a standard

feature of major pollution treaties.

Stewart Harris, managing director for global affairs at the American Chemistry Council, said the administration’s position is largely aligned with the plastic industry’s.

Harris, whose trade group represents plastics manufacturers, said hard limits on plastic production will raise product costs for lower income people globally without significantly reducing plastic waste. Rough-

ly 2.7 billion people globally do not have access to proper collection for their plastic waste and addressing that and recycling would go further to reducing pollution, he said.

ACC is lobbying for individual countries to set their own action plans for tackling plastic pollution, such as setting national rather than global targets for how much recycled content plastic should contain.

Harris said ACC has not taken a position on the national security exemption, but that such provisions were common in global environmental agreements.

“That tells me that the United States is very serious about negotiating an agreement it can join,” he said. “They wouldn’t be even considering those details if it was not serious about joining.”

Even if negotiators reach a deal, the United States would only join the treaty if the Senate ratifies it by a two-thirds majority vote, a difficult bar to clear in an extremely polarized Congress.

While formal talks will resume next spring, informal negotiations resumed in late June, nearly a year after governments failed to produce a final agreement amid disputes over whether the treaty should include limits on plastic production and binding restrictions on chemicals. Many countries rejected the then-chair’s draft as too weak to serve as the basis for a deal.

Youngman said the new document weakens last year’s text further by removing proposed reporting requirements on how much plastic countries produce and consume, and by replacing stronger legal terms such as “shall” with weaker language such as “should.” Even its most ambitious options, she said, would fall short of the mandate to end plastic pollution.

“We didn’t think it was possible,” she said, “but we keep on digging ourselves even lower.”

Heads of delegations are due to meet in Bangkok at the end of September, where governments are expected to discuss “bridging proposals,” compromise language intended to address the treaty’s most contentious issues.

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Economists say reinstating Mexican cattle imports may not help beef prices

BY JOHN HANNA
AND SARAH RAZA
Associated Press

The United States was set to reopen a border crossing in Arizona to cattle from Mexico on Monday as part of a broader effort by the Trump administration to reduce record-high beef prices, though economists doubt the move will mean much to grocery store shoppers.

The Agriculture Department has said that concerns about the New World screwworm's spread lessened enough to allow the movement of cattle from Mexico at a crossing in Douglas, Arizona, about 230 miles southeast of Phoenix. Over time, it hopes to reopen other crossings in New Mexico and Texas.

Beef prices clearly are a concern for President Donald Trump, who announced Friday that he would allow up to 331,000 tons of imported ground beef into the country, tariff-free, to be sold at below-market prices over the next 90 days. In February, the White House said closing the border to livestock imports from Mexico more than a year ago was "essential" to containing the screwworm, but it has exacerbated a shortage of cattle for slaughter in the United States.

"The administration obviously has a lot of incentive to try to be able to say that they're doing something about high beef prices in particular," said Derrell Peel, a professor of agribusiness at Oklahoma State University. "Beef has been singled out because it is an expensive product and because it's just high profile."

The Trump administration closed the border to cattle imports in May 2025 as part of its response to the screwworm, a parasite with flesh-eating larvae that can infest and even kill cattle or other animals. The move came as the U.S. already was struggling to meet beef demand, thanks to a cattle herd that has been shrinking for five years and now is the smallest in decades.

Because the Agriculture Department plans a phased reopening of the border, it will take months for Mexican imports to



FERNANDO LLANO/AP

Cows are fenced in before being displayed at a cattle auction in Hermosillo, in Mexico's Sonora state, on July 29, 2025.

return to their traditional levels, Peel said. Mexico has traditionally provided 1.1 million head, or about 3 percent of the U.S. cattle supply.

"I don't expect to see any measurable impact on cattle prices or beef prices soon," Peel said.

The Agriculture Department reported that on Jan. 1, the U.S. cattle herd had dropped to 86.2 million head, the lowest figure in 75 years. Beef prices skyrocketed over the past five years, rising significantly faster than food prices as a whole, according to the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics.

The average price of a pound of ground beef rose nearly 57 per-

cent from July 2021 to July 2026, from \$4.39 to \$6.89 — hitting a peak of \$6.90 in May — with a 10 percent increase over the previous year. Food prices have risen about 25 percent overall in those five years, according to the bureau's numbers.

The price for a pound of uncooked steak rose 35 percent over the past five years, reaching a record \$13.06 per pound in July, also 10 percent higher than a year before.

But Glynn Tonsor, a professor of agricultural economics at Kansas State University, said the potential effect on beef prices from the smaller supply of cattle was lessened because the U.S.

beef industry is more efficient and has been able to get more meat from each animal than in past years.

Federal and industry officials view the New World screwworm fly as a major threat to the nation's \$113 billion cattle industry. It was an annual warm-weather scourge for U.S. ranchers from at least the 1930s through the 1960s, until the U.S. largely eradicated it. The fly was contained for years near the Panama Canal, but returned to southern Mexico in late 2024 and advanced toward the U.S., with the first case in Texas since 1966 reported June 3.

Since then, more than 40 cas-

es have been confirmed in southern Texas and southeastern New Mexico, with infestations of cattle, sheep, goats and dogs.

In her July announcement of plans for a phased reopening of the border, Agriculture Secretary Brooke Rollins said it was possible to start with an Arizona crossing because the northern Mexican states of Sonora and Chihuahua had stronger animal health programs than other parts of Mexico. She also said each animal would be inspected and declared free of the parasite before crossing the border.

Sen. John Boozman (R-Arkansas), the chair of the Senate Agriculture Committee, said the

Agriculture Department is taking a "careful, science-based" approach to reopening the border and imposing strong animal health protocols.

"This is an important step for America's cattle producers, especially our feeders in the border states," Boozman said in a statement. "Restoring this long-standing trade is critical to strengthening our cattle supply and supporting a healthy, competitive beef industry."

Drought in cattle-producing regions of the U.S. is a major reason the national herd is so small, said David Anderson, professor of agricultural economics at Texas A&M University. If grass doesn't grow, cattle have nothing to graze upon, forcing ranchers to sell them off. Low cattle prices over the past two decades also are a factor.

"Where we are today is sort of the culmination of some 18, 19, 20 years of very low cattle prices," he said. "That forces us to reduce our herds. Drought forces us to reduce them even further."

The shortage of cattle also has left beef processing plants operating below capacity.

Tyson Foods, one of the nation's largest meat processors, announced in November that it was reorganizing its beef operations and closing a plant in Lexington, Nebraska, about 220 miles southwest of Omaha. Earlier this month, it announced plans to close a plant in Utah outside Salt Lake City and another in Illinois about 150 miles southeast of Chicago.

In June, another major U.S. processor, JBS USA, announced plans to close beef plants in Memphis and outside Philadelphia, though it later said it would keep some operations at the Pennsylvania plant to preserve 400 jobs there.

Rebuilding the U.S. herd — and ultimately lowering prices — is likely to take years, largely because a cow typically has only one calf a year, Peel said. In addition, breeding a heifer keeps her out of the food supply, tightening it further as the herd is rebuilt.

Peel said prices will remain high for some time and for elected officials, "There's nothing you can do."

Preservationists work to extend life of Revolutionary War 'witness tree'

BY ALLEN G. BREED
Associated Press

EUTAW SPRINGS, S.C. — Standing beneath the spreading branches of a massive live oak, historian Garrison Marcoux tries to imagine what this scarred, struggling tree saw 245 years ago.

Did one of the British soldiers encamped at this South Carolina crossroad near the end of the Revolutionary War sit in the oak's shade to recuperate from the series of attacks in American Maj. Gen. Nathanael Greene's "war of posts?" Did he or his comrades take cover behind its then slender trunk and fire at the onrushing Continental Army? Perhaps a soldier took his last breath beneath its canopy, watering its roots with his blood.

"I'm a spiritual person," Marcoux, with the South Carolina Battlefield Preservation Trust, said as workers clambered among the limbs above. "To say that a place that experienced a lot of violence and intense emotion and things like that doesn't hold some kind of energy is probably not likely. I think that energy exists where something like this happened."

This is a "witness tree." And it now faces its own fight for survival. After multiple attempts to stave off its death over the decades, it is being choked by the chains and cables meant to support it. Preservationists are working to save this unique, living reminder of an oft-overshadowed chapter in U.S. history.

Arborists estimate that the tree was about 50 years old on Sept. 8, 1781, when British and colonial forces clashed during the Battle of Eutaw Springs — considered by historians to be the last open field engagement of the American Revolution.

"It's very rare to have a witness tree, especially from the Revolutionary War," Marcoux said on a recent sultry morning as gnats and mosquitoes buzzed around his head. "To have the tree that witnessed this battle and still standing is short of a miracle."

Among the officers were famous names like Lt. Col. Henry "Light-Horse Harry" Lee and

Brig. Gen. Francis Marion, better known as the "Swamp Fox."

About 2,500 Americans attacked the roughly 2,000 British and Loyalist troops camped around a fortified brick house. Greene, who had a horse shot out from under him during the battle, called Eutaw Springs "by far, the hottest action I ever saw, and the most bloody for the numbers engaged."

Lt. Col. Alexander Stewart, the British field commander that day, later wrote to Gen. Charles Lord Cornwallis, "I assure you the Action was bloody and obstinate."

There were 1,461 killed, wounded, captured or missing. Both sides would claim victory.

"That tree probably took a

"It's very rare to have a witness tree, especially from the Revolutionary War. ... To have the tree that witnessed this battle and still standing is short of a miracle."

Garrison Marcoux, a historian

few lead balls itself," said Aron Landsaw, an arborist.

The combatants would move on. The oak remained — and faced several more battles of its own. Hung with swaying Spanish moss, its branches festooned with bright-green resurrection fern, the tree reaches 45 feet into the sky, its canopy spreading about 130 feet. Its trunk is 72 inches in diameter at breast height.

The twin springs that gave the Revolutionary War battle its name are no more, inundated by the 1940s project that flooded the Santee River basin for hydroelectric power and flood control. Development in the 1960s swallowed up much of what the lake project spared.

The tree survived it all.

Then, about 50 years ago, lightning struck the oak's crotch, splitting the tree nearly in two. Workers lashed the broad branches together with steel cables and chains.

But the mechanisms that saved the oak are now slowly killing it. As the tree grew, the metal bands cut into the trunk and branches, in some places disappearing beneath a scar-like covering of bark.

"The chains and cables are actually choking it out," Landsaw said. "It can't pull nutrients up from the soil."

Preservationists hope to reverse that. South Carolina 250 and the American Battlefield Trust joined forces to hire New York-based SavATree for the project as the U.S. marks the 250th anniversary of the signing of the Declaration of Independence.

Crews recently used a super-sonic air tool to de-compact the ground around the tree's roots, then injected a kelp mixture to add nutrients to the soil. The day of Marcoux's visit, SavATree workers hammered little blunt lightning rods into the main branches, connecting them with shiny copper cables that converge on a longer copper rod pounded deep into the ground about 10 feet from the trunk.

"If lightning does hit it, it'll run down the copper cables and dissipate into the ground," said Landsaw, a consulting arborist with SavATree.

Next, workers will install new cables, bolted into the five main branches, to stabilize the tree before removing the old supports.

"There's going to be a center hub in the middle that connects all these cables and allows the tree to sway with the wind and move around when it needs to," Landsaw said.

Landsaw said this is the most significant project he has ever worked on. While he can't promise the tree will live another three centuries, Landsaw is confident it will be around to inspire new generations of Americans.

"We're focusing on another 100 years at least," he said. "Hopefully longer."

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An executive order would bar the Postal Service from mailing ballots to voters not on lists of citizens created by federal agencies. As midterms near, Monday’s ruling is not the end of the mail-in voting legal fight.

Supreme Court eases path for limits on mail-in voting

BY JUSTIN JOUVENAL,
PATRICK MARLEY
AND JULIAN MARK

A divided Supreme Court on Monday eased the path for an executive order by President Donald Trump that would impose sweeping new restrictions on mail-in balloting for November’s midterm elections, but the complex and fast-moving legal fight is not over.

The executive order would bar the U.S. Postal Service from sending mail-in ballots to voters not on lists of citizens created by federal agencies. States also would be obligated to send the ballots in envelopes that can be tracked to thwart fraud.

Trump has falsely claimed that noncitizens are voting in large numbers, but studies have found that it happens infrequently. He blamed such fraud in part for his loss in the 2020 presidential election.

With just over two months to go before pivotal elections, the high court’s ruling — which overturned a lower court judge’s block of the president’s order — won’t be the last word on whether it will be allowed to go forward.

The case now returns to the lower courts, and a key part of the executive order remains blocked because of a ruling in separate litigation that must also be resolved for the order to go into effect before November.

The legal fights have been closely watched by election officials who have expressed concerns about a quick timeline to comply with the order.

The high court’s decision was not on the merits of the executive order but on a narrower legal question: whether 23 states and the District of Columbia had been harmed by the executive order and their challenge to the order met the legal bar.

In the unsigned opinion, conservatives on the court affirmed the administration’s arguments that it was too soon to take legal action because agencies had yet to finalize the rules for implementing the order at the time the Trump appeal was filed. The Postal Service published its rule late Friday and said it plans to make it official Wednesday.

Richard Hasen, a UCLA law professor and director of the school’s Safeguarding Democracy Project, in an online post called the ruling “narrow and technical” and said the issue could come back before the Supreme Court soon. He said it was “weird” that the court didn’t address the Postal Service issuing a new rule.

The ruling postpones a final decision by a week or more, Hasen said, “when we will be even closer to the election and it will be impossible for states



President Donald Trump has falsely claimed that noncitizens have voted in large numbers, but studies show that it happens infrequently.

to comply with some of the rules that will come out.”

If the executive order ultimately goes forward, it is likely to inject fresh uncertainty into an already high-stakes election that will determine which party controls the House and the Senate.

Some election officials said it will be a challenge to implement major new procedures so close to the contests. States face looming deadlines to begin sending out absentee ballots, and some would have to replace envelopes, train staff and make other changes to comply with the order.

The Supreme Court majority brushed aside those concerns in its decision, but acknowledged its ruling was not the ultimate word on the legality of Trump’s executive order.

“The Court’s disposition of this application does not mean that any measure taken by the Government to implement the Order will necessarily be lawful. On that score, time will tell,” the majority wrote.

The decision came over the sharp objections of the court’s three liberals.

“This ruling violates well-established precedents concerning this Court’s equitable discretion and needlessly injects chaos and uncertainty into the upcoming midterm elections,” Justice Ketanji Brown Jackson wrote in

an opinion. “It also lets another shoe drop in the Kafkaesque nightmare that our precedents have been steadily creating for certain plaintiffs who seek to bring election-related challenges.”

The Supreme Court’s ruling for now overturns a New England appeals court ruling last month that found Trump’s order would “sow confusion” and “threaten disenfranchisement of many eligible voters.” The appeals court ratified a federal judge’s block.

In June, U.S. District Judge Indira Talwani in Massachusetts issued a summary judgment against the executive order, ruling that the president lacked constitutional authority to order changes in how states and local governments administer elections.

The Constitution gives states the primary role in election administration and assigns Congress the ability to set national standards for elections. The president has a more limited role.

In August, Talwani blocked the portion of the executive order on mail ballots for all states in a separate case brought by the League of Women Voters and other voting rights groups. The Trump administration asked the Supreme Court to instruct lower courts to lift that block

on Trump’s order as well, but the justices did not address the matter.

Groups that are suing over the executive order argued the administration had violated an injunction by publishing the Postal Service rules. Over the weekend, the groups asked Talwani to issue an order declaring the postal rule had no effect and to bar the administration from taking any further action.

Talwani told government lawyers to file responses by Tuesday morning and said they were “ignoring the confusion that the publication [of the rule] will engender.”

In the case directly before the justices, the Trump administration asked the Supreme Court to reverse the appeals court ruling, saying its decision was “indefensible” and could impose “irreparable harm on the federal government” as the administration tries to shore up the integrity of elections.

The administration also argued that the plaintiffs in the case — the nearly two dozen states and the District of Columbia — lacked standing to challenge the executive order because rules were still in the works.

“The injunction is especially indefensible because the agencies are still deliberating over how (if at all) to implement

the Order,” the administration wrote.

The states and D.C. argued that Trump had overstepped his authority in issuing the executive order and warned of the possibility of major problems during November’s elections.

“The consequences of allowing such transformative changes to take effect so close to this fall’s elections would be extreme,” the states wrote in filings. “Because of the high risk of errors and the limited window for correcting mistakes, many of the millions of voters who rely on mail voting — especially voters with disabilities and those in rural areas — would likely be denied mail ballots and, as a result, disenfranchised.”

Officials from states that sued over the executive order promised to continue the litigation. In a social media post, Arizona Attorney General Kris Mayes (D) emphasized that the ruling was procedural and states would continue to try to block the executive order. “States run their own elections,” she wrote. “Not the Postal Service. Not the President.”

The court “seemed to create complete chaos leading up to the midterm elections, waiting weeks after an administration filing, and just days before mail ballots go out, to completely rewrite the rules of the election,” said David Becker, executive di-

rector of the nonpartisan Center for Election Innovation and Research, which assists local and state election officials.

Some election officials concurred, saying the changes would be exceedingly difficult to implement in the months before the midterms.

States and the federal government would be responsible for creating lists showing who is eligible to receive mail ballots, and the risk of mismatches or eligible voters being left off those lists is high, they said.

The administration has been determining citizenship by using a federal database that contains some incomplete and inaccurate information. In some instances, eligible voters have had their registrations revoked because they were improperly identified as noncitizens, according to court records.

State voter rolls are constantly changing, and some states allow voters to register to vote up until Election Day. Election officials would be required to regularly update their lists, but the Postal Service has not yet made clear how states would do that.

In addition, under the new rule, the Postal Service would need to review and approve the designs of ballot envelopes for thousands of voting jurisdictions in the country — a steep challenge with a tight time frame and constrained budgets.

Counties typically order their envelopes a year or more in advance and would not have time to get new ones before November, said Jennifer Morrell, the chief executive of the Elections Group, which supports and trains election officials.

“It just seems a little bit reckless,” she said of putting the new rule in place so close to the election.

Voting by noncitizens is rare, but it does happen. New Jersey recently disclosed that it had inadvertently registered thousands of noncitizens because of a software error, including about 340 who went on to cast ballots in recent years.

Trump, who has claimed that voter fraud is rampant despite a lack of evidence, has taken other steps to exert federal control over elections.

He has been pressuring the Senate to pass the Save America Act, which would require voters to prove their citizenship to register and to show photo identification when voting.

He reiterated debunked claims about vulnerabilities in election systems during a prime-time television address in July, fired members of a federal bipartisan election commission and threatened to withhold funding from states that do not make changes to voting procedures before November.



GERALD HERBERT/AP

An aerial view shows flooding on July 17 in Ozona, Texas. So far this summer, total atmospheric moisture levels have been about 5 to 15 percent above average in the Pacific and across much of the U.S.

See the invisible force driving destructive floods across the United States

Extra moisture in atmosphere has fueled record-breaking rainfall

BY BEN NOLL

Some of the most extreme weather in the United States this summer has been driven by an invisible force pooling in the skies above: water vapor.

Although recent destructive floods in Hawaii, Indiana, Kentucky, Missouri, New York, Texas, West Virginia and many other states may seem geographically disconnected, they share a link to something happening thousands of miles away, in a remote stretch of the tropical Pacific Ocean.

That's where the combination of a record-breaking El Niño, a marine heat wave and the ocean-warming tailwind from climate change have sent much more moisture into the atmosphere than normal. So far this summer, total atmospheric moisture levels have been about 5 to 15 percent above average in the Pacific and across much of the U.S.

An analysis by The Washington Post shows that since June, this extra moisture, transported by winds, has spilled into the contiguous United States, helping to fuel record-breaking rainfall in parts of 44 out of 48 states, covering about 90,000 square miles.

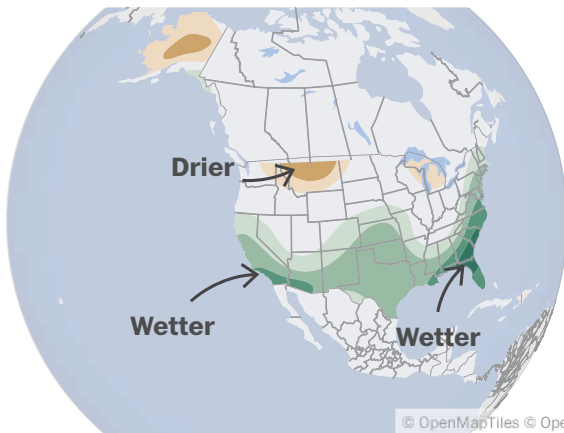
"This is important," wrote Tampa-based meteorologist Jeff Berardelli on X about the widespread nature of above-average moisture.

He added: "That's why we keep getting these 1-1000 year rain events. It's because that probability is based on the past climate. We now have a new climate. Much more moisture is available for storms. El Niño is supercharging this effect at the moment, but the underlying mechanism is long term climate warming."

Although the level of mois-

Precipitation outlook for Dec. 2026 to Feb. 2027

Above average Below average

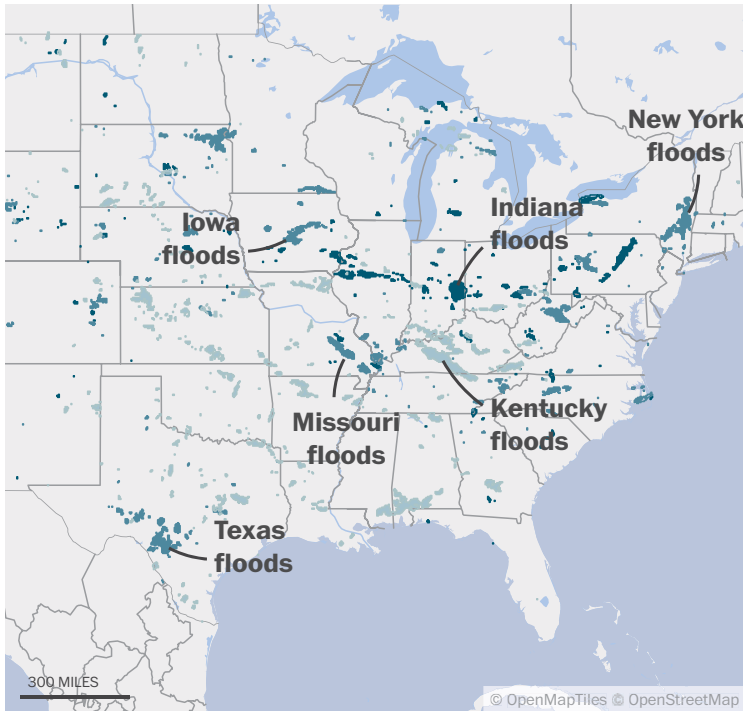


The darker the color, the higher the chance for the specified outcome. Unshaded areas have equal chances of receiving above-average or below-average precipitation.

Source: NOAA

Where and when record-breaking rainfall events have occurred so far this summer

June July August

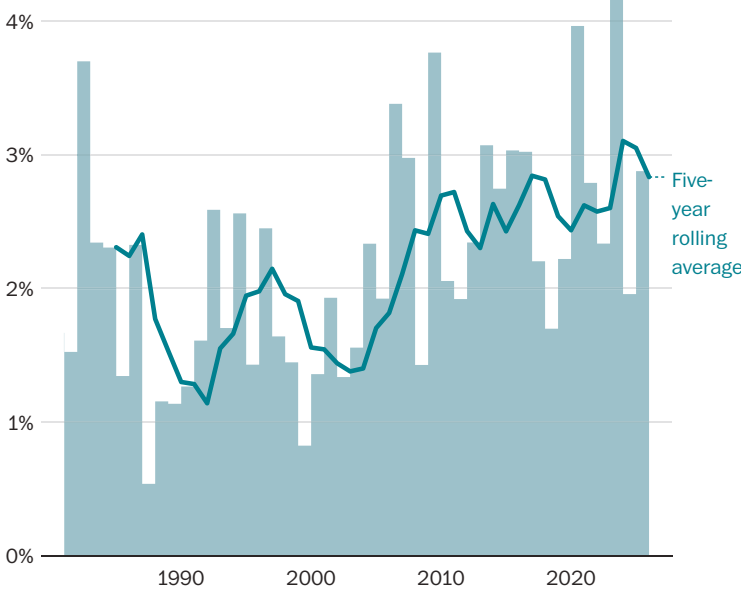


Considering daily rainfall data from June 1 to Aug. 20. Data for 2026 was compared with historical data from 1981 to 2025 to see where records were broken this year.

Source: PRISM/Oregon State University

Share of contiguous U.S. land area affected by record-breaking rainfall each summer

Extreme rainfall has become more widespread



Considering daily rainfall records from June 1 to Aug. 20 each year.

Source: PRISM/Oregon State University

ture flowing through the sky doesn't have a one-to-one relationship with rainfall amounts, having more moisture can boost the odds for rainfall extremes, if there's a force to squeeze that moisture out, such as a front or low pressure system.

The Post recently reported how this powerful El Niño — on the backdrop of climate change — will act like a climate time machine, temporarily pushing global temperatures to levels that might not otherwise be reached for another decade or so.

That's important, because temperature rises are directly linked to the amount of moisture that can pulse across the planet.

Because the water vapor-carrying capacity of air increases at a rate of 7 percent per degree Celsius, it's possible — if not likely — that 2027 also sets a new global moisture record, surpassing 2024. In 2025, The

Post mapped the planet's rising moisture zones and showed how they are closely connected to an increasing risk for rainfall extremes.

Those risks are amplified when atmospheric circulation patterns work in tandem with warming, funneling increasingly moisture-laden air toward the same places, where it can be tapped by storms.

That double whammy has already contributed to numerous flooding events in the U.S. this summer — and there are probably more to come.

Where flood risks may intensify

These summer floods are probably a harbinger of more extreme rain to come during fall and winter.

The exceedingly warm Pacific waters are forecast to turbocharge the southern branch of the jet stream, also called the subtropical jet stream, which

could create a storm highway from California to Florida and up along the East Coast.

NOAA's recently released winter outlook shows that above-average precipitation totals are expected to span from California to the East Coast — suggestive of a stormier-than-normal winter.

Berardelli is particularly concerned about heavy rain events and severe weather across the Deep South and Florida.

"I expect that we will see much above-normal rainfall, and I'd bet some flood events as well," he said, citing strong climate model support for a very wet winter in the South.

"All effects combined, we should see some eye-opening weather, perhaps even events to a level we have not experienced before," Berardelli said.

The consequences of this atmospheric moisture boost will be felt globally. The storm highway may stretch from the U.S. all the way to drought-stricken parts of Europe, with elevated potential for flooding as heavy rain falls on dry, cracked grounds.

No two El Niño events are exactly alike, but the strength of this one is unlike anything people alive today have experienced — or anything measured in the instrumental record stretching back to about 1850.

"What we are about to see this fall and winter may be without precedent," said Berardelli.

About this story

Atmospheric moisture data from June 1 to Aug. 15 of this year was compared with historical data over that same period using data from 1991 to 2020.

Daily rainfall data from 1981 to 2026 was assessed to generate the percentage share of record-breaking events that occurred from June 1 to Aug. 20 each year.

The moisture data comes from ECMWF, and the rainfall data comes from the PRISM Group at Oregon State University.

Woman and her 2-year-old daughter struck, killed by lightning in Florida

BY MATTHEW CAPPUCCI

Two people were killed by lightning Sunday afternoon in Margate, Florida. The victims, a 31-year-old woman and her 2-year-old daughter, were struck while on a neighborhood sidewalk, according to local police.

The strike occurred at about 2:25 p.m. on Northwest First Street in the Broward County city midway between Miami and West Palm Beach. Both victims were transported to a local hospital, where they were pronounced dead.

Widespread severe weather

was not present; instead, typical afternoon sea-breeze storms formed along both of Florida's coasts. Data from the National Lightning Detection Network counted 23,812 cloud-to-ground strokes in a 24-hour period. The greatest strike density accompanied storms along the Space and Treasure coasts, including near Margate, where a bull's-eye of flash density was observed with between 30 and 40 strikes per square mile.

Sunday's episode marks the third and fourth lightning deaths in Florida this year. Florida is the most lightning-vulnerable state in the nation and av-

Sunday's episode marks the third and fourth lightning deaths in Florida this year. Florida is the most lightning-vulnerable state in the nation.

erages seven lightning fatalities annually.

An 18-year-old man was killed in Santa Rosa County, Florida, on May 31 while kayaking, and a 51-year-old man was struck and killed on Fort Myers Beach on July 3. Men are struck

and killed more than four times as often as women.

July and August are the peak times for lightning-strike casualties. That's when the greatest number of people are outside, and lightning activity is reaching a crescendo. The United

States has seen 12 lightning fatalities so far this year.

The vast majority (90 percent) of lightning-strike victims survive. Most who don't suffer cardiac arrest or stop breathing. Most victims can be revived by immediate CPR. Strike victims do not hold a charge and are safe to touch. First aid should be administered immediately.

In many cases, people are struck and killed even when it's not raining. Lightning bolts can leap up to 10 miles from a parent thunderstorm, and often the more errant, farther-venturing bolts carry more charge. If you can hear thunder, you are

close enough to be struck by lightning.

Sunday's storms also brought a tornado to Port St. Lucie, Florida. It's believed the tornado touched down on land initially, unlike many coastal Florida tornadoes, which are weak land-falling waterspouts. Although the overall environment didn't favor widespread rotating thunderstorms, it's likely the storm acquired more localized spin thanks to a wind shift along the sea breeze. The storm tilted and stretched that spin vertically into a tighter tube, forming a tornado.

THE WORLD



Ukrainian and foreign officials attend a ceremony marking Ukraine's Independence Day in Kyiv on Monday. Ukrainian lawmakers voted on Aug. 24, 1991, to proclaim the country's independence.

Europe's leaders mark Ukraine's 35th Independence Day in Kyiv

BY SAMYA KULLAB
Associated Press

KYIV — European leaders joined President Volodymyr Zelensky in Kyiv on Monday for celebrations marking the 35th anniversary of Ukraine's Independence Day as Russia pressed on with its 4-year-old invasion of the country.

One of President Vladimir Putin's key goals in starting a war with Russia's neighbor in February 2022 was to return Kyiv to Moscow's orbit. Ukrainian lawmakers voted Aug. 24, 1991, to proclaim the country's independence, and a nationwide referendum that year overwhelmingly approved it.

With no significant changes on the front line for months and no apparent progress after more than a year of U.S.-led peace efforts, both countries are locked in a spiral of escalating aerial attacks that are killing civilians and smashing infrastructure.

British Prime Minister Andy Burnham, on his first overseas trip since taking office last month, joined almost a dozen other European leaders, as well as other dignitaries in Kyiv on Monday.

"For Ukraine, independence is not an abstract idea. We defended it against all odds," Ukrainian Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha said on social media. "In times like these, nations learn how important it is to have allies by your side."

Burnham co-chaired a meeting of what's been dubbed the "coalition of the willing" of more than two dozen countries help-

ing Ukraine resist Russia's onslaught.

Burnham said he is pushing British industry to help a Ukrainian project that is working on a low-cost alternative to the U.S.-made Patriot air defense systems that are desperately needed but are in short supply. He urged other countries to encourage Washington to adopt stiffer sanctions on Russia and press Moscow to accept U.S. attempts to secure an unconditional ceasefire.

Zelensky said in a speech at Kyiv's St. Sophia Square that the presence of European leaders reflected continental fears about Russia's wider ambitions.

"We all understand that in this Russian war against us — against Ukraine — far more is being decided than the future of Ukraine and Eastern Europe," he said.

"No nation in a war like this could rely solely on its own weapons," Zelensky said. "No nation could withstand attacks of such intensity without the world's help."

The leaders brought pledges of further military and financial support. Burnham announced that his government has agreed to allow defense company MBDA to release classified information relating to British components used in the SCALP long-range missile.

That paves the way for France and Ukraine to advance plans for the weapon's production in Ukraine.

SCALP is the French version of the U.K.'s Storm Shadow missile, with both systems incorpo-

rating shared technology.

"Ukraine has been Europe's protector, not a drain on our security, but the front line of keeping Europe safe," Burnham said, adding that Kyiv and its partners "must keep up the pressure on Moscow."

Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov said the Kremlin views the plan "extremely negatively." He accused Britain of "taking part in this war" on Kyiv's side.

Ukraine has leaned heavily on NATO countries for help fighting Russia's bigger army, although

relations with the United States have been cooler under President Donald Trump.

Russia, meanwhile, is getting help from North Korea and China.

Ukraine's swift development of innovative drone technology has enabled it to blunt Moscow's battlefield progress as well as hit targets deep inside Russia, as far as 1,200 miles from their border.

The speeches in St. Sophia Square were accompanied by a parade of domestically produced weapons.

Both Russia and Ukraine are trying through long-range strikes to inflict economic pain, disrupt military supplies and erode public morale.

Ukraine's long-range drones have repeatedly hit facilities in Russia's vital oil industry, causing fuel shortages, and have also engaged in a campaign against Russia's largest online retailer, Wildberries.

But foreign suppliers also have to take into account their own needs, weapon production levels and the depth of stockpiles.

As the air war has intensified, Ukraine's stocks of Patriot interceptors to counter Russia's ballistic missiles have dwindled. Kyiv urgently needs more interceptors before winter, when Russia routinely bombards its power grid, but the demands of the Iran war and slow output of the sophisticated interceptors have left Ukraine short and vulnerable.

Three teenagers were killed and six children were wounded in the southern Russian city of Krasnodar, Russia's children's rights ombudswoman Maria Lvova-Belova said, as Ukraine attacked several warehouses of Ozon, another online retailer, for the third straight day, according to officials and the company.

Ozon said a large fire raged at its logistics facility in the suburbs of Krasnodar following the overnight attack.

A drone also hit the grounds of an Ozon logistics center in the southern Russian region of Adygeya, said regional Gov. Murat Kumpilov, although the company said its warehouse wasn't

damaged.

In all, four Ozon premises appeared to have been targeted.

Meanwhile, Ukraine's General Staff said its forces struck the Russian state-owned Kameletsky Combine defense company in the Rostov region overnight, starting a fire. The plant produces rocket and missile fuel, it said.

Russia's Defense Ministry said its air defenses overnight intercepted and destroyed 351 Ukrainian drones over eight Russian regions, the Crimean Peninsula and the Azov and Black seas. Moscow illegally annexed Crimea in 2014.

The ministry also said its forces overnight struck Ukrainian ports and vessels delivering military cargo.

Russia has also turned its sights on Ukrainian shopping malls, supermarkets and gas stations in recent months. Russian drones struck a shopping center in central Ukraine in a daytime attack Friday, killing 16 people and wounding 130, Ukrainian officials said.

Ukraine's southern Odesa region came under a large-scale Russian missile and drone attack Monday, with food storage facilities and energy infrastructure among the targets, regional authorities reported.

Eighteen people, including two children, were injured in a Russian drone strike on Chernihiv in northern Ukraine, according to Ukraine's Emergency Service.

It was not possible to independently verify each side's reports.



Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelenskyy hands over the flag of a military unit during the ceremony to mark Ukraine's independence.

DIGEST

SOUTH KOREA
U.S. military will not take part in exercises

The United States will not join South Korea in large-scale amphibious landing exercises next month because of demands in the Middle East, the South Korean military said Monday — raising further questions about the sustainability of U.S. military commitments in Asia as the Iran war strains resources.

The U.S. Marine Corps informed its South Korean counterparts in June that in light of "the situation in the Middle East," the U.S. wouldn't participate in the Ssangyong, or "Twin Dragon," exercises carried out every two years, said Han Seung-jeon, a South Korean marine corps spokesman, at a Monday news briefing.

He said the two countries are discussing the eventual resumption of the exercises. The U.S. Marine Corps did not immediately respond to a request for comment. The announcement comes after the aircraft carrier USS George Washington departed its home base in the Pacific Ocean and arrived in the Arabian Sea to replace the USS Abraham Lincoln.

Earlier this month, President Donald Trump said he directed the Pentagon to "substantially reduce" joint military exercises with South Korea, citing costs and his "very good relationship" with North Korean leader Kim Jong Un. Trump said such exercises send a "totally inappropriate and hostile" signal to North Korea, which he said "has been unthreatening and respectful" during his tenure.

— *Sammy Westfall*

TURKEY
Five mayors convicted on corruption charges

A Turkish court on Monday convicted five mayors of municipalities run by the country's main opposition party on corruption charges in a trial that critics have denounced as politically motivated.

The case before an Istanbul court included allegations of bribery, bid-rigging and fraud in relation to municipal contracts. Critics of the government of Turkish President Recep Tayyip Erdogan say the trial targeted the opposition Republican People's Party, or CHP, and that the prosecution relied on secret witnesses and defendants implicating other defendants in return for lighter punishment.

The Turkish government

insists the country's judiciary is independent and free from political influence.

The case focused on allegations that companies controlled by businessman Aziz Ihsan Aktas secured municipal tenders through bribery, bid-rigging and fraud. The opposition, meanwhile, has said that municipalities under Erdogan's party control that did business with Aktas were not as thoroughly investigated.

Of the five convicted, the mayor of Istanbul's Besiktas district, Riza Akpolat, received the harshest sentence of 23 years and three months for accepting bribes, money laundering and bid-rigging. The sentences of the four others — who like Akpolat were removed from their posts following their arrests — ranged between five and eight years.

— *Associated Press*

HAITI
Multiple people are killed in gang attack

A powerful gang coalition attacked a once peaceful farming community nestled in the hills above Haiti's capital, killing multiple people, an official told the Associated Press on Monday.

Kenscoff Mayor Jean Massillon said armed men raided the community late Sunday, setting fire to homes and killing residents.

Wails filled the air in Kenscoff as survivors found the bodies of friends and family strewn on the streets early Monday.

One man flung himself on the side of the road, head on his right arm as he cried on the ground. Nearby, people picked up the bodies of those killed.

Robert Jean recalled how he

heard shooting before dawn and tried to rouse people from their sleep to escape being killed.

He said he was frantically looking for his brother, who was killed.

Farmer Mathurin Pierre, 41, told the AP that he lost 14 loved ones and that an unknown number remain missing.

Massillon blamed the attack on members of Viv Ansanm, which the U.S. government designated as a foreign terrorist organization last year.

He said gang members targeted a church and homes including those owned by Jean "Bill" Pape. He is a renowned doctor who runs a nongovernmental organization in Haiti that helps patients including those with HIV and tuberculosis.

No further details about the attack were available.

— *Associated Press*

Bessent unveils sweeping new Iran economic sanctions, delays toughest blow

IRAN FROM A1

during a news conference at the Treasury Department in Washington. “We do not have infinite patience here.”

Asked why the U.S. isn’t imposing widespread sanctions right away, Bessent said the administration wants to give countries an “opportunity to remedy bad behavior.”

“Why would I want to blow up the global financial system?” Bessent said. “We believe that a warning shot and a level-set of expectations is appropriate.”

Some independent specialists found Monday’s announcement underwhelming, especially after days of increasingly bellicose warnings from Trump and Bessent about mounting an “economic D-Day” against Iran and its commercial partners. In an opinion piece published Sunday in the Financial Times, Bessent wrote that the United States had “significantly dismantled Iran’s military capabilities and weakened its nuclear programme” and on Monday would launch the “single greatest financial offensive ever marshalled against an adversary.”

But Bessent left unresolved what many analysts see as a key issue: whether the administration is prepared to take on China one month before President Xi Jinping is due in Washington for an official state visit.

“I think the big question is going to be whether they’re willing to do something that crosses the red line of the China trade truce. And if not, you know, this is ultimately not going to be successful,” said Matt Swinehart, a former Treasury official who served under presidents of both parties and is now with Rock Creek Global Advisors in Washington.

The administration’s plan to pressure foreign leaders directly is likely to pay off, he said. But genuine progress will come only if the U.S. penalizes privately owned Chinese oil refineries, known as “teapots,” and the large Chinese banks that facilitate Beijing’s purchases of Iranian oil, Swinehart said.

Asked whether Chinese banks would be among those hit with the punishing financial measures, Bessent replied that “no



JULIA DEMAREE NIKHINSON/AP

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said that “total financial isolation” of Iran could make U.S. force unnecessary.

one is above the reach of U.S. sanctions.”

Swinehart said Monday’s announcement seemed to be a sign that the administration had all but exhausted its weapons for confronting Iran. “It’s only now that I think the administration has realized it doesn’t have a lot of other options,” he said. “You do have to wonder why they didn’t do this before.”

Adam Smith, who worked on Iran sanctions in the Obama administration, said Bessent’s strategy could be effective: Intense pressure on Iran’s financial lifelines ultimately produced the 2015 nuclear deal with the U.S.

“If even some of what Bessent said comes true, this is a significant increase of pressure. If this goes on — plus the physical blockade — it could actually have

an impact,” said Smith, now a partner at Gibson Dunn, a global law firm.

The question is how other entities view Bessent’s “warning shot,” said Rachel Ziemba, an adjunct senior fellow at the Center for a New American Security, a bipartisan nonprofit focused on national security.

“It’s not clear to me that the rhetoric matches with the will- ingness to implement,” she said. “There aren’t a lot of good additional options on more economic pressure on Iran because all of them come with economic or geostrategic costs.”

Monday was not the first time the Trump administration has said that it was dialing up pressure on Iran. Trump has repeatedly put sanctions on foreign companies involved in the oil

trade that represents Iran’s principal source of revenue, even as his military campaign against Tehran has flirted with stalemate.

During Trump’s first term, the U.S. employed what he called a “maximum pressure” sanctions campaign against the Islamic republic. And for the past year — long before February’s military attack — the administration has carried out “Operation Economic Fury” in hopes of forcing Iran to submit to American demands to give up its nuclear weapons program.

More broadly, some U.S. sanctions against Iran date back to 1979, when the Islamic republic took U.S. diplomats hostage and held them for 444 days.

Over the years, sanctions have become an almost reflexive tool

of American power, a way to accomplish foreign policy goals that Washington is unable or unwilling to attempt with military force. But it carries a mixed record of success.

Among the 37 sanctions programs administered by Treasury’s Office of Foreign Assets Control, the oldest targets Cuba. President Dwight D. Eisenhower first imposed financial sanctions on the island’s communist government in 1960. His successor, President John F. Kennedy, broadened them into a full trade embargo. Though its economy is a wreck and its people lack routine access to electricity and other essentials, Cuba today remains under communist rule.

In Tehran, Iranian Parliament Speaker Mohammad Baqer Qalibaf on Monday dismissed Wash-

ington’s threats as “big talk” and predicted that Iran’s trade partners would not comply with U.S. sanctions.

“Iran’s trade partners have also announced to us, both through the media and by sending messages, that they regard these statements as utterly meaningless,” Qalibaf said in a Farsi-language post on his X account.

Before Bessent’s news conference, Iranian Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi also mocked the treasury secretary’s claims that Iran’s military capability had been dismantled.

“You say ... 100% of military factories destroyed, and the nuclear program buried,” Gharibabadi wrote on social media. “Yet for the very same Iran, the largest financial offensive in history and the mobilization of all U.S. agencies and authorities have become necessary! Is this a victory or an admission of U.S. defeat?”

The war has reached a near-stalemate in recent weeks, even as a ceasefire agreement expired last week. The hostilities have for months disrupted shipping through the Strait of Hormuz, a key channel through which around 20 percent of the world’s oil moved before the war.

That disruption has pushed up oil and gas prices in the lead-up to the midterm elections in early November, in which Republicans are hoping to maintain control of the House and Senate. Most Americans disapprove of the war, polls show, contributing to record low approval ratings for Trump.

This weekend, Mohsen Rezaei, the head of Iran’s national security council, vowed that “not a single drop of oil” will be exported through the Persian Gulf if the U.S.-led “economic war continues.”

“Iran will regard any country’s participation in or support for America’s economic war against the Iranian people as an act of war,” he wrote on X.

Iran’s currency hit a record low Monday, and skyrocketing inflation has made life unaffordable for many Iranians. But Iran’s threats against ships transiting the Strait of Hormuz have helped to maintain the country’s leverage.

Trump dives into U.N. leader race

U.N. SECRETARY FROM A1

U.N. insider, one of several who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss the secret voting process.

“They have until the end of December,” said a second person familiar with the process and its backroom machinations. The question, this person said, is “does [Trump] come in at some point — everybody at the U.N. is waiting for this — and say, ‘I want ... Infantino, [or] his daughter [or son-in-law Jared] Kushner.’ ... Then the whole process gets set back as somebody figures out the politics of backing him down.”

One senior U.S. official acknowledged deep U.S. involvement but said that the interviews were more akin to “conversations,” adding that the administration does not have a preferred candidate among current or possible future nominees.

“We want the best candidate. Period,” said the official, who spoke on the condition of anonymity about internal administration deliberations and the closed-door selection process. “We’re not focused on anything that would limit the most talented people around the globe from putting their names up.”

While they may differ on how it is done, few member states disagree with the need for reform. “This particular race is different from all the others,” said Peter Yeo, senior vice president of the U.N. Foundation and a longtime expert on U.S.-U.N. relations.

“Fundamental questions are being asked about the future role of the organization ... what the U.N. does, what is its mandate, what programs it should be running, how it should be financed,” Yeo said. “It’s not just the United States asking.”

Trump, who has denigrated a host of international organizations, has sharply criticized the U.N. as ineffective, wasteful and out of tune with U.S. priorities. He has canceled U.S. membership and voluntary donations to many of its agencies — most prominently the World Health Organization — while U.S. humanitarian and development aid has been shunted away from international programs toward bilateral assistance that reflects “America First” priorities.

Annual member dues to the regular U.N. budget are assessed according to a formula that in-

cludes gross national product and population, and the U.S. has long been the biggest contributor. But until recently, the Trump administration had paid nothing while it pushed for severe budget cuts and organizational changes.

Early this year, as Guterres warned that the U.N. faced “imminent financial collapse,” the administration paid about \$160 million of last year’s more than \$800 million assessment, according to the U.S. official. On Aug. 4, following staff and budget cuts in which the U.S. was heavily involved, the administration notified Congress that it intends to pay \$725 million of this year’s dues.

Technically, the secretary general is elected by a majority vote in the 193-member General Assembly. But only once, in 1950, has there been more than one person on the ballot delivered to the assembly by the 15-member Security Council. The council’s approval requires at least nine votes, though each of the five permanent members — the U.S., Russia, China, Britain and France — has veto power.

It has long been agreed that the secretary general should not be from one of the permanent five members, who already wield tremendous power with their vetoes, and that the position will rotate among different regions of the world. Since the U.N. was founded in 1945, some of the nine who have held the office, including Guterres, have served two consecutive five-year terms. Africa, Asia and Europe have had multiple chances, but only one secretary general has come from Latin America — Peru’s Javier Pérez de Cuéllar, who served from 1982 to 1991.

All five of the currently nominated women are Latin Americans, as is one of the three men. The other two men are from Africa. All are former U.N. or national officials in their home governments, or both, and most have campaigned strenuously for the job.

Beginning this summer, council members are periodically holding secret straw votes in which they “encourage,” “discourage” or offer no opinion on each candidate. In officially un- released but widely disseminated results of the first vote, held in late July, the top three were Rebeca Grynspan, former Costa Rican president and former

head of U.N. Trade and Development; Carolyn Rodrigues Birkett, former foreign minister and current U.N. ambassador from Guyana; and Rafael Mariano Grossi, an Argentine diplomat who has been director general of the U.N.’s International Atomic Energy Agency since 2019.

In a second straw vote Friday, all three were reportedly still out in front, but no one looked like a runaway.

Other nominees include two-time Chilean president and former U.N. High Commissioner for Human Rights Michelle Bachelet, former Ecuadorian foreign minister and president of the General Assembly María Fernanda Espinosa, former Senegal president and prime minister Macky Sall, and Ugandan politician and diplomat Olara Otunnu. Last week, former Ecuadorian diplomat Ivonne A-Baki entered the race, nominated by the Pacific island nation of Tonga (since Ecuador already had a candidate).

So far, said the U.N. insider, “the selection is sinking into the murky waters of Security Council politics.”

Russia and China may want to stick a finger in the eye of the U.S., and vice versa, with a veto of a favored candidate, experts said.

“Rumors are that the U.K. is not well disposed about Grossi” because of residual British sparring with Argentina over the 1982 Falklands War, said Brett D. Schaefer, a senior fellow at the American Enterprise Institute. The U.S. has previously indicated that it does not favor Bachelet because of a perceived closeness to China. Russia is also said to be “unenthusiastic about Grossi” because of the IAEA’s stances on its ally Iran and enemy Ukraine, Schaefer said.

Because any one of the five permanent members can kill a candidacy, closure won’t near until the Security Council switches from straw polls to colored ballots, when a red card indicates a definitive veto. That probably won’t happen until some time after the annual high-level General Assembly attended by heads of governments next month.

“I don’t see anybody on this list that has enough ‘encourages’ to get elected,” Schaefer said. “You’re likely not seeing the [next] secretary general among these current candidates.”

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Workers in China worry over being replaced as they adapt to AI on jobs

BY CHAN HO-HIM
AND FU TING
Associated Press

HONG KONG — Computer programmer Fei Zhaojun's boss asked him if artificial intelligence could soon replace humans in coding jobs. Two weeks later, he was laid off from his job in Beijing, together with about 160 of his colleagues.

It's an increasingly common scenario as artificial intelligence, supported by government policies, reshapes China's massive job market. Some economists believe that might eventually undermine the overall strength of the world's second largest economy.

Rapid adoption of AI in many fields, from computer programmers to script writing and physical tasks, is pushing people out of their jobs or leaving them afraid that it might. China is at the vanguard of AI adoption as government policies encourage people and businesses to use AI applications and robotics in all aspects of life, so people like Fei are figuring out how to adapt.

"There appears to be far less anti-AI sentiment in China [than elsewhere]. Most people seem either positive, neutral, or mildly interested in AI," said Shujing He, a Beijing-based senior analyst at advisory and research firm Plenum.

"Individuals who worry about being replaced, as well as those who have already left traditional workplaces, are often eager to experiment with AI-enabled businesses and independent ventures," she said. "The level of interest is striking."

Until recently, Fei had doubted AI could do programming work perfectly, even though his bosses thought it was close enough.

"Mid-level coders' job are essentially replaceable in most of the cases," said Fei, 40. "Even if it is a disaster that leads to replacing all humans, at this stage, you just have to use it as everyone else is using it."

Now he is making vlog-style short videos during a career break while figuring out what he wants to do next. He is not making a living off of his videos, which are about ordinary people's lives, but hopes that they might help others.

Du Qinchun, a part-time translator, has been helping to train an AI model to do translations. That's brought him more work, at least temporarily.

"But it's true that the pay in the industry has been cut by more than half compared to what it was years ago," said Du, who is based in southwestern China's Chengdu city.

The trend is so evident that popular college programs in foreign languages have increasingly fallen out of favor as AI-powered translation tools have become more widespread.

The share of Chinese industrial enterprises saying they use AI models and "agents" jumped to 47.5 percent last year from 9.6 percent in 2024, according to the market intelligence firm IDC.

"China's vibrant open-source model ecosystem fosters greater AI application innovation in industrial settings, gradually



A man walks by as workers rest near a board promoting Artificial Intelligence at the China International Supply Chain Expo in Beijing on June 25.



Wang Zhicheng hold his book at a coffee shop in Beijing on Aug. 4.

closing the gap between foundational model capabilities and real-world enterprise value creation," said Yanze Du, an IDC senior research manager in Beijing.

Humanoid robots can now, for example, sort parcels in postal centers, although still on a small-scale basis, and are pushing the boundaries in performing more human tasks such as directing traffic and making coffee. Food delivery robots are

also gaining ground across the country, potentially threatening the livelihoods of millions of Chinese food delivery workers.

Generative AI increasingly is used for creation, production and distribution in China's short drama industry. The number of live-action short and vertical video series designed for mobile phones fell about 75 percent in the first quarter of this year from a year earlier, according to Chinese media reports.

"Tasks that once required specialized training can now be performed by almost anyone with access to AI tools. This is particularly evident in software development and multimedia creation," said Plenum's He. "As a result, workers whose roles are narrowly concentrated in these areas may face greater displacement risk."

A report from International Labor Organization, meanwhile, found that women face higher risks of losing employment because of the use of AI than men, as they tend to work in areas more suitable for automation, such as assembling electronics, and remain underrepresented in science and technology.

Under China's "AI Plus" initiative and its five-year plan through 2030, the government is pushing to infuse AI across many industries, aiming to gain an edge in China's technology rivalry with the United States.

"What is specific to China is that the government is really into diffusing AI across the economy, so AI may get into different domains more quickly comparing to other countries," said Zilan Qian, a research associate at Oxford China Policy Lab.

China's economic growth has already been slowing. Consumer spending has lagged partly due to people becoming reluctant to spend because they're worried about losing their jobs. It's add-

ed to problems stemming from a prolonged downturn in the housing market that has undermined household wealth.

China's tech industries may be innovative with high productivity, but they may not generate many new jobs, said Eswar Prasad, a professor of economics and trade policy at Cornell University.

"AI is likely to lift productivity across the board but could have a severe disruptive effect on employment, worsening the employment growth problem and resulting in a detrimental effect on social stability," he said.

Similar to their U.S. rivals, Chinese tech giants have cut or restructured tens of thousands of jobs, partly due to AI. The outlook for the broader jobs market remains uncertain: China's overall urban unemployment rate hovers around 5 percent, but unemployment for people 16 to 24, excluding students, is roughly triple that.

That said, in the longer run, some experts say unemployment rates could fall, since China's population of 1.4 billion is rapidly aging and shrinking.

By 2050, China is projected to have fewer than two working-age adults to support each retiree, compared with more than 2.5 in the U.S., said Xuenan Cao, a professor at San Francisco Bay University whose focus includes technology and society.

"Automation could partial-

ly offset a shrinking workforce rather than being purely a threat to it," Cao said.

Wang Zhicheng, 32, often used AI for brainstorming and fact-checking in his previous job as a scriptwriter for a company that produces 3D animated educational videos and interactive exercises for children.

After its parent company laid off roughly half of its 13 script writers, he chose to resign and work independently, making illustrated children's books.

While AI sometimes saved time the scripts it generated, they often felt strange, Wang said. Episodes tended to be repetitive and formulaic and the level of detail devoted to knowledge varied widely.

"You can treat AI as a tool just like [Microsoft] Word," said Wang, who has started his own studio making picture books and other creative works. "Humans are still the decision-makers on which one to pick or pursue among all that AI generates."

High school chemistry teacher Yang Zheng said he does not consider AI as a threat to his job even though students use AI for help with their homework.

"Teachers cannot be there all the time," he said. "It is a good thing for students as it generates in real-time so that students can ask follow-up questions," said Yang, 29. "It often gets things wrong, but it improves over time."



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ECONOMY & BUSINESS

Sales rebound at Target amid a merchandise overhaul

The retailer says it is working to reduce prices on more goods

BY ANNE D'INNOCENZIO
Associated Press

NEW YORK — Target reported its second straight quarter of comparable sales gains last week, saying that a merchandising overhaul under the retailer's new CEO is attracting more customers and boosting sales throughout its stores.

The retailer also benefited from a tariff refund of \$994 million after the Supreme Court ruled this year that the Trump administration had overstepped its authority when the tariffs were implemented.

There is a lot of interest in how tariff refunds from the U.S. government will impact retailers and whether those refunds will be used to lower prices for customers.

Chief Financial Officer Jim Lee, when asked about tariff refunds this past week, said the company continues to invest in lowering prices. Target reduced the prices of more than 10,000 items over the past year, and “there’s more to come even as we’re facing headwinds overall,” Lee said.

Comparable sales, those coming from stores and digital channels operating for at least 12 months, rose 3.8 percent in the second quarter. The company also upgraded its annual profit and sales outlook, citing the solid performance during the first half of the year.

Target is emerging from more than a year of weak comparable sales. A 5.6 percent jump in the first quarter offset a 3.8 percent decline in 2025. The second-quarter gain followed a 1.9 percent drop a year ago.

Target CEO Michael Fiddelke, a 20-year company veteran who became chief executive in February, said the latest quarter was “an important step forward in the plan we laid out earlier this year to open a new chapter of growth for Target.”

Target also reported an increase in the number of customers going to its stores and shopping on its website from May through July.

“We’re encouraged by the progress made so far, and we’re also clear-eyed about the important work still ahead,” Fiddelke said.

In March, Fiddelke unveiled a \$6 billion plan to reverse Target’s sales slump and to reclaim the retailer’s reputation as a place to go for affordable yet



PHOTOS BY ELLEN SCHMIDT/AP

Target reported an increase in the number of customers going to its stores and shopping on its website from May through July.

stylish apparel and home goods.

More than half of Target’s back-to-school merchandise is new, the company said.

That includes a limited-time collection of teen and tween clothes, school supplies and accessories in pastel colors and floral prints from the women’s lifestyle brand LoveShack Fancy. Target also collaborated with Hollister on a dorm decor collection.

Target recruited fashion designer and TV personality Isaac Mizrahi this summer to fill the newly created role of creative director at large. Mizrahi has been brought in to mentor Target designers, advise on product design and innovation, and forge new partnerships.

It is Mizrahi’s second partnership with Target. He became the first major fashion designer to collaborate with the retailer in 2002 for a successful run.

Fiddelke is also remodeling Target stores and improving staffing. The company has more than 100 full-scale remodels underway, with a goal of reaching 130 this year, Fiddelke said Tuesday.

During the second quarter, comparable store sales — sales from established physical stores — increased 2.7 percent, while increased same-day deliveries pushed digital comparable sales



More than half of Target’s back-to-school merchandise is new, the company said.

up 8.7 percent.

Target was one of the first big retailers to report second-quarter financial results, which could give industry analysts and economists another read on whether ongoing price pressures from the conflict in Iran impacted consumer behavior.

The Commerce Department released a report this month

showing weak retail sales in July. The University of Michigan’s consumer sentiment index, also released this month, showed greater pessimism about the economy this month, probably driven by stubbornly high prices.

Target’s overall sales increased in all six of its main merchandising categories, led

by double-digit growth in what the company calls Fun 101 — a division that includes consumer electronics, toys, trading cards, sports paraphernalia, books and gaming items.

Target’s beauty and food and beverage sales were also standouts. Target plans to roll out a Target Beauty Studio concept next month in more than 600

locations. The new area, which will offer upscale beauty products and enhanced product expertise from staff, will partly replace its shops with Ulta, which is ending its partnership with the retailer in August, the company said.

On the other side, business in clothing and home goods hardly grew. Target executives said the work to improve these areas is ongoing.

Net income was \$1.87 billion, or \$4.11 per share, for the three months ended Aug. 1, easily beating the \$2.34 per share that Wall Street had expected, according to a survey by FactSet. It also outpaced last year’s \$935 million, or \$2.05 per share. Yet this year also included millions from tariff refunds, which amounted to \$1.65 in earnings per share, Target said.

Net sales rose 5.3 percent to \$26.54 billion for the period.

Target now expects sales to increase 5 percent, up from its earlier predictions for a 4 percent gain. It also expects earnings per share for the full year to be in the range of \$9.90 to \$10.90. Analysts expect \$8.52 per share for the year, according to FactSet.

In May, Target reiterated its guidance from March for earnings per share to be near the high end of \$7.50 to \$8.50.

Treasury yields ease and tech stocks decline on a mixed day on Wall Street

BY STAN CHOE
Associated Press

NEW YORK — Stocks drifted to a mixed finish Monday as the countdown ticks toward potentially market-moving events later in the week. The areas of the bond market that the Treasury Department is trying to calm down, meanwhile, eased a bit.

The S&P 500 slipped 0.3 percent and pulled a bit further from its all-time high set earlier this month. The Dow Jones Industrial Average added 140 points, or 0.3 percent, and the Nasdaq composite fell 0.8 percent.

Tech stocks led the way downward following big swings through the summer on worries

that the frenzy around artificial-intelligence technology sent prices too high and that the huge demand for AI chips won’t be sustainable if they don’t produce enough profits.

Chip giant Nvidia has been a tremendous winner of the AI boom and become Wall Street’s largest and most influential stock because of it. It will deliver its latest quarterly earnings report Wednesday, which could dictate the next big move for AI-related stocks.

Nvidia sank 2.9 percent and was the heaviest weight on the S&P 500, where the majority of stocks rose. Drops of 5.8 percent for Micron Technology and 2.6 percent for Broadcom also

helped drag the index lower.

All told, the S&P 500 fell 21.51 points to 7,652.86. The Dow Jones Industrial Average rose 140.15 to 53,417.16, and the Nasdaq composite sank 200.26 to 25,980.19.

The other big factor moving stocks recently has been the bond market, where longer-term Treasury yields climbed through the summer on worries about high inflation, huge government debts and other factors. High yields make it more expensive for everyone to borrow, not just the government, and have already pushed up mortgage rates and hurt the housing industry.

The Treasury Department announced a surprise move

last week to increase the size of planned buybacks of Treasuries, which could help contain the rise in yields for 10- and 30-year Treasuries. But analysts warned the move may have only a limited effect because of how small the size of the buybacks are and how they do not fix the fundamental problems of too-high debt for the U.S. government and expensive oil prices because of the war with Iran.

On Monday, the yield of the 10-year Treasury eased to 4.70 percent from 4.74 percent late Friday and is back below where it was late Tuesday, before Treasury made its surprise announcement.

Helping to bring yields down

on Monday was a drop in oil prices. Brent crude fell 2.3 percent to \$90.54 per barrel.

Last month it zigzagged between \$72 and \$102 as hopes rose and fell that the United States and Iran could reach a deal that would allow oil tankers to freely exit the Persian Gulf again. The United States on Monday announced new sanctions aimed at Iran, which helped drag the value of Iran’s currency to a record low against the U.S. dollar.

Despite Monday’s easing of Treasury yields, analysts warn the U.S. government’s attempts to influence the bond market could ultimately mean higher pressure on inflation. Inflation already is worse than nearly ev-

eryone would like and has been for years.

That raises the pressure on the Federal Reserve to raise the federal funds rate, which affects very short-term overnight loans. When the Fed raises that rate, it could help keep a lid on inflation by trying to slow the overall economy and undercutting prices for stocks and other investments.

The Fed’s new chairman, Kevin Warsh, is set to deliver a speech Friday in Jackson Hole, Wyoming. The mountain setting has been the backdrop for major Fed policy announcements in the past, but investors are unsure of what they may get from Warsh this time around.

DIGEST

SOCIAL MEDIA

U.K. urges TikTok to remove ‘awful content’

Britain’s government Monday urged TikTok and other social media companies to take down viral videos “celebrating” dangerous driving, after two police officers and five young men were killed in a crash when a car was driven down the wrong side of the road.

Officers Matthew Blades and Tom Clough were killed Saturday when a Volkswagen was driven the wrong way along a road in northeastern England and hit their vehicle. Five people in the car — three boys who were 17 and 18 years old and two men, both 23 — were also pronounced dead at the scene.

The collision took place as concerns grow over social media videos showing people driving dangerously on purpose, posted by the drivers themselves or others inside the vehicles at the time.

British media reports suggest that one of the people who died in the Volkswagen on Saturday may have previously posted such a video.

U.K. Defense Minister Luke Pollard said the government has told TikTok and similar platforms to “step up” and remove such “awful content.”

Prime Minister Andy Burnham’s office said “the glorification of dangerous driving for clips and entertainment is utterly disgraceful.”

It said the U.K. media regulator has the government’s full

backing to take tough action against platforms that fail in their legal duties.

TikTok did not comment but said its policies strictly prohibit content that could cause significant physical harm.

— Associated Press

PRODUCT SAFETY

Drops recalled over contamination fears

Nearly 40,000 bottles of drops for itchy and dry eyes were recalled beginning last month because of “potential contamination,” according to the Food and Drug Administration.

The voluntary recall of Clear Eyes Maximum Itchy Eye Relief 0.5-fluid-ounce bottles began July 29 and was issued by

Prestige Consumer Healthcare, which is the parent company of Clear Eyes, because of a “lack of assurance of sterility,” according to a notice posted by the FDA.

The recall was due to a potential for contamination identified during the manufacturing process, according to Phil Terpolilli, a spokesman for Prestige Consumer Healthcare, and the product was not confirmed to be contaminated.

“We initiated this voluntary recall out of an abundance of caution and our commitment to providing consumers with safe, high-quality products,” Terpolilli wrote in an email, adding that no serious adverse events have been reported as of Monday.

The FDA has listed the recall as Class II, which means the use or exposure to a product “may

cause temporary or medically reversible” health issues and is unlikely to cause serious health consequences. The expiration date of the recalled drops is Sept. 30, 2027.

— Rachel Roubein

TESLA

Tesla has stopped selling premium solar roof tiles on its website

nearly a decade after CEO Elon Musk launched the product as a more attractive alternative to panels. Tesla’s solar roof URL now redirects to a solar panels offering. Musk unveiled the roof tiles in 2016 as Tesla sought to acquire SolarCity, the solar installer run by his cousins. The company in 2021 had targeted 1,000 installations per week, but industry estimates said the actual figure was far less. Musk still has big ambitions in solar. Tesla

filed plans in Texas this month for a \$10.1 billion solar-cell factory outside Houston that would create 9,712 permanent jobs.

PRESIDENT DONALD TRUMP

invested as much as \$50,000 in Elon Musk’s SpaceX in June, according to a public financial disclosure

giving him a financial stake in a major government contractor run by his former adviser. He bought between \$15,001 and \$50,000 in shares June 23, according to a financial disclosure signed by him Aug. 12 and made public Aug. 22. The purchase was part of more than 1,000 stock trades the president made in June. SpaceX priced the biggest-ever U.S. IPO on June 12, valuing the space, satellite and AI provider at \$1.77 trillion.

— From news services



People arrive at the U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services field office in Miami in 2018.

Administration proposes charging \$103,000 fee for H-1B visas for hiring skilled foreign workers

President Trump contends program takes jobs from Americans

BY TED HESSON AND LAUREN KAORI GURLEY

The Trump administration plans to charge employers seeking skilled foreign workers through the H-1B visa program a \$103,265 fee, a proposed regulation posted on Monday says.

Revenue from the fee would be used to run the legal immigration system, the document says, including funding for federal immigration courts and U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement.

President Donald Trump's administration argues that the H-1B program has been used to take jobs away from Americans and that the current system fails to prioritize the most exceptional foreign workers. Trump tried to implement a similar \$100,000 fee last year through a presidential proclamation, but it was invalidated by a federal judge in June.

The H-1B program, created by Congress in 1990, provides employers with visas for 65,000 skilled foreign workers annually, with another 20,000 visas available for workers with advanced degrees from U.S. universities.

The proposed regulation contends the new fee would make employers "less likely to hire an H-1B worker over a qualified

and highly-skilled American." The regulation cites a working paper in the National Bureau of Economic Research that found H-1B workers made, on average, about 15 percent less than American counterparts.

In the June ruling against the fee, U.S. District Judge Leo T. Sorokin of Massachusetts said the president unilaterally imposed an illegal tax, bypassing Congress, and failed to consider the impact of his actions on sectors experiencing labor shortages that rely on the H-1B program to hire physicians, nurses and teachers.

The Trump administration appealed the ruling to the U.S. Court of Appeals for the 1st Circuit and requested it be paused pending the appeal, but the request was denied in late July.

The new proposed regulation, set to formally publish in the Federal Register on Tuesday, seeks to carve a different legal path by proposing to use the fees to offset the cost of running the immigration system. It exempts some groups, such as most U.S. colleges, universities and nonprofit hospitals affiliated with academic institutions. But unlike last year's proposal, it would apply to many people who already reside in the United States, not just those submitting petitions from abroad.

"This makes it much broader," said Jeremy Neufeld, director of immigration policy at the Institute for Progress, a nonpartisan think tank.

The proposed rule would restrict a major pathway for foreign guest workers that is

widely used by Silicon Valley tech companies, among other businesses. Industry critics say that the fee would diminish the United States' competitive edge against China, India and other countries in a variety of research and tech industries, as well as harm a number of industries that depend on foreign professionals.

"This is again an illegal tax," said Charles Kuck, who practices immigration law in Atlanta.

Amazon has received the most H-1B visas in recent years, with more than 9,300 approved petitions in fiscal year 2026 through June 30, according to U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services data.

Other top users of the H-1B program in 2026 have been India-based IT and outsourcing companies Tata Consultancy Services and Infosys, followed by American tech companies Apple and Microsoft.

Neufeld said expanding the fee requirement to applicants already in the United States could lead to a significant reduction in the number of H-1B petitions that companies request.

"I would be very surprised if even large companies pay this fee for many of their H-1Bs," he said.

Sorokin's decision to strike down Trump's original \$100,000 H-1B visa fee came in response to a lawsuit from 20 states, led by California and Massachusetts.

The U.S. Chamber of Commerce and an association of top research universities in a separate lawsuit last year criticized

Trump's earlier fee, saying H-1B workers fill critical jobs in the medical, manufacturing and technology fields.

The federal judge in that case sided with the Trump administration in December, leading the Chamber of Commerce and university association to appeal.

The administration estimates the new proposed regulation would generate an estimated \$8.8 billion annually.

Nearly \$3 billion would go to the federal immigration courts and be used to support more than 8,400 hires, including immigration court judges.

ICE, already funded to historic levels, would receive roughly \$1 billion to pay for vetting of immigration applications and the administration of the student visa program, the proposed regulation says.

It says U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services would use the money to offset \$3 billion in existing costs, and several other agencies involved in immigration processing would also receive funds.

The public will have 30 days to comment on the new proposed regulation following its publication to the Federal Register on Tuesday, the proposal says. It can take months or even years to finalize regulations.

U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services generally does not refund filing fees, including when a visa petition is denied. The proposed regulation does not address whether the new \$103,265 fee would be refundable, and the agency did not respond to a request for comment.

Canadian PM Carney is facing his biggest test

CANADA FROM A1

son said, "the frustration of dealing with these guys was palpable."

Carney said last week his government was ending trade negotiations with the Trump administration rather than accepting a mounting list of concessions. He has urged other world leaders to join him in a united front against U.S. economic coercion. They're watching now to see what happens next.

Countries such as Canada and China are "showing that you can stand up to the U.S." in trade talks, said Carl Bildt, a former prime minister of Sweden.

He expects the approach to prompt "a discreet discussion in the E.U. and Japan on whether they did the right thing."

David Eby, the premier of British Columbia, told CNN he hoped "at some point the rest of the world will say enough."

by about 2.5 percent.

But in the long run, Tombe calculates, they could cost Canada nearly 90,000 jobs.

Each side has blamed the other for the collapse of negotiations.

Carney says the U.S. made an offer he had to refuse.

The administration introduced last-minute provisions to limit Ottawa's freedom to make trade deals with other countries, he said, an "unacceptable" surrender of Canadian sovereignty.

U.S. negotiators also sought to curb the promotion of Canadian or French-language content on platforms such as Netflix, he said, and mandatory product labeling in French, which, with English, is one of the country's two official languages.

Carney is also responding to Canadian frustration with Trump's threats and insults, including repeated comments about making Canada the 51st state.

Christine Fréchet, the premier of French-speaking Québec, renewed calls on Saturday to buy Canadian goods. Fans in Vancouver and Montreal booed the U.S. national anthem before Major League Soccer games over the weekend, the Canadian Press reported.

According to Dan Kelly, president of the Canadian Federation of Independent Business, the new tariffs would hit 40 percent of small Canadian exporters, including those selling machinery, building products, food and jewelry.

"Tit-for-tat tariffs, he warned, hit "small firms hard." He called Carney's retaliatory levies "an understandable response from our government."

Eby, who is not a member of Carney's party, said accepting the U.S. demands would have meant reducing Canada to "the economic equivalent of the 51st state."

Trump's trade wars and annexation threats have fueled efforts by U.S. partners around the world to curb security and economic dependence on Washington. But many have conceded that decoupling is a long and messy process, and have instead attempted concessions and conciliation.

As tensions escalated in recent days, Carney acknowledged that the risks of pushing back. Canada is retaliating "reluctantly," he said, "because we recognize that it will raise costs and reduce choice for Canadians."

At the same time, he said, it was in the country's best interests.

"Last spring, I warned that America is trying to break us so that they can own us," Carney said Saturday. And I promised: "That will never, ever happen." We are keeping that promise."

Trump announces tariffs on Canadian vehicles, steel in upping of trade war

BY DAVID J. LYNCH

President Donald Trump on Monday said he would impose higher tariffs on additional Canadian products beginning Jan. 1, in a sign that his trade war with Canada is intensifying following this weekend's collapse of negotiations between the two nations.

"Canada has been ripping off the United States of America for years. Their ridiculously high tariffs on our Farmers and farm products has made life impossible for these great American Patriots," Trump wrote in a post on his social media site, Truth Social. He added, "On January First, 2027, Tariffs on all Cars, Trucks, both large and small, Automotive Parts, and Steel, will be increased to 50%."

The more than four-month delay in the tariffs' effective date leaves time for negotiations to resume between the once-close allies.

Relations have soured since the failure of talks this weekend aimed at averting an earlier batch of Trump tariffs, a 50 percent duty on goods including hockey sticks, beer and whisky. After the U.S. tariffs took effect early Saturday, Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney said his nation had been "attacked" by the United States and was "at war." The Canadian leader said Canada would retaliate with tariffs of its own on U.S. products beginning Sept. 8.

In his social media post, Trump lambasted Canada as "among the worst Nations in the

World to deal with."

Canadian soldiers have fought alongside Americans in every major war since World War I.

Trump wrongly said the U.S. ran a \$60 billion annual trade deficit with Canada. In fact, the annual shortfall is \$48 billion. Most economists say that bilateral trade deficits are of little economic significance.

"WE DON'T NEED CANADA, THEY NEED U.S.! They do 95% of their business with the U.S., with us, the exact opposite!" the

"Canada has been ripping off the United States of America for years."

President Donald Trump,
writing in a post on his social media site on Monday

president added.

U.S. farmers rely on Canadian suppliers for nearly 80 percent of the potash fertilizer they use each year. Northern border states, including New York, Michigan, Vermont, Minnesota and Maine, run on electricity produced by Canadian hydropower. And Midwestern refineries are optimized to process heavy sour crude oil from Canadian wells, which keeps U.S. gas prices lower than they otherwise would be.



Rolled coils of steel sit in the yard at the ArcelorMittal Dofasco steel plant in Hamilton, Ontario, this month.

NICK IWANYSHYN/CANADIAN PRESS/AP

TUESDAY OPINION

Syria’s leaders need to prove they can be trusted

BY ILAN BERMAN

Washington’s rehabilitation of Syria has proceeded at remarkable speed. Over the past several months, the United States has dismantled much of the sanctions architecture that isolated the country for years, restored diplomatic engagement with Damascus and begun exploring new avenues of security cooperation with the fledgling government of Syrian President Ahmed al-Sharaa.

The logic is understandable. The fall of Bashar al-Assad’s regime in December 2024 at the hands of opposition forces spearheaded by Sharaa’s Hay’at Tahrir al-Sham presented the U.S. with an irresistible opportunity. It created an opening to pull Syria out of Iran’s orbit, where it had been nestled for decades under the rule of first Hafez al-Assad and then his son Bashar. It also held out the potential for a stabilization of the deeply fractured state, if a more pragmatic government were to truly take hold.

That wager may yet pay off. Indeed, recent days have seen new signs of cooperation between Syria and the United Nations’ nuclear watchdog. Still, it is becoming increasingly clear that, at least at the moment, Washington is basing its bet more on hope than hard evidence.

Developments inside Syria suggest the ideological makeup of the country’s new rulers has not changed nearly as much as Western officials might wish to believe. Instead, beneath the new government’s more polished diplomatic messaging lies an Islamist movement that continues to promote many of the same ideas that defined its origins as an al-Qaeda affiliate.

Take education. A new study by the Israeli Alma Research and Education Center think tank details the curriculum of the Dar al-Wahi al-Sharif school network, an educational system affiliated with the ruling HTS. The findings are troubling. According to the report, jihadist ideology and political indoctrination begin as early as kindergarten in network-run schools, which “now operate in major provinces throughout Syria, including Aleppo, Hama, Damascus, Latakia, and Deraa.” Israel is systematically erased from classroom maps and replaced by “Palestine.” Jews and Christians are portrayed as perennial enemies of Islam, and armed jihad against them is presented as a religious obligation.

These are more than isolated examples of intolerance. They reflect an officially sanctioned effort to shape Syria’s next generation according to a radical, rejectionist worldview.

At the same time, Damascus is struggling with another unresolved problem that likewise speaks volumes about the character of Syria’s new order: the disposition of foreign fighters.

Developments suggest the ideological makeup of the country’s new rulers has not changed nearly as much as Western officials might wish to believe.

The Syrian military now contains roughly 5,000 extremists who fought alongside HTS during its successful campaign to topple Assad. Many of them have been accused of abuses against Syria’s minority communities, including extrajudicial killings and instances of sectarian violence. Naturally, the continued presence of these elements on Syrian soil has alarmed neighbors such as Israel and Lebanon, and raised serious questions from the international community about the reliability of Syria’s security apparatus.

The issue, moreover, was supposed to already have been settled. Removing foreign jihadist fighters from Syria’s armed forces was a central American condition for sanctions relief after Assad’s fall. Yet despite major U.S. concessions — including the repeal of the extensive architecture of economic pressure imposed by Congress under the 2019 Caesar Act — Sharaa’s government has made only limited progress in doing so. To the contrary, it has become painfully clear that these fighters remain indispensable to the new Syrian regime’s hold on power precisely because they constitute some of its most loyal and battle-hardened supporters.

These facts are presenting American policy-makers with an uncomfortable reality. The central premise of the Trump administration’s current approach is that engagement will gradually moderate the Syrian government. But moderation is difficult to achieve when a regime’s political survival depends on the support of militants and the dissemination of extreme ideology.

None of this means that the U.S. should abandon engagement altogether. A stable Syria — one independent of Iran, contributing meaningfully to the fight against regional terrorism and protecting its minorities — would advance Washington’s interests in the Middle East. But such normalization needs to be earned, rather than assumed.

Fortunately, Washington and its partners still have considerable leverage over Damascus in the form of economic assistance, defense cooperation, diplomatic recognition and international financial support. These tools should be employed deliberately, with measurable benchmarks tied to genuine reform. Things like the removal of foreign fighters from Syria’s security forces, meaningful protection of religious and ethnic minorities and comprehensive revision of extremist educational materials shouldn’t be aspirational goals. They should be minimum requirements for deeper partnership.

Until they are, Washington needs to proceed with considerably more caution than is currently in evidence.

Ilan Berman is the senior vice president of the American Foreign Policy Council.



SPENCER PLATT/GETTY IMAGES

BY JOHN FICARRA

“I work for free. You pay me to commute.” It was a phrase I repeated to my boss countless times over the years, and with good reason.

Though I live within the bounds of New York City in “the forgotten borough” of Staten Island, my daily commute into Manhattan — a bus ride, a trip on the Staten Island Ferry, the subway to Midtown — took an hour and 40 minutes each way. And that was with perfect connections.

There were never perfect connections. I could count on at least one traffic accident, mechanical breakdown, medical emergency, subway station flooding or “ongoing police investigation” to muck up the beginning or ending of my day. It was demoralizing and exhausting.

I once did the math. Allowing for vacation and holidays, my daily commuting totaled at least 732 hours per year, a staggering 35,136 hours over my 48-year career. Looking back on it, I’m still amazed I survived my misguided (some might say crazy) lifestyle choice.

But there came to be one bright spot in my commute — the 25-minute ride on the Staten Island Ferry.

In 1993, I began riding the boat (which is what Staten Islanders call the ferry) with my good friend and co-worker Amy. Like most seasoned riders, we made the same ferry every morning — ours was at 8:30 — and sat in the same seats. Sitting opposite us would always be the same two fellow commuters, who eventually became known as “Larry Sneakers” and “Dr. Bruce.” One day the

four of us got to talking, and we never stopped.

Occasionally loud and always laughing, we attracted the attention of others around us. Some were obviously annoyed and changed their seats; others were curious and soon joined in the fun.

Over time, our little group of seafarers swelled to about 25, though it was rare that all of us were on board at the same time.

Among our crew was Steve, a lawyer who missed his calling to be a comedy writer but who, nevertheless, did a nice job on my will and condo closing. Also Crazy Peter, a marketing exec who once spent a week in Florida directing a squirrel named Russell in a razor blade commercial for Walmart; Lenny, an environmentalist who kept bees in his backyard until he found out the hard way that he was highly allergic to their sting; Gerard, a sound engineer who ended most of our ferry rides with a stroll through Battery Park sampling what was then a controlled substance; and Jane, an HR administrator with a heart of gold.

We called ourselves the Ferry Posse. We rode together for 25 years, trading jokes, local gossip, recipes, movie recommendations, and the names of reliable contractors and handymen. We celebrated the arrival of children and grandchildren and consoled each other over the loss of loved ones, including one of our own — Anthony, a magazine editor and longtime posse member who retired and bought a country home in Italy, only to die unexpectedly not long after.

We shared three confirmed hookups, one improbable marriage, two coronary procedures, one cancer diagnosis and two divorces, including the

dissolution of the aforementioned improbable marriage.

A group of us watched in horror from the ferry’s deck as black smoke billowed out of the north tower of the World Trade Center the morning of 9/11.

When I retired in December 2018, the posse gathered on the 8:30 boat to say goodbye. Champagne was poured as the two NYPD officers on board looked the other way. Favorite anecdotes were retold, and Crazy Peter tried to present me with a retirement gift of a mounted deer head he had foolishly purchased a few weeks earlier on a whim and was now trying to unload. (I declined his generous offer.)

All too quickly we passed the Statue of Liberty and Ellis Island, and the sight of the Manhattan skyline came into view.

It was our silly tradition that every day one posse member was selected to rise as the boat approached the dock and lead the group off the ferry — our “designated sherpa.” That day, I was the designated sherpa for one last time.

I’m still in touch with many of the posse members, thanks to a group texting thread. Some have moved away; others I still occasionally see in a Staten Island supermarket or park. But whenever any of us ride the ferry, regardless of the time or day, we always sit in the old posse section. If we’re lucky, we run into a fellow member, and rekindle a bit of what made our daily commuting slog a pretty great experience.

John Ficarra was the editor of Mad magazine from 1985 to 2018.

What MAGA fails to understand about Richard Nixon



BETTMAN ARCHIVE/GETTY IMAGES

Vice President Richard Nixon with his wife, Pat, on Nov. 9, 1960, in Los Angeles as presidential election results arrive.

BY LEE HUEBNER

Richard M. Nixon is having a moment. “Nixonmaxxing” young conservatives seem intent on repairing the disgraced former president’s reputation, wearing Nixon-emblazoned merchandise, praising his bare-knuckle approach to politics and holding him up as a victim of Washington machinations.

Vice President JD Vance in late June said of the scandal leading to Nixon’s 1974 resignation, “If Watergate happened tomorrow, it would be like a 12-hour news story. The idea that it would have taken down a presidency is crazy.”

Nixon’s politics of resentment and his pugilistic style clearly appeal to the populist right. His anti-establishment sensibility is shared by President Donald Trump, a longtime admirer of the 37th president. But there is a fundamental difference between the two men, one that fully justifies paying fresh attention to Nixon — just not for the reasons that Nixonmaxxers imagine.

One of the most troubling aspects of Trump-driven MAGA politics is that it denies election results and works to undermine confidence in America’s electoral system. And it likes to blame an amorphous, villainous “deep state” for the nation’s political problems.

Nixon, by contrast, battled against such impulses even though on one notable occasion doing so cost him a chance at the presidency, and on another cost him the presidency itself.

Thirty-two years have passed since President Bill Clinton, in a speech at Nixon’s funeral in 1994, urged the country “to remember President Nixon’s

life in totality.” But that has never been an easy thing to do.

Clinton wanted the country to get beyond thinking of Nixon only, or primarily, in the context of the Watergate scandal, as many still do to this day. But the alternative outlook did not mean ignoring or dismissing that stain, as some of today’s Nixon fans prefer. To the contrary, as Nixon himself later acknowledged, “I made so many bad judgments” and “I brought myself down.”

But as serious as his mistakes surely were, and as Clinton also implied, a great deal can be learned from many more positive parts of the Nixon story, including his breakthrough foreign policies and his surprisingly progressive domestic record. As a former White House speechwriter for Nixon, and as a professor who has since been teaching a course about him, I have long focused my attention on the complexity of Nixon’s “totality.”

The element of his totality that may be most beneficial to appreciate right now involves two moments when Nixon refused to join Republicans who were urging him to deny election results and defy court rulings. His refusals bookended his career in presidential politics.

The first such reckoning came in the 1960 presidential election, when Nixon, the vice president, finished in a virtual tie with his Democratic rival, Sen. John F. Kennedy — a 118,000-vote margin for JFK out of 68 million votes cast. Kennedy’s success depended on his extremely narrow margins in two key states, Illinois and Texas, both of which had a history of dubious vote counting.

A broad chorus of his supporters urged him to contest the result, but Nixon quickly conceded, re-

portedly telling a friend, “Our country cannot afford the agony of a constitutional crisis.”

He may have agreed privately that he had won enough votes to be elected, but he discouraged Republican officials who began investigating the results and publicly emphasized his support for an orderly transition of power.

Nixon summed up his thinking when he had to announce his own defeat as he presided over a joint session of Congress on Jan. 6, 1961. His words provide a stunning contrast to the way America’s current leader and many of his followers still talk about the 2020 election. Nixon’s words are well worth fresh attention nearly two-thirds of a century later:

“This is the first time in 100 years that a candidate for the presidency announced the result of an election in which he was defeated and announced the victory of his opponent. I do not think we could have a more striking and eloquent example of the stability of our constitutional system and of the proud tradition of the American people of developing, respecting and honoring institutions of self-government. In our campaigns, no matter how hard-fought they may be, no matter how close the election may turn out to be, those who lose accept the verdict, and support those who win. ... It is in that spirit that I now declare that John F. Kennedy has been elected president of the United States.”

Thirteen years later, holding the presidency but his political career unraveling amid the Watergate scandal, Nixon again demonstrated his commitment to constitutional order. When the Supreme Court on July 24, 1974, denied the president the use of executive privilege to protect Oval Office tape recordings, including the “smoking gun” tape that did him in, Nixon did not hide the tape, or destroy it, as many had urged him to do.

Nixon immediately decided not only to accept the decision but also to announce publicly that he was doing so. James St. Clair, his special counsel, read Nixon’s statement on live national radio and television that afternoon: “While I am, of course, disappointed in the result, I respect and accept the court’s decision, and I have instructed Mr. St. Clair to take whatever measures are necessary to comply with that decision in all respects.”

The White House tried to limit damage from the tapes’ release, to no avail. Amid mounting impeachment pressure, Nixon announced his resignation on Aug. 8.

Respect for democratic processes — specifically, election results and court rulings — is not in vogue today in some Washington circles, even among those who purport to admire Nixon. But such respect, especially when the chips were down, was a key part of Richard Nixon’s totality.

Lee Huebner, a media and public affairs professor at George Washington University, is the author of “Nixon’s Elusive Totality.”

OPINION

The Washington Post

AN INDEPENDENT NEWSPAPER



Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney speaks Monday in Lévis, Quebec.

EDITORIAL BOARD

Americans and Canadians
all lose from escalating trade war

THE 50 PERCENT tariffs announced Monday by President Donald Trump on all cars, trucks, automotive parts and steel from Canada would crush manufacturers in the United States and raise prices in both countries. The silver lining is that Trump said these import taxes would not take effect until Jan. 1, leaving time for negotiators to disarm an economic land mine.

A bilateral deal appeared close last week before talks broke down at the 11th hour. Neither Trump nor Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney wants to look as if he's succumbing to bullying from the other, so the escalation has been predictable.

Early Saturday, 50 percent U.S. tariffs took effect on Canadian alcohol, cement, hockey equipment and dairy products. Canada vowed to retaliate with "dollar for dollar" reciprocal tariffs set to kick in on Sept. 8.

Overheated rhetoric won't help find an off-ramp. Carney said the U.S. "attacked" Canada and that the neighbors are "at war." On social media, Trump said Canada was "among the worst Nations in the World to deal with."

There's no love lost between Trump and Carney. The prime minister owes his come-from-behind victory in last

Trump again treats allies worse than adversaries, and it could cost Republicans in the midterms.

year's election to the president's saber-rattling. But for the good of their respective countries, both men need to pull back from the brink.

For a generation, the U.S. and Canada offered a case study of the mutual benefits that come from globalization. Free trade led to car parts moving back and forth several times before a completed vehicle hit a showroom floor. The U.S. and Canada share electricity grids. Canada supplied American refineries with more than 4 million barrels of crude oil per day in 2024.

The U.S. is Canada's largest export market by far, and Canada is the largest export market for 32 American states. Canada sold \$454 billion in goods and services to the U.S. last year, and the U.S. sold \$426 billion to Canada.

When Trump announced his "Liberation Day" tariffs last year, China and Canada vocally refused to negotiate un-

favorable new deals. But Chinese President Xi Jinping is about to be feted at the White House next month. With Canada, Trump has apparently decided it's easier to punch down than to antagonize another superpower.

This is part of a frustrating pattern: Trump antagonizes America's friends while placating adversaries. Last week, he angered South Korea by scaling back joint military exercises to avoid provoking the dangerous and erratic dictator of North Korea. That came shortly after the president threatened to bomb Oman.

The spat with Canada is another needless provocation. Carney says the old relationship is a relic and will never return. Let's hope he's wrong about that.

Just over two months from the mid-term elections, this trade war with Canada could cost the GOP in several House races and Senate battlegrounds, including Maine, Michigan, Ohio and Iowa. Would paying an electoral price for protectionism push Republicans back toward their free-market roots?

As welcome as that would be, it's more important — for the sake of consumers, workers and businesses on both sides of the border — to sort out a new trade arrangement before November.

An Iran containment strategy takes shape

AFTER SIX MONTHS of on-again, off-again bombing in Iran, punctuated by futile efforts to negotiate a grand bargain with the regime, President Donald Trump is returning to the more defensible strategy of economic containment.

Rather than gambling on a military breakthrough, which would probably require putting American troops on the ground in Iran, the Trump administration has decided to squeeze the mullahs by cutting them off from the rest of the world.

On Monday, Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent unveiled what he called an "economic onslaught." He threatened secondary sanctions on foreign individuals, corporations and financial institutions that continue to do business with Tehran.

Bessent said his team has "mapped every node, every facilitator and every network" that has been used to evade existing sanctions. He indicated that U.S. government officials are reaching out to foreign leaders with "specific requests" and timelines for compliance. As an example, he mentioned Iran's largest bank and said all its foreign branches must be shuttered. "The clock just started ticking," said Bessent, promising a "zero-leakage approach."

Delivering that, however, will require picking a big fight with China, the largest buyer of Iranian oil, and it's unclear whether Trump has the appetite to follow through. Thus far, U.S. sanctions have been concentrated on independent refiners and intermediaries rather than major Chinese banks or state-owned companies. Chinese President Xi Jinping is due in Washington next month for a summit. If he leaves town without



Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent outlines new Iran-related sanctions on Monday.

having made a meaningful commitment to curb China's purchases of Iranian oil, Bessent's threat will look hollow.

But even if the administration succeeds in sharply constricting Iranian exports, Trump needs to be realistic about what this can accomplish. The conflict has strengthened the hard-liners of the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps. Ratcheting up pressure appears extremely unlikely to compel the military to surrender.

The Trump team cannot help but describe its recalibrated approach in martial terms. Bessent previewed Monday's rollout as an "economic D-Day." But D-Day evokes a military campaign with a clear objective: the enemy's unconditional surrender. Economic pressure rarely works that way.

Sanctions have a poor record when it comes to hastening regime change.

Comprehensive enforcement is elusive, and Iran is a practiced evader, having honed its skills for decades. Worse, ruling elites are quite good at passing the pain along to regular people. Even populations enduring profound misery rarely throw off cruel leadership. Just ask the Kim dynasty in North Korea.

That's why containment is not really about regime change. Its immediate goal is to make an already battered Iran weaker so that it's less capable of threatening its neighbors and developing nuclear weapons.

As the vise tightens, Tehran's new leaders will probably lash out militarily. Trump will need to respond forcefully to such attacks without allowing every provocation to drag the United States back into an open-ended war. Containment is a process, rather than an end state — a marathon, not a sprint.

MICHAEL RAMIREZ



LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

To save the Chesapeake Bay, save this fish

Mark Robichaux is right about the urgency of protecting Atlantic menhaden in his Aug. 19 online op-ed, "This little fish anchors the East Coast food web. A fight over it is brewing." This fish is foundational to the food chain and feeds a wide variety of animals, including striped bass, osprey and whales.

Saving menhaden helps save the bay. Now, evidence of a crisis is impossible to ignore. Osprey chicks are starving to death at high rates. Catches have plummeted for small-scale menhaden fishermen. The Chesapeake Bay needs help.

Leaving more menhaden in the water is one of the fastest ways to benefit the ecosystem, and this strategy is supported by 92 percent of Virginia voters, according to a poll commissioned by the Chesapeake Bay Foundation.

The industry will say more science is needed to act. But research on menhaden in the Chesapeake Bay was delayed for years.

Waiting indefinitely while the bay circles the drain is irresponsible. It needs action today, before red flags turn into irreversible damage.

The Atlantic States Marine Fisheries Commission will soon seek public comment on a proposal that could cut the Chesapeake Bay's industrial menhaden harvest by up to half. Everyone who cares about thriving waterways should tell the commission to approve conservation-minded reforms to protect the bay, coastal communities and the thousands of jobs that depend on a healthy ecosystem.

Will Poston, Virginia Beach
The writer is the forage campaign manager at the Chesapeake Bay Foundation.

The National Fisheries Institute, which I lead, welcomes genuine calls for improved fishery management grounded in science. But no one should confuse science with calls to bypass the nation's time-tested fishery management system.

The National Marine Fisheries Service and its fishery management councils have concluded that the Atlantic Coast and Gulf Coast menhaden fisheries are healthy and responsibly managed for commercial as well as sportfishing uses. In fact, the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration's most recent stock assessment states that "Atlantic menhaden are not overfished and that overfishing is not occurring." Fishery management measures — and the hard work of supplying the world's healthiest animal protein — ought to be left to the professionals.

Lisa Wallenda Picard, Reston
The writer is the president and chief executive of the National Fisheries Institute.

Legalized cannabis is better

The cannabis industry shares the priorities described by George F. Will in his

Aug. 20 column, "Rethinking the hazardous marijuana social experiment": protecting children, strengthening public safety, reducing crime and minimizing the harms of misuse. But it disagrees with him on the most effective approach to accomplishing them.

Cannabis legalization reallocated demand from criminal organizations to storefronts with age verification, testing and labeling standards, and it has created more than 400,000 jobs and more than \$28 billion in tax revenue since 2014.

Will is concerned that potency drives health risks, but inhaled high-potency cannabis products can actually reduce smoke exposure compared with lower-potency ones.

Will framed alcohol as a "private right" that is too embedded to extirpate, yet cannabis and its therapeutic value have been equally embedded. Cannabis products were listed in the U.S. Pharmacopeia until 1942. The Food and Drug Administration approved the THC-based dronabinol for chemotherapy-induced nausea in 1985 and the CBD-based Epidiolex for epilepsy in 2018.

Will highlighted Mark Kleiman's observation that society can choose the problems of legalization or those of prohibition. That's true: Prohibition of alcohol or cannabis yields contaminated products, well-funded criminal organizations and forgone tax revenue. Cannabis prohibition also means withholding medicine from people who need it.

Adam Rosenberg, New York
The writer is the chair of the board of the National Cannabis Industry Association.

George F. Will sensibly noted in his Aug. 20 column that marijuana use, like alcohol use, has become a private right that is too embedded in society to eliminate. However, he fails to note the advantages of marijuana legalization. Ten years of legalization have brought California an 86 percent decline in marijuana arrests, more than 57,000 legal jobs created and \$8 billion in tax revenue. Meanwhile, alcohol use has declined, and countless patients have found a substitute for opiates and other drugs in the treatment of chronic pain and other conditions. No wonder Massachusetts voters will likely decline to re-criminalize.

Dale Gieringer, Oakland
The writer is the director of the California National Organization for Reform of Marijuana Laws.

Letter submissions

Send letters to letters@washpost.com. Submissions must be exclusive to The Post and should include the writer's address and day and evening telephone numbers. Letters are subject to editing and abridgment. Please do not send letters as attachments. Because of the volume of material we receive, we are unable to acknowledge submissions; writers whose letters are under consideration for publication will be contacted.

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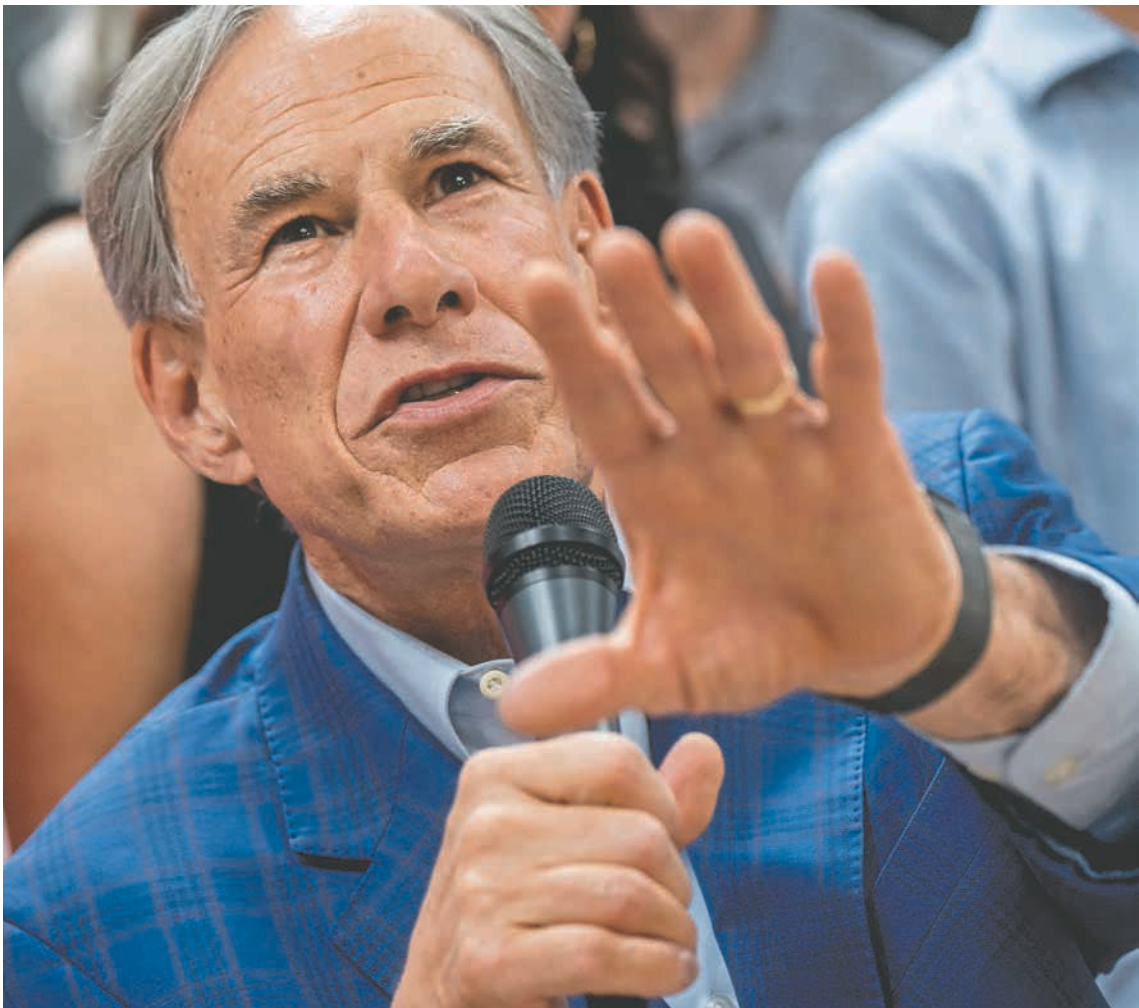
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OPINION

Ken Paxton isn't the only Texas Republican in trouble



OMAR ORNELAS/EL PASO TIMES/REUTERS

Texas Gov. Greg Abbott (R) in El Paso on Aug. 19.

BY JOE HOLLEY

On the outskirts of Fredericksburg, a Texas Hill Country town whose German heritage lures fans of tidy historic homes and tasty strudel, a battered delivery truck sits beside the highway from Austin. On the driver's side of the vehicle is a large sign in faded black letters. Barely legible, it reads, "Donald Trump: Promises Made. Promises Kept."

Come Nov. 3, the medium — in this case, an old truck — may be the message, not the words on the sign. The president's overwhelming influence just might be fading, not necessarily in MAGA-fervid Fredericksburg but among voters statewide. The most obvious indication is the high-profile U.S. Senate race, where in some polls Trump's hand-picked choice, scandal-plagued Texas Attorney General Ken Paxton, has trailed his Democratic challenger, state House member and aspiring pastor James Talarico.

Even more unexpected, though getting much less attention, are two other top-of-the-ticket contests. In the governor's race, Republican Greg Abbott, vying for a record-setting fourth term, held a one-point lead in a July poll over his Democratic challenger, a little-known state House member from Austin named Gina Hinojosa. Other polls have had Abbott leading by four to six points. To put this into perspective, among his six consecutive statewide victories as attorney general and governor, Abbott has won races by 20, 22 and 30 percentage points. He began July with a \$67 million campaign war chest. Hinojosa had \$3 million.

The lieutenant governor's race may be more surprising. A poll conducted in late July showed Re-

publican Lt. Gov. Dan Patrick, arguably the most powerful politician in Texas, trailing his Democratic challenger by two points. That would be Vikki Goodwin, a veteran House member from Austin.

Talarico, with plenty of campaign donations, has made a name for himself across the country. But ask Texans if they've heard of Goodwin, a real estate agent, and the response is likely to be a blank stare.

So what's happening in a state where Democrats have wandered in the political wilderness for more than three decades, a state that hasn't sent a Democrat to the U.S. Senate since 1988, where a Democrat has not occupied the Governor's Mansion since Ann Richards left office on Jan. 17, 1995?

On Thursday, the Cook Political Report moved the Senate race from "Lean Republican" to "Toss Up." In the governor's race, Cook has moved in Hinojosa's direction, from "Solid Republican" to "Likely Republican."

For long-suffering Democrats, even the most measured prediction of electoral success brings on a case of the willies. Texas Democrats resemble a struggling baseball team whose pitcher is working on a no-hitter. They have been disappointed too many times — the most painful example being Beto O'Rourke's narrow loss to Sen. Ted Cruz in 2018 — so it's best not to mention what may be unfolding.

None other than the lieutenant governor saw looming danger. Patrick tried to warn Republicans last spring after Paxton, in a bitter Senate primary, forced four-term Sen. John Cornyn into a runoff. A feuding party, he warned, could result not only in a loss of the Senate seat but in downballot defeats as well.

Republican primary voters didn't listen. After Trump's late endorsement of Paxton, they awarded the divisive attorney general 64 percent of the vote, compared with Cornyn's humiliating 36 percent.

Most political observers regarded Patrick's warning as little more than rally-the-troops campaign hyperbole. Richard Murray, a political scientist affiliated with the University of Houston's Hobby School of Public Affairs, took him seriously. An expert on polling and demographics, he anticipates a Democratic "wave of some proportion" in November.

"The thing about a wave," Murray said, "is that voters don't distinguish between candidates."

In other words, voters are not all that concerned that Hinojosa is not that well known beyond Austin. A Rio Grande Valley native and a former Austin school board member, she has served in the Texas House since 2017 and is among the chamber's more progressive Democrats.

"Hinojosa has a demographic advantage — a woman and a Latina — which primes two electoral Dems need to win statewide," University of Houston political scientist Brandon Rottinghaus said.

"The real issue," he added, "is that Abbott is vulnerable. Polls show Texans think the state is on the wrong track."

Beyond the MAGA base, Texas voters seem unsettled. Businesses have been buffeted by Trump's tariff whims. Gas and grocery prices remain high. And thanks to an unpopular war of choice in Iran, farmers and ranchers are contending with higher feed, fertilizer and fuel costs.

Perhaps the major difference between 2024 and 2026 is what appears to be a sharp decline in Hispanic support for Republicans. After a shocking swing toward Trump two years ago, polls show increasing voter remorse. The Trump administration's mass deportation obsession, and the deadly havoc caused by masked immigration agents in Texas and elsewhere — as well as high prices and economic uncertainty — have combined to raise doubts about whether Trump's dramatic gain among Hispanic voters will endure.

Russ Tidwell, a political consultant and former Democratic Texas House member, noted a more subtle shift. He pointed out the high number of new residents Texas attracts annually. "They're not coming from Mississippi," he joked.

The newcomers are not necessarily all Democrats, but many aren't reliably Republican either. They may not know much about the cultural issues that have motivated Texas conservative voters since long before MAGA. They're probably not all that familiar with Abbott's anti-Muslim fixation or his zeal for school vouchers. They may not know that Patrick finally succeeded during the most recent legislative session in his mission to require public schools to post the Ten Commandments.

As Tidwell sees it, the changing demographics of his home state, particularly in the so-called Texas Triangle (Dallas-Fort Worth, Austin-San Antonio and Houston), resemble what has happened in Georgia, Arizona and Virginia. Each of these previously solid-red states now has two Democratic senators because of dramatic growth around Atlanta, Phoenix and the Northern Virginia suburbs.

Tidwell fondly recalled 1982, when his fellow Dems dominated statewide elections, and he's well aware of positive omens this time, but like most Texas Democrats, he won't breathe easy until that old truck in Fredericksburg gets hauled off to the metaphorical junkyard.

Joe Holley is based in Austin and writes about Texas politics.

MAX BOOT

Trump's bullying has backfired

Whatever else you may say about him, President Donald Trump is a consummate salesman. As former House speaker Newt Gingrich once noted to me, the former real estate tycoon did a brilliant job with his campaign slogan: It wasn't "Trump for President"; it was "Make America Great Again." Despite his outsize ego, he kept the focus on the country, not on his own ambition. But Trump's normally deft marketing touch has deserted him during his second term.

In the CNN Poll of Polls, 36 percent approved of his job performance, while 63 percent disapproved. That's far below the historical average for presidents. He is even more unpopular abroad — and international disapproval of the president has translated into disapproval of the country he leads. A Pew Research Center poll of 36 countries, conducted earlier this summer, found that 76 percent of respondents had "no confidence" in Trump and 57 percent had an unfavorable opinion of the United States. In most of the countries Pew surveyed, people had a more positive impression of China than of the U.S.

There are many factors that explain the collapse of Trump's support — he has, after all, pursued unnecessary and unsuccessful policies, ranging from trade wars to his actual war with Iran, that have exacerbated voters' concerns about "affordability." What makes it all worse is that Trump makes almost no attempt to win over either domestic or foreign audiences to his views. Instead of cajoling or convincing, he tries to coerce and compel others to do what he wants.

Earlier this year, he refused to rule out military action to annex Greenland — a threat that European countries took seriously enough to dispatch their forces to defend Danish sovereignty.

Last month, Trump threatened to impose tariffs on Canada to punish it for wildfires that were blowing smoke into the U.S. One day later, the Trump administration imposed 50 percent tariffs on many Canadian goods, claiming that they were unrelated to the wildfires.

Then last week, Trump threatened to "bomb the shit" out of Oman if it gets "in the way" of his administration's talks with Iran. I can't remember any previous president making such a blunt public threat against an ally, but for Trump it's become routine.

Trump also suddenly announced that he was re-



MARK SCHIEFFELBEIN/AP

ducing joint military exercises with South Korea, citing not only his supposedly "very good relationship" with North Korean dictator Kim Jong Un but also South Korea's unwillingness to join Trump's war against Iran. He had earlier threatened to withdraw U.S. troops from Spain and Italy if they didn't do more to help in the fight against Iran.

The irony is that South Korea now has a president, Lee Jae Myung, who shares Trump's (most probably futile) hopes of renewing diplomacy with North Korea, so it would not have been hard for Trump to work out a joint stance with Seoul. But he didn't bother. By acting unilaterally and suggesting he was doing so in part to punish South Korea, he opened a rift with another close ally.

Trump's conduct abroad is mirrored at home, where he has never made any effort to win sup-

port beyond his MAGA base. Instead of trying to win over skeptics and critics, he targets them for retribution, whether by cutting funds to "woke" universities, launching prosecutions of political opponents or dispatching immigration agents and National Guard troops to Democratic cities.

His strategy is backfiring badly. Judges have blocked many of his executive edicts and dismissed several of his politically motivated prosecutions. Trump's opponents aren't intimidated; they're energized. Sen. Mark Kelly (D-Arizona) has turned unsuccessful Pentagon efforts to punish him (for warning troops not to follow illegal orders) into a staple of his stump speech.

Trump's coercive tactics are also failing miserably abroad. His inability to defeat Iran after almost six months has emboldened its hard-line regime; it continues to hold the Strait of Hormuz hostage and refuses to discuss its nuclear program. U.S. allies aren't helping to reopen the strait despite Trump's demands. Meanwhile, countries including Canada and China have pushed back against Trump's extortionate tariffs, leading him to pull back in many instances.

Even Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, one of Trump's few foreign friends, has defied White House pressure to withdraw from Gaza, to crack down on radical Israeli violence in the West Bank and to stop bombing Syrian military installations.

Trump's ability to intimidate has dramatically eroded because the whole world has seen how empty many of his threats are. He is not, for example, going to bomb Oman. He talks big but backs down so often that "TACO" (Trump Always Chickens Out) has become a popular acronym.

Here's a radical and undoubtedly quixotic suggestion for the final 2½ years of Trump's presidency: Instead of trying to bludgeon the entire world into submission, maybe he should try persuasion instead. A good start would be giving serious speeches to explain and justify his policies, as previous presidents have done, rather than relying on bombastic social media posts — often designed to outrage and infuriate — to get his message out.

Many of Trump's goals, from ending Iran's nuclear program to getting allies to contribute more to mutual defense, are actually reasonable. But his bullyboy tactics have boomeranged. Where are his vaunted marketing skills when they are needed most?

DOMINIC PINO

The FCC's power over broadcasters was a mistake from the start

In the early 1900s, when Congress was figuring out how to regulate broadcasting over a newfangled invention known as radio, it faced a crossroads. It could extend existing ideas about private property to a new domain. Or it could reject that in favor of a quasi-socialist system prone to government efforts to restrict speech and freedom.

ABC can tell you which one it chose.

Under the system set up a century ago, a government agency, initially the Federal Radio Commission and since 1934 the Federal Communications Commission, issues licenses for broadcast frequencies. Who gets these is based not on market forces but rather on what the FCC deems the public interest. Broadcasters don't actually own their frequencies — licenses must be renewed after a set term — and they can't transfer them without FCC approval. This system has long since been expanded beyond radio to broadcast TV.

When it created this regulatory regime, Congress was guided by the premise that broadcast frequencies are scarce and many people want to use them. There was a need, the thinking went, for an orderly way to assign frequencies so that multiple users wouldn't overlap on the same one.

But allocating scarce resources is what markets do. When radio pioneers broadcast programming on a certain frequency, they were transforming a sliver of the electromagnetic spectrum — something owned by no one — into a valuable resource. Remove the hand of intrusive government, and this first-mover claim ought to have conveyed ownership. Left alone, a market for frequencies would have developed naturally, with prices determined by supply and demand.

In this alternate reality there would still be a role for government, which would use its enforcement power to punish interlopers and facilitate the functioning of the market. Broadcast on a frequency owned by someone else? You're trespassing. Attempt to gobble up a critical mass of frequencies? Welcome to an antitrust lawsuit. But Congress was spooked by the powerful new technology of radio, and the heavy-handed speech-policing system America has today was born.

A 1959 paper by renowned economist Ronald Coase isolated the fallacy at the heart of the FCC regime. Every valuable resource is scarce, Coase noted, but scarcity doesn't give government a right to control it — at least not in the United States. Coase traced the history of FCC licensing and found that skeptics of government control were ignored as the FCC got rolling; after that regulators couldn't imagine doing things any other way. Bad economic reasoning got government off on the wrong foot, and then it stepped into cement, which hardened around the mistake.

The Trump administration's apparent attempt to use the lever of FCC licensing to move the broadcaster's coverage in the direction it wants, now the subject of a federal lawsuit, lies directly downstream from that.

In the process of issuing and renewing licenses, the FCC has the power to review broadcasters' content to ensure it is serving "the public interest." It's this eye-of-the-beholder requirement that the agency uses to take steps that would be obvious violations of the First Amendment in any other context.

The government can't shut down a podcast for harshly criticizing public officials or spreading what it thinks are undesirable religious views. But that's essentially what the Federal Radio Commission did in 1931 when it took away a Los Angeles pastor's broadcast license.

The government can't tell a newspaper it's not allowed to run editorials it thinks are contrary to the public interest. But the FCC in 1941 renewed a Boston radio station's license on the condition that it wouldn't broadcast editorials.

The government can't take a cable TV station off the air because it believes its programming is too politically one-sided. But in 1970 the FCC denied license renewal to a Philadelphia-area broadcaster over violations of the Fairness Doctrine, which said broadcasters had to air opposing viewpoints.

The Kennedy and Johnson administrations also used the Fairness Doctrine to bully conservative broadcasters. Democratic Party operatives fronted organizations to file Fairness Doctrine complaints with the Democratic-majority FCC, which then ordered stations to broadcast pro-administration views. In the 1970s, allies of Richard Nixon challenged the licenses of TV stations owned by The Washington Post Co., which also happened to publish the president's most hated newspaper.

Though courts are supposed to help protect Americans' First Amendment freedoms, they have often failed when it comes to broadcast media. Courts have largely allowed the FCC to freelance on the First Amendment because they, too, have bought into the economic fallacy that Congress did. Since broadcasters are using spectrum only by the grace of government, the theory goes, government can set conditions for using it.

Anyway, even holdouts for the scarce-spectrum theory ought to concede that the world has changed. In 2005, a research paper by an FCC staffer concluded that "the Scarcity Rationale for regulating traditional broadcasting is no longer valid," and we all know technological progress did not halt in 2005. Electromagnetic spectrum continues to be used more efficiently. Cable TV, satellite radio and the internet have opened far more media for broadcasting outside the FCC's remit. In the cacophony of modern communications, tightly controlling supposedly precious broadcast bandwidth is a farce.

The FCC has loosened some restrictions as time has passed; most prominently, the Fairness Doctrine ended in 1987. But the agency's core power over broadcasters remains — to the evident glee of the Trump administration.

It's a power the government never should have had. As the advance of artificial intelligence spurs calls for government ownership, universal basic income and new types of taxes, let's not make the same mistake again.

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SPORTS
Roger Federer will play in a U.S. Open exhibition, but don't call it a comeback. **B7**



METRO
Letters from families of Confederate soldiers gifted to Gettysburg museum. **B12**

The Washington Post
Style

TUESDAY, AUGUST 25, 2026

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THEATER REVIEW

In D.C., ‘The Notebook’ turns the page

The musical had a rough run on Broadway, but the touring production makes a splash at the National Theatre



Alysha Deslorieux and Ken Wulf Clark play the lead characters when they're in their 20s in "The Notebook," currently playing at the National Theatre.

BY THOMAS FLOYD

“The Notebook” was hounded by cynicism when it hit Broadway two years ago. The schmaltzy source material turned the musical into an easy target. The tearjerker’s souvenir tissue boxes were also a source of mockery. Mixed reviews and Tony Award snubs doomed it to an abbreviated nine-month run.

That’s a shame, because this unabashedly sentimental musical, now at Washington’s National Theatre, is much better than it has any right being. Sure, composer Ingrid Michaelson’s indie-pop songs deploy a few clunky lyrics. Yet the score still boasts plenty of peppy pleasures. Bekah Brunstetter’s script — adapted from Nicholas Sparks’s 1996 romance novel — could be reductively labeled emotionally manipulative. But what storytelling isn’t?

Deftly directed by Michael Greif and Schele Williams, the touring production brings the crowd-pleasing melodrama — plus some acute observations about time’s passage for good measure. Between saucy gags about our protagonists’ love and lust, Brunstetter’s libretto joyfully reflects on youthful indiscretions and mournfully confronts aging’s irreversibility.

Although the framing device sets “The Notebook” in a 21st-century nursing home, flashbacks and slippery memories root much of the action in 1960s and ’70s North Carolina. Thus the show shrewdly calls on three actors to portray each star-crossed lover — blue-collar Noah and blue-blooded Allie — across the characters’ teens, 20s and golden years.

As played by Kyle Mangold, Ken Wulf Clark and an affecting Beau Gravitte, Noah journeys from boyish to rugged to curmudgeonly. The nifty Allie, portrayed on opening night in D.C. by Yassmin Alers, Chloë Cheers and the particularly impressive Alysha Deslorieux, is a beacon whose light eventually dims in the throes of dementia.

Lest you think the heartache overwhelms the occasion, Michaelson has whipped up a re-

SEE THEATER REVIEW ON B2

From Dan + Shay, a heartfelt single

‘Say So’ is a tribute to mentor who died by suicide

BY MARIA SHERMAN
Associated Press

The lead single from Grammy Award-winning duo Dan + Shay’s forthcoming album “Young” is a hard pivot from the wedding songs that make up so much of the country pair’s discography.

“Say So,” with its big-hearted and hopeful chorus, is about suicide prevention. It was written in tribute to Dan Smyers and Shay Mooney’s late mentor Ben Vaughn, head of Warner Chappell Music Publishing, who died by suicide a year before.

“If you’re going through hell, you’re not alone,” Mooney sings. “If you need somebody, say so.”

“For one of the first times in our career, I was like, ‘I’m not like sure if we should tackle this,’” Smyers said.

But in the studio, it became an inevitability — even though they were uncertain. “We were just sharing stories about our friend. And it just fell out of us. A verse and a chorus in, and I think we were all just like, ‘I don’t know,

man. Is this too heavy to tackle?’” Smyers continued.

Creating the demo together, alongside co-writers David Hodges and Jimmy Robbins, became therapeutic.

“We owed it to our friend Ben,” he said. “We owe it to the community, who he meant so much to. And I feel like we owed it to ourselves to at least see that one through to the finish line.”

What they didn’t realize is that the day they started work on the song was also what would’ve been Vaughn’s 50th birthday. “It was more than a coincidence,” he said. “That was the sign that this song could help somebody.”

“Say So” may be the heaviest song off “Young,” but it is also a thematic center for the record — 10 autobiographical tracks of crossover country that reflect their lives, now, with new emotional vulnerability — what Mooney labels “a very life-giving thing.”

The album opens with its title track, the stripped-back acoustic arpeggio “Young,” what Smyers

SEE DAN + SHAY ON B3

MUSIC REVIEW

A Beastie Boy returns with a messy but fun album

BY RON HARRIS
Associated Press

Mike D 5D, a new project from former Beastie Boy Michael Diamond, will release “Thank You” on Friday — the debut solo album from the MC and the first new music from the Beastie Boys’ camp since the 2012 death of Adam “MCA” Yauch.

“Thank You” is a debut album unafraid to traverse new sonic ground — and suffers only the occasional misfire.

Joined by his band — his sons Skyler and Davis Diamond as well as Eddie Ruscha, Will Graefe and Milo Ruscha — Mike D’s album bristles with stuttering drum and bass breaks and distressed vocals on the opening tracks “Switch Up” and “What We Got,” both of which sound as if they were pushed through an overdrive pedal. Somehow it works and is fitting with Mike D 5D’s high-volume and energetic style. (The band will play a sold-out show on Sept. 1 at 9:30 Club in D.C.)

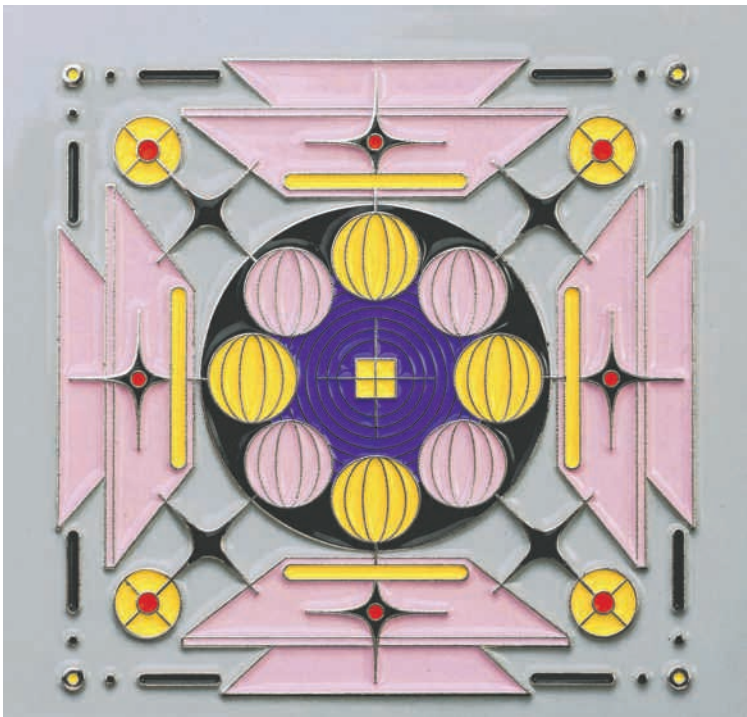
Less necessary are meandering and repetitive songs such as “Secrets Pt. II,” in which Mike D discusses his discomfort. “I got secrets,” the rapper implores, re-

peatedly — no, seriously, a lot — while failing to reveal one. The rapper has a musical idea, but not much of a lyrical one.

Much of the album plays out like a man in a bedroom with a vintage synth, a half dozen beered-up friends and a laptop stuffed with aging drum software. Such is true of the track “Crypto,” which purports to cast a cautious eye at greed, but lurches melodically. Ultimately, it relents to a frenetic and fuzzy declaration from Mike D of “All these people in your ear, they’re in your ear / All these people talking in your ear, in your ear” — which apparently means something to him.

But overwhelmingly, “Thank You” is messy, noisy glitch-rap fun. Consider “I Don’t Care,” one of the top tracks. It holds a down-tempo pace and finds Mike D weighing the balance of responsibilities and their emotional returns: “We all have a role/ I didn’t see mine,” he sings. “Start with a goal get lost in the deadline.” The track excels thanks to wonderful Mini Korg synth work from Hubert Blanc-Francis, formerly one half of the French music duo Cassius.

Despite a dash of low lights,



CAPITOL RECORDS/AP

Much of the album “Thank You” has a vintage synth sound.

“Thank You” is refreshingly inventive. That in itself is an accomplishment. To have the aim and drive to create something this new and far afield deserves applause. He’s reaching beyond the low rung re-creations of Beastie

Boy flavor he could have easily leaned into. But that’s easy and accessible and where’s the fun in that?

Credit is due here for exploration and commitment. He’s Mike D and he gets respect.

‘Gruesome Playground Injuries’ follows unlucky soulmates through the years

THEATER REVIEW FROM B1

freshly frothy score. Allie's and Noah's youngest iterations may stumble through some strained banter, but their chemistry still charms on the ukulele-strumming “Dance With Me.” Clark handsomely sings the yearning toe-tapper “Leave the Light On.” When the rain inevitably pours from the rafters — the one scene that undeniably evokes the novel's 2004 film adaptation — the soaring duet “Forever” meets the moment.

One minor drawback for the touring production: the absence of the pool of water that defined David Zinn and Brett J. Banakis's stellar set on Broadway. But it's not a dealbreaker. Between the rain scene and the audible audience sobs, it would appear that “The Notebook” has no shortage of waterworks.

Through Sunday at the National Theatre, 1321 Pennsylvania Ave. NW. About 2 hours 20 minutes. [broadwayatthenational.com](#).

Here are reviews of two more productions now on D.C.-area stages:

‘Gruesome Playground Injuries’

It turns out that “The Notebook” isn't the only time-hopping, decades-spanning romance on a D.C. stage. How about that?

“Gruesome Playground Injuries,” playwright Rajiv Joseph's darkly comic two-hander, is an exercise in indulgence. As a piece of writing, its gimmickry comes at the expense of thematic coherence. It's easy to understand why thespians are drawn to the 2009 play — the two roles allow challenge-hungry actors to navigate ages 8 to 38 — but the text remains a bit slight.

So consider it a success that Keegan Theatre's engaging revival — starring Irene Hamilton as

the chronically ill Kayleen and Jimmy Bartlebaugh as the gleeful daredevil Doug — mostly works despite the uneven material. As the eight scenes catch up with these unlucky soulmates through the years, following various injuries and maladies, Joseph unspools an episodic rumination on how misery truly does love company.

That unwieldy structure serves up inherent pacing issues as scene transitions call on the actors to constantly change costumes and apply bloody makeup. That said, directors Susan Marie Rhea and Kurt Boehm solve that problem as best they can by turning those interludes into an opportunity for the actors to sweetly frolic on Josh Sticklin's playground set. (It's an improvement on the stilted transitions from last fall's off-Broadway revival, which starred Kara Young and Nicholas Braun.)

Then there are the compelling performances. Hamilton masters Kayleen's standoffish flirtation. Bartlebaugh expertly plays Doug as a free spirit who can't help but eventually break. Together, they prove well balanced — like two sides of a seesaw.

Through Sept. 6 at Keegan Theatre, 1742 Church St. NW. About 1 hour 30 minutes. [keegantheatre.com](#).

‘Baron Vaughn: Cycle Breaker’

“Time travel is real, y'all,” Baron Vaughn asserts early in his amusing solo show. “It's called trauma.”

The comic, best known for his role on the Netflix comedy “Grace and Frankie,” lays the groundwork for his riotous reflections early in “Cycle Breaker,” now at 1st Stage for the company's Logan Festival of Solo Performance. (The festival also features Ronald Rand's “Let It Be



CAMERON WHITMAN

Irene Hamilton and Jimmy Bartlebaugh are perfectly balanced in “Gruesome Playground Injuries” at Keegan Theatre.

Art! Harold Clurman's Life of Passion” and Diana Gitelman's “It Ends With Guinea Pigs.”) Over an hour-plus, the ever-energetic Vaughn struts and shrieks and scats while delivering manic musings on fatherhood, child-

hood and snapping cycles of neglect.

Directed by Aysan Celik, “Cycle Breaker” could use more tissue connecting Vaughn's troublesome past and his complicated present. But the show, anchored

by Vaughn's thorny relationship with his alcoholic mother, still proves a worthy vessel for the stand-up's soulful introspection and rapid-fire humor. At times, his wit proves so quick that a golden gag sails right past the

audience. No matter — the churn of laughter is one cycle that doesn't break.

Through Sunday at 1st Stage, 1524 Spring Hill Rd., Tysons. About 1 hour 30 minutes. [1ststage.org](#).

My longtime girlfriend abruptly decided to break up. How can I win her back?



Carolyn Hax

Carolyn: How do you get an ex back who has done a 180 and completely turned cold? My ex and I had a committed, mutually affirming relationship for eight years. Then, on a random Tuesday, minutes after she walked out of a counseling appointment, I got a call from the parking lot telling me it was over. It all ran contrary to the person I know, who was a delightful communicator and connector mindful of others' feelings.

My ex had experienced some recent major stress when she found out she couldn't have children. We never had a major argument, and I have complete confidence in her faithfulness. I just wonder if the stress of the infertility news made her make a rash decision when it came to our relationship. Maybe I was a reminder of that lost chance. Truth is, she was my person, whether or not she could have children.

So the question is: What do you do when you want an ex back and they have gone cold and distant? She isn't acting like herself. She did reach out on our

anniversary by text ... while taking the tone-deaf step of trying to coordinate when I could get my stuff back on that special day. That hurt.

It has now been four months. Is the better strategy to give her time to process? What does a well-intentioned person do to get someone back who is stressed more than ever? I am convinced that the same person I have known is in there, but I need to figure out how to make an argument that resonates in her world when communication has gotten ice cold. — *Ex*

Ex: I am so sorry about your abrupt breakup.

You don't, though, “get” people “back.” You can't.

To presume to try, even, is an oddly negating behavior. Think about it. She says she doesn't want to be with you anymore, and what's your response to that — “No, you do, I can tell”?

People can walk out of therapy appointments in the midst of their mutually affirming eight-year relationships with us and call us from the parking lot and drop us flat. They really can.

It's not that I encourage this, it's awful. So painful. I believe all of us deserve some kind of

explanation that makes sense, that we at least would feel better for knowing. But we're in no position to demand one. Being owed it due to our basic humanity does not equal a guarantee we'll get it. If “no” is the answer, then we must take it.

Because there's a baseline you're dealing with here, and that's individual agency. She is 100 percent in charge of herself. You don't *get* to “get” her to do anything. If she wants to be with you again for her own reasons, then, wonderful. That's different. Better for you, too, because she will be choosing you freely, not responding to pressure or even influence from you. Just the absence of you.

Your wanting her back is also a different thing. It's understandable and contained within you. But the “get” of your framing changes everything, and makes it about extraction. All your observations come from what you see as yours. She was “my person,” you didn't doubt her faithfulness *to you*, and you want to give her time to process as a “strategy.” You know she is “in there,” she doesn't.

I say this even as I have no doubt about your sincerity in missing her. Plus her bad news was also bad for you, and



ILLUSTRATION BY NICK GALIFIANAKIS/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

heartbreaking in its own right. I'm sorry for that, too.

I am just not as sympathetic when you focus on her pain only through the lens of your own. It's apparent the recent infertility news has affected her profoundly. And when the person you spent eight years with and still love is clearly hurting, you ask how “a well-intentioned person” crafts a message *to get her back*.

There is no “back” anyway. There is only forward. She will never be who she was before recent events affected her, and to think she can be is also a kind of erasure. To accept people as they are now is a form of respect for what they've been through — just as a good intention is to want the best for her, period.

So that's your argument: Care about her on her terms without regard for how doing so can make things better for you. The resonance of not trying to resonate. Start there.

Write to Carolyn Hax at tellme@washpost.com. Get her newsletter delivered to your inbox each morning at wapo.st/gethax.

Join the discussion live at noon Fridays at washingtonpost.com/live-chats.

How should a reception desk worker respond to callers who are overly chatty?

Miss Manners

JUDITH MARTIN, JACOBINA MARTIN AND NICHOLAS IVOR MARTIN

calls and visitors. When dealing with rude and polite callers alike, I greet them with a pleasant tone and promptly answer their questions to the best of my ability.

What concerns me are the overly chatty callers — those who insist on lengthily greeting me, inquiring about my day, joking around, explaining how

Dear Miss Manners:

I am a college student at a small, private art school, and work part-time at the school's reception desk, receiving and directing phone

they came to realize they needed to call, etc., before finally reaching the point of the call or giving me the name or extension they want.

I understand that they are merely trying to be kind and brighten my day, and I appreciate their friendliness, but often I have other callers on hold or visitors waiting at the desk. I patiently wait through the person's spiel, as I would never dream of interrupting.

Is this chatty attitude appropriate for a strictly business call? Or, if so, should it be reserved for the person you have business with, instead of their receptionist?

When I make business calls

of my own, I tend to politely say hello and ask for the person I need to speak with, of course adding a please and thank you. Am I being too curt, and should I inquire about the person's day?

The balance between efficiency and pleasantness in doing business seems extremely hard to achieve. Totally ignoring the humanity of both worker and customer is rude, and yet both parties are interested in getting on with whatever the transaction is.

Miss Manners remembers when banks started claiming to be their clients' friends. What this has led to is mandating

employees to start conversations — the current cliché is asking what the client is doing for the rest of the day — that are both intrusive and time-consuming.

Many Gentle Readers have complained to her about this. Yet they would probably appreciate being recognized as returning customers, for example, or just being greeted by someone who is not surly.

You are experiencing the reverse of this problem, with callers feeling they must chat you up. Or perhaps, as you are a student, your fellow students think it is an opportunity to make friends.

So you must not encourage

this by prolonging the small talk. The phrase you want, repeated as often as necessary, is “But tell me how I can help you.”

Dear Miss Manners: Does putting “RSVP” on an invitation denote that the recipient is requested to reply no matter whether they are attending or not, or does one only need to RSVP if they plan to attend?

I sent out about 40 invitations and nearly half of the recipients did not send any kind of acknowledgment or response. I assume/hope they are not coming!

I was under the impression that RSVP meant you should indicate your intentions

regardless. Is this incorrect? Is there a more clear way to communicate to invitees that the host would appreciate a response even if negative?

For those who failed high school French, RSVP translates to “please respond,” whether yes or no. Perhaps you would do better putting your request in English.

New Miss Manners columns are posted Monday through Saturday on washingtonpost.com/advice. You can send questions to Miss Manners at her website, missmanners.com. You can also follow her @RealMissManners.

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The Guide to Offers

The Washington Post

Enter for the chance to win a pair of tickets to Quicksand & Bane - August 31

It's impossible to overstate Quicksand's influence on hardcore. Formed in New York City in 1990 by veterans of Gorilla Biscuits, Youth of Today, Burn and Bold, the band pushed hardcore's raw aggression into heavier, groove-driven territory, helping define the sound that would become known as post-hardcore. Joining them are Soul Blind, whose thick, pedal-drenched sound channels the weight of their hardcore roots through the hooks, haze and massive guitars of modern rock. Don't miss this one of a kind performance.

See details at washingtonpost.com/entertainment/events/lists/388





Country duo Dan Smyers, left, and Shay Mooney recorded songs about grief and affection for their new album, “Younger.”

On ‘Young,’ Dan + Shay tackle difficult subjects

DAN + SHAY FROM B1

describes as “a message from your future self to your present and past self, about the passage of time and appreciating the moment.”

But there’s an additional, gendered resonance. “Men — I just think, maybe I’m generalizing — don’t do as good of a job of sharing their feelings and emotions. And I’m saying that because that’s me,” he said.

“You’re tough. You bottle it up. But when I finally broke down that wall, it changed my life. And I think that song just talks about aging as a man.”

That’s yet another difficult subject, which might also explain why, before creating the 10 songs that make up “Young,” Dan + Shay wrote and scrapped an entire album’s worth of material. The tracks that made up the final collection took time, open and honest conversation, and a hearty dose of self-reflection.

It’s why there may be more religiosity to this album than in the previous works — from the single “Her, The Kids and Jesus” to the album’s two mentions of a King James Bible.

“Her, the kids and Jesus; that’s kind of a snapshot at what my life looks like right now,” Mooney said.

Grief — and affection — take on many forms across “Young.” From the ode to a young adult’s first pet (“Dogs in Our Twenties”) to a twist on the traditional love song format and praying your partner dies after you (the ’90s country-channeling “The Old Guys”), the songs are delivered with tenderness. The latter includes the album’s sole feature, Cody Johnson — a neo-traditionalist in country music that, on paper, may seem at odds with Dan + Shay’s genre-hybridity. After all, these are the same guys who recorded the multiplatinum crossover hit “10,000 Hours” featuring Justin Bieber in 2019.

“We occupy a very different space in country music,” agrees Smyers. Even vocally — Mooney’s got a high register, Johnson sings low, and when they’re all singing together, “It’s, like, perfectly meeting in the middle.”

It also highlights the range of this album. “There’s kind of a song for everybody, for whatever you’re going through,” says Mooney. “Whatever people need to get out of this album, I hope that they get that.”

If you or someone you know needs help, visit 988lifeline.org or call or text the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline at 988.

Coughlan will scale back ‘Bridgerton’ duties, has upcoming role in Hulu hit

BY ANDREA FLORES
Los Angeles Times

Dearest gentle reader, Nicola Coughlan will scale back on portraying her beloved “Bridgerton” character.

While promoting the new fantasy adventure film “The Magic Faraway Tree,” Coughlan told E! News that she will be stepping back from her role as Penelope Featherington in the fifth season of the Netflix hit show.

“I feel very lucky. To be honest it’s the best of both worlds because I’m currently filming on ‘Only Murders,’ but I still get to pop back into ‘Bridgerton’ now and then and see everybody. It’s like I’m home,” Coughlan said to E! News.

The 39-year-old Irish actor said that she had an “incredible experience” leading the “Bridgerton” series, but her storyline is naturally winding down. In Season 4, Penelope retired as the high-society gossip columnist Lady Whistledown (voiced by Julie Andrews) after her public identity was unveiled amid her romance with Colin Bridgerton (portrayed by Luke Newton) in Season 3.

Another mystery writer seems to have picked up the pen as the show heads for its fifth season —

which will center on the widowed Francesca Bridgerton (played by Hannah Dodd) and her late husband John Stirling’s cousin, Michaela Stirling (played by Masali Baduza).

“Part of the beauty of that world is that it keeps reinventing itself. Every season being a new story takes on a different guise,” Coughlan said. “Also, I’m still the OG guys, do you know what I mean? Still the OG.”

Earlier this year, the former “Derry Girls” star joined the sixth season of Hulu’s “Only Murders in the Building” as a recurring cast member, just as the NYC crime-solvers shift their focus to a London case.

But don’t worry, dear reader, Coughlan will not disappear completely from the popular Netflix series, set to be released next year.

Like other leading characters of “Bridgerton” seasons past — including Phoebe Dynevor, who led the first season as Daphne Bridgerton, and Jonathan Bailey, who led Season 2 as Anthony Bridgerton — Coughlan will still participate in some scenes, although it is unknown for how many episodes.

“It’s so nice and low pressure,” Coughlan said. “I’ll always pop back to ‘Bridgerton’ if they want me.”



Nicola Coughlan as Penelope Featherington in “Bridgerton.” Her character’s storyline is slowly winding down.

Adult child says mom was never there for her. Can relationship be salvaged?

Asking Eric

R. ERIC THOMAS

Dear Eric: My husband died by his own hand more than 20 years ago. We had three kids younger than 15. I

was devastated but I had to keep going to maintain some normalcy for them. I went back to school, got a job, sent kids to college, et cetera.

Then came a bombshell a few years ago. My youngest said I have never been there for her, that I only communicate with her with small talk and that emails are just a place for me to tell her what I’ve been doing. (Isn’t that what emails are for?)

She said I didn’t tell her I loved her, didn’t help enough with her wedding, used her kids for Facebook posts, that I favored one child over her and that I don’t visit her and her family enough. (I live more than 1,200

miles away). She says she’s so happy that her mother-in-law is there for her since I’m not.

She says our relationship is only skin-deep and that’s not what she wants. She’s happy with her little bubble of friends.

No matter what I say or do, it’s wrong and she tears into me again. I think a lot of this is coming from her “therapist.” I’m at wit’s end of what to do. I think maybe we should just be estranged. It would save us both some grief and angst every time an email arrives. I wouldn’t even feel welcome right now if I should go to visit. Any advice?

— *Unwelcome Mother*

Mother: I’m sorry for the terrible loss you experienced and I’m sorry you’re navigating this traumatic period with your daughter. It’s possible that some of this is a result of unresolved grief with which she’s struggling,

but it’s hard to tell since she won’t engage with you and only lobs criticism.

It’s clear this relationship needs a reset. To your point, it may be helpful for you to give yourself some space for a time, as what you’ve heard from her has been hurtful.

She told you that the relationship you have is not what she wants. Although she’s listed ways that she feels you’ve wronged her in the past, I’m curious if she is able to identify things that you both could do differently moving forward. You might say something like, “I’m sorry for my part in what went wrong in the past. I’d like to work through it, eventually, but it will be easier to do that if we set a different course for the future. What are one or two actionable changes that we can commit to?”

The past can be overwhelming and it’s clear that you have

different perspectives on it. The advice isn’t to ignore the past, but the past can’t be solved in a day. Tomorrow can only be different, however, if you and she can agree to work toward it together.

Dear Eric: I would like to add something to your response to “Property Brothers,” the parents who must move closer to medical providers. Both of their sons want them to build a home on their property. Your answer addressing the emotional aspect is fine.

I’m a financial adviser. The following must be addressed to avoid a potential falling out between their sons and to protect their own estate.

They must have a written, legal document that states if the son on whose property they build their dwelling divorces, dies or sells his property, there is

language that addresses how the parents are compensated.

When they die and if they have substantial assets, the other son will be compensated for assets that are equivalent to the amount of the home. If there are no assets other than the home, how will the son with the dwelling on his property compensate his brother?

— *Property Protection*

Property: Thank you for this addendum. That’s a very helpful insight that will, hopefully, save the family from future strife.

Dear Eric: Boy, can I relate to “Time After Time,” whose spouse was always late. I’m the late one in my marriage.

Yes, it drives my husband nuts, and he does see it as an insult. After years of this conflict, I figured out a solution that has worked for us: instead of

focusing on what time the event starts, I ask, “What time do you want to leave?”

That way my husband sets the time, and I make sure I am ready to go in time to leave when he wants to. It has worked very well for us.

— *Time Challenged*

Time: Thanks for writing in. I like this reframing because it prioritizes communication and, in asking the question, you indicate to your husband that though you may be late, you’re trying to be considerate of his time as well.

Send questions to R. Eric Thomas at eric@askingeric.com or P.O. Box 22474, Philadelphia, PA 19110. Follow him on Instagram and sign up for his weekly newsletter at rericthomas.com.

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From morning coffee to daily errands, show your love for journalism everywhere you go. These everyday essentials blend function and Post pride. Perfect for work, home, or gifting.



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CLASSIC DOONESBURY



RED AND ROVER



FRANK AND ERNEST



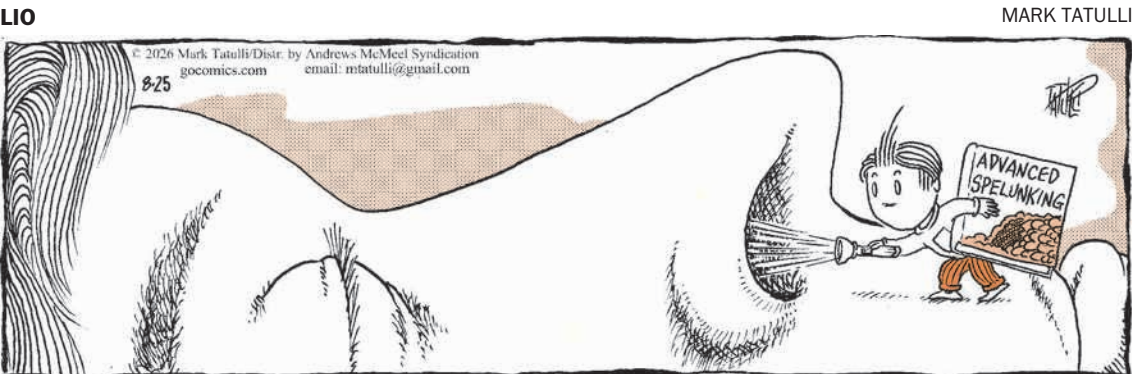
CLASSIC PEANUTS



RHYMES WITH ORANGE



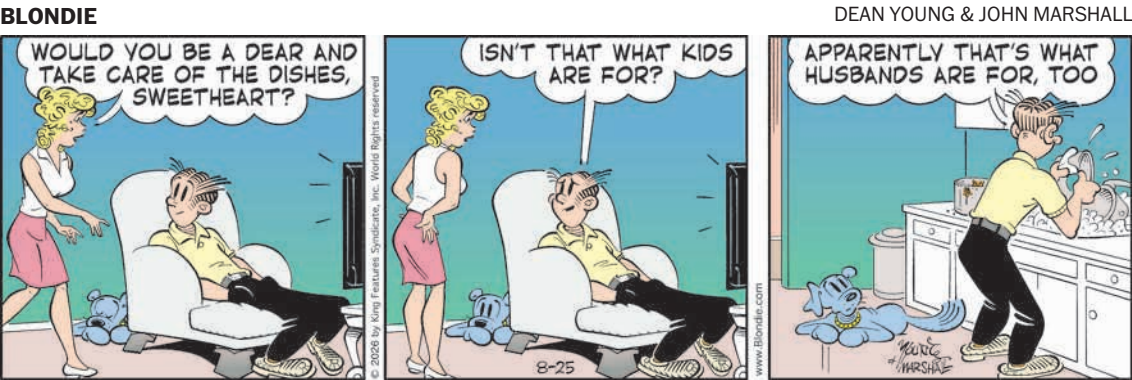
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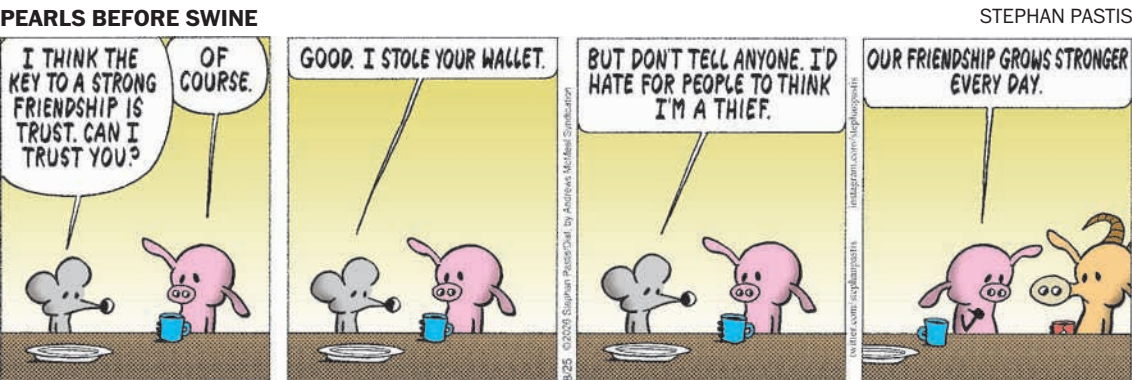
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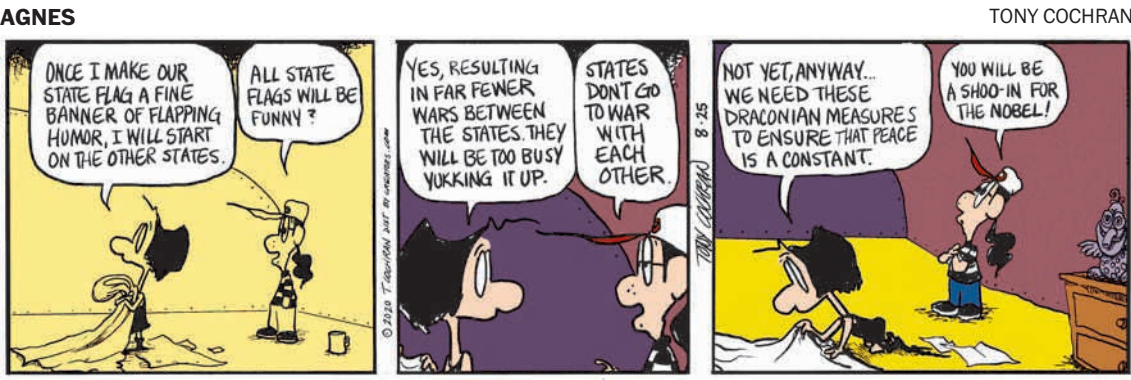
PEARLS BEFORE SWINE



PICKLES



AGNES



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CRABGRASS



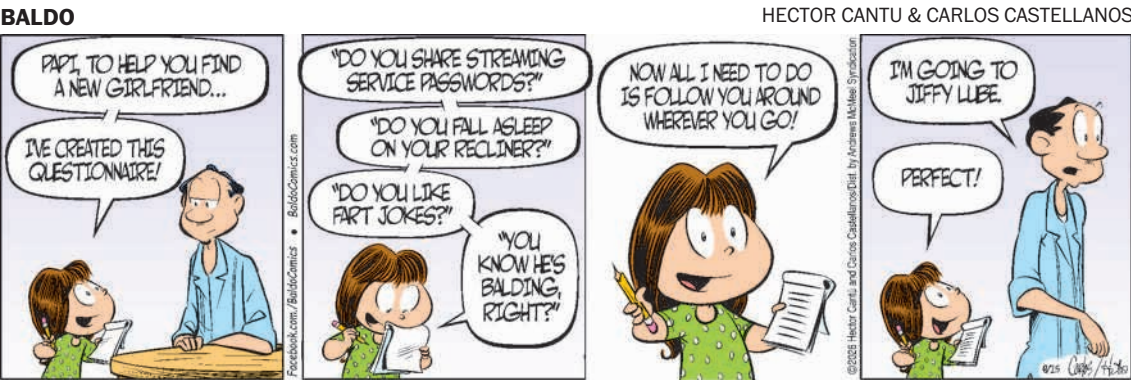
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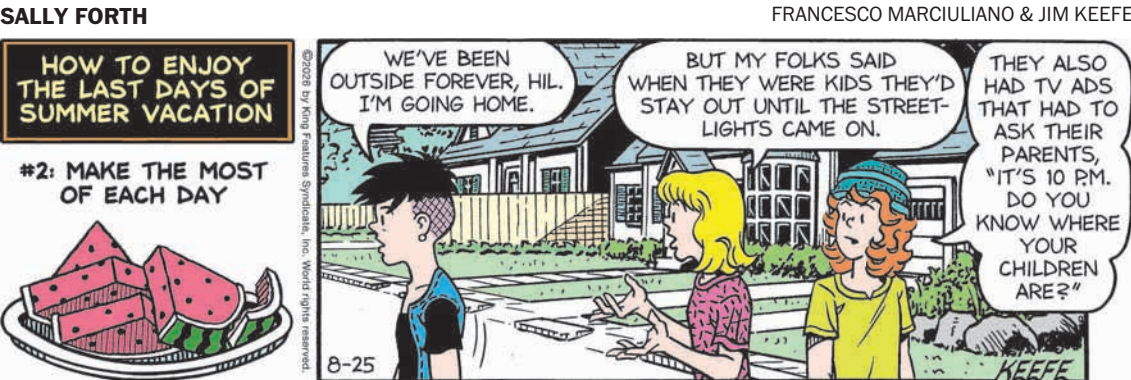
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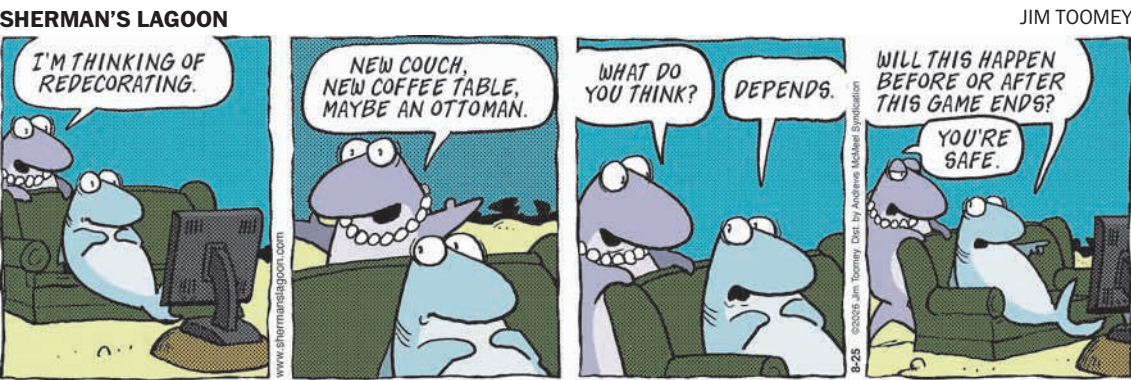
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SALLY FORTH



SHERMAN'S LAGOON

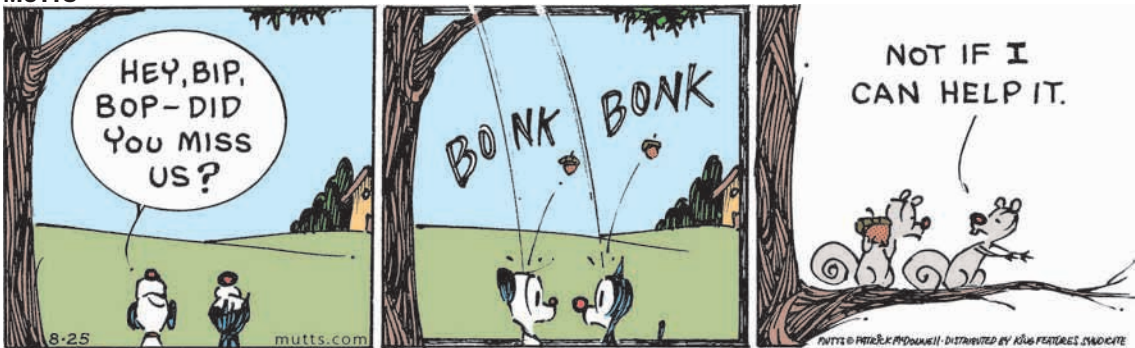


CURTIS



MUTTS

PATRICK McDONNELL



ZITS

JERRY SCOTT & JIM BORGMAN



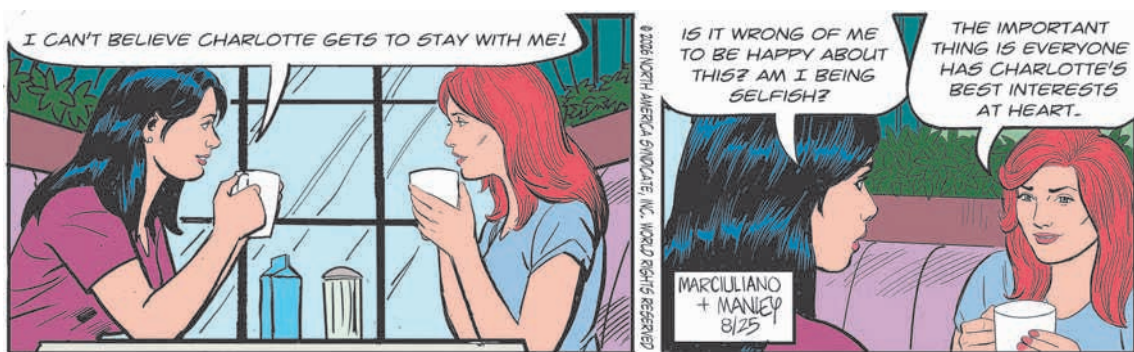
HEART OF THE CITY

STEENZ



JUDGE PARKER

FRANCESCO MARCIULIANO & MIKE MANLEY



FRAZZ

JEFF MALLETT



SIX CHIX

BANNERMAN, XUNISE, KONAR, LAWTON, PATRINOS & PIRO



GARFIELD

JIM DAVIS



BARNEY AND CLYDE

WEINGARTENS & CLARK



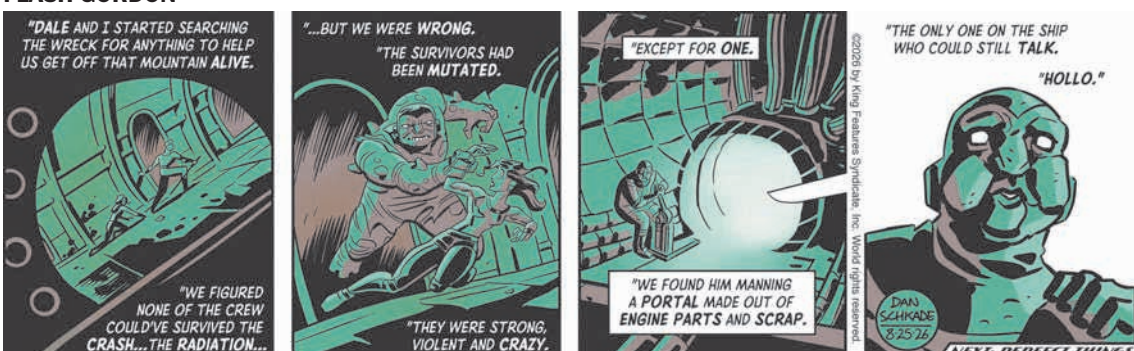
DUSTIN

STEVE KELLEY & JEFF PARKER



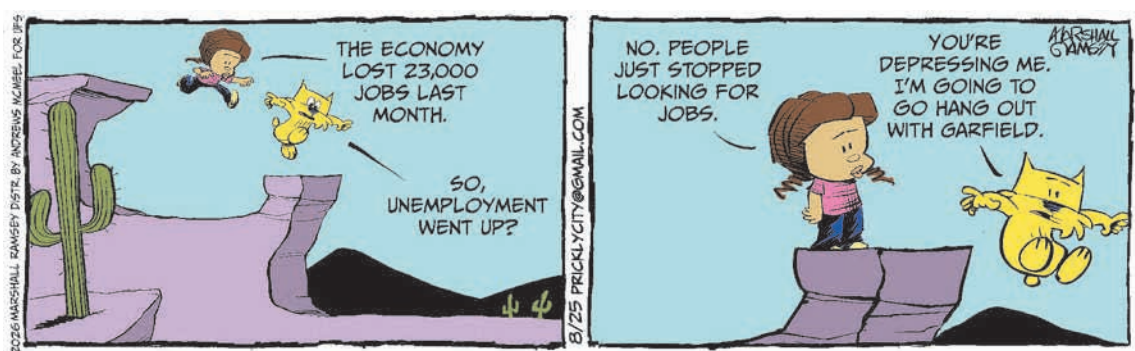
FLASH GORDON

DAN SCHKADE



PRICKLY CITY

MARSHALL RAMSEY



LOOSE PARTS

DAVE BLAZEK



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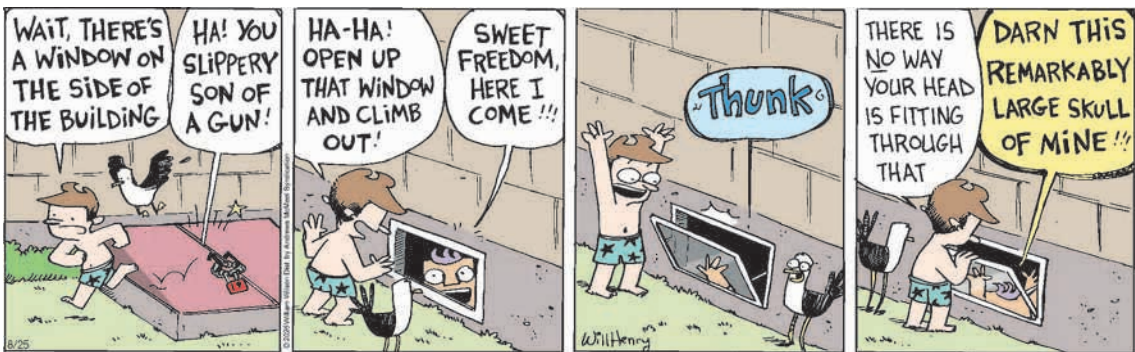
BABY BLUES

RICK KIRKMAN & JERRY SCOTT



WALLACE THE BRAVE

WILL HENRY



ON THE FASTTRACK

BILL HOLBROOK



BEETLE BAILEY

GREG, BRIAN & NEAL WALKER



SPEED BUMP

DAVE COVERLY

DENNIS THE MENACE

H. KETCHAM



FAMILY CIRCUS

BIL KEANE

REPLY ALL LITE

DONNA A. LEWIS



	TELEVISION									
8/25/26	7:00	7:30	8:00	8:30	9:00	9:30	10:00	10:30	11:00	
4.1 WRC (NBC)	• NBCNe..	• News4..	• America's Got Talent (Live)				• Password		• NEWS..	
4.2 WRC (IND)	King	King	King	King	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	George	
5.1 WTTG (Fox)	• Fox 5	• TMZ	• Kitchen Nightmares	• Beat Shazam			• Fox 5 at 10		• Fox 5	
7.1 WJLA (ABC)	• Wheel	• Jeopardy!	• Jeopardy! (SP)	• Celebrity Fam.			• Celebrity Fam.		• News	
9.1 WUSA (CBS)	• Inside	• ET	• NCIS	• NCIS: Origins			• NCIS: Origins		• 9 News	
14.1 WFDC (UNI)	• Rosa		• Tan cerca	• Guardián de mi vida			• Corazón de oro		• Noticias	
20.1 WDCA (MNTV)	• Family	• Family	• Fox 5 News	• Family	• Family		• Chicago P.D.		• Chicago	
22.1 WMPT (PBS)	• Farm	• Outdoors	• Finding Your Roots	• American Masters			• Before		• Amanp..	
26.1 WETA (PBS)	• PBS News Hour		• The Essence of Eva				• American Masters			
32.1 WHUT (PBS)	• Sacred	• Hometo..	• Avian Chronicles	• Nature			• All Too Clear		• BBCNe..	
50.1 WDCW (CW)	• Friends	• Friends	• WWE NXT (Live)				• DC News Now		• Neighbor	
66.1 WPXW (ION)	• Chicago Fire		• Chicago Fire	• Chicago Fire			• Chicago Fire		• Chicago	
A&E	Customer	Customer	Customer	Customer	Customer	Customer	Customer	Customer	Customer	
AMC	Movie: Goodfellas	★★★★ (1990)	Henry Hill rises through the ranks of a crime branch.				Movie: My Cousin Vinny	★★★ (1992)		
Animal Planet	Louisiana Lockdown		Louisiana Lockdown				Louisiana Lockdown		Lockdown	
BET	Celebrity Family Feud		Celebrity Fam.		Ms. Pat	ComicVi..	ComicView	ComicView	ComicView	
Bravo	The Real Housewives: Ultimate Girls Trip		The Real Housewives of London		(15) The Real Housewives of London			The Real Housewives of Orange County		
Cartoon Network	Burgers	Burgers	Burgers	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Rick Morty	
CNN	E. B. OutFront (Live)		Cooper 360 (Live)		The Source (Live)		CNN News. (Live)		Laura	
Comedy Central	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	
Discovery	(6:00) Homestead		Homestead Rescue: Intervention	(SF)			Homestead Rescue: Intervention			
Disney	Big City	Big City	Phineas	Phineas	Vampirina	Phineas	Phineas	Kiff	Ladybug	
E!	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	Cocktail	Cocktail	How I Met	
ESPN	2026 Little League Baseball World Series Game 28: Teams TBA	(Live)			SportsCenter Special (Live)		Fantasy Football Draft		SportCtr (Live)	
ESPN2	Fantasy Focus		Roger Federer, An Icon Returns	(Live)			APP Tour Pickleball		Detroit Open	
Food Network	BeatBobby	BeatBobby	Bobby's Triple Threat		Kitchen Undercover		Bobby's Triple Threat		Bobby's	
Fox News	Ingraham (Live)		Jesse Watters (Live)		Hannity (Live)		Gutfeld!		Fox News	
Freeform	Movie: Elemental	★★ (2023)			Movie: Inside Out	★★★ (2015)	A girl's five emotions try to guide her through life.		The 700 Club	
FX	(5:30) Movie: Bad Boys for Life (2020)		Movie: Bad Boys: Ride or Die	★★ (2024)	Two wisecracking Miami cops find themselves on the run.		Movie: Coming to America	★★★ (1988)		
Hallmark	(6:00) Movie: October Kiss (2015)		Movie: Notes of Autumn (2023)				Golden Girls		Golden Girls	
Hallmark M&M	(6:00) Mystery 101		Mystery 101				Murder, She Wrote		Murder ...	
HBO	(6:25) Movie: The Dark Knight	★★★★ (2008)			Hard Knocks: Seattle Seahawks		(55) Lanterns		(50) Hard Knocks: Seattle Seahawks	
HGTV	Love It or List It		Love It or List It		Extreme Buyers Club		Totally	Totally	Hunters	
History	Proof-There		Proof-There		Proof-There		(05) Proof-There		(05) Proof	
Lifetime	Castle		Castle		Castle		(05) Castle		(05) Castle	
MASN	O's Xtra	MLB Baseball	Baltimore Orioles at St. Louis Cardinals	(Live)			O's Xtra		Touchdo..	
Monumental	WNBA Basketball		Mystics	Mystics	WNBA Basketball					
MSNBC	The Weeknight (Live)		All in With Chr. (Live)		The Briefing (Live)		Last Word (Live)		The 11th	
MTV	Caught in Act		Caught in Act		Caught in Act		Caught in Act		Unfaithful	
Nat'l Geographic	Conquistadors		Conquistadors		Conquistadors		Conquistadors		Conquist	
Nickelodeon	Friends	Friends	Friends	Friends	Friends	Friends	Big Bang	BigBang	BigBang	
NWSN	Vargas Report		Cuomo		On Balance		Katie Pavlich		JesseWeb	
Paramount	(6:00) Movie: Couples Retreat	★★ (2009)	(50) Movie: The Intern	★★ (2015)	A 70-year-old intern develops a bond with his young boss.					
Paramount+Sho	Movie: Bleed for This	★★★ (2016)			Movie: Brave the Dark (2025)				Movie: Scream ...	
Syfy	(6:30) Movie: Troy	★★★ (2004)	Menelaus' brother, King Agamemnon declares war against Troy.		Movie: Transformers: Dark of the Moon	★★ (2011)				
TBS	MLB Baseball	Los Angeles Dodgers at Atlanta Braves	(Live)		MLBClose	Office			Office	
TCM	(6:45) Movie: Truth About Murder (1946)		Movie: These Three	★★★ (1936)	(45) Movie: Beloved	Brat	★★ (1938)		Movie: Nancy D...	
TLC	Baylen Out Loud		Baylen Out Loud		Baylen Out Loud		1000-lb (SP)		90Day	
TNT	(5:30) Movie: Road House (2024)		Dunkman World Championship Finals		Movie: Jurassic World	★★ (2015)				
Travel	Paranormal Nightshift		Paranormal Nightshift		Paranormal Nightshift		Paranormal		Paranor...	
TruTV	MLB Baseball	Los Angeles Dodgers at Atlanta Braves	(Live)		MLBClose	Movie: Moneyball (2...				
TV Land	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	(20) Raymond		Raymond		King	
TV One	Cosby/Sh..	Cosby/Sh..	Lv Single	Lv Single	Lv Single	Lv Single	Lv Single	Lv Single	Lv Single	
USA Network	Law & Order: SVU		Law & Order: SVU		Law & Order: SVU		Law & Order: SVU		Law-SVU	
VH1	My Wife	My Wife	Movie: Poetic Justice	★★ (1993)			Movie: Baby Boy (20...			
WNCB	The Aging Brain		Fed Gov	7News at..	Jacuzzi	WorldNe..	WJLANe..	Jacuzzi	National	
	LEGEND: ★ indicates new or live programs ♦ High Definition									
	Movie Ratings (from TMS) ★★★★★ Excellent ★★★★★ Good ★★ Fair ★ Poor No stars: not rated									

BIRTHDAY | AUGUST 25: You are energetic, perceptive and strategic. You're also a sensitive caregiver. This is a year of teaching and learning. Take time this year to renew your spiritual or religious beliefs. Explore philosophies that will give you a better self-awareness and get you closer to the true meaning of your life.

Moon Alert: After 5:30 a.m. EDT today there are no restrictions to shopping or important decisions. The Moon is in Aquarius.

ARIES

(March 21-April 19)
Your interactions with friends and members of groups might be intense today. Someone might do something that catches you off guard. Or perhaps you'll meet someone unusual. Very likely, you'll feel sympathetic for someone else, and you might look for ways to help them.

TAURUS

(April 20-May 20)
Encounters with bosses, parents, teachers and the police might be intense today. Pull in your reins a bit in case you offend someone, or you might come on too strong. This could relate to something unexpected that impacts your money, possessions or your earnings.

GEMINI

(May 21-June 20)
teer clear of controversial subjects like politics, religion and racial issues today. They will be intense and might quickly grow into an argument. If something catches you off guard, be careful because you might say something you could later regret. Be mindful of what you say and do today.

CANCER

(June 21-July 22)
If you're discussing how to divide or share something like an inheritance or something to do with shared property, taxes or debt today, make sure that your facts are correct. Meanwhile, something unexpected might throw you off guard. Confusion with a boss or someone in authority also might be a factor.

LEO

(July 23-Aug. 22)
Discussions with partners, spouses and close friends are intense today. This might be because you're surprised by something that a friend or a member of a group does or says. This might rattle you! You also might feel sympathetic to the problems of someone far away.

VIRGO

(Aug. 23-Sept. 22)
This is a powerful time for you; nevertheless, something unexpected might occur if you attempt to improve your health or your job. This could relate to an authority figure or your efforts to help someone in need. Do what you ca

LIBRA

(Sept. 23-Oct. 22)
Surprise opportunities to socialize might pop up today. If so, act quickly. Romantic connections will be affectionate today. Likewise, you might feel affectionate toward your kids. However, parents should be extra vigilant because this is also an accident-prone day for your kids.

SCORPIO

(Oct. 23-Nov. 21)
Your home routine might be interrupted today. You also might be involved with a parent or a female family member more than usual. If exploring new health

remedies, be careful. Enjoy schmoozing with others today, especially younger people.

SAGITTARIUS

(Nov. 22-Dec. 21)
Pay attention to everything you say and do today because this is a mildly accident-prone day for you. However, you will feel affectionate toward your kids as well as romantic partners. An unexpected inspiration might give you some wonderful creative ideas.

CAPRICORN

(Dec. 22-Jan. 19)
You might impulsively purchase something today. You also might lose something, so protect what you own. Because something unexpected could impact your money or your possession, keep your eyes open! If you can help a family member today in practical ways or with a sympathetic ear, do so.

AQUARIUS

(Jan. 20-Feb. 18)
Today the Moon is in your sign lined up with Pluto, which can make you emotionally intense. In fact, you might feel overwhelmed by something. You also might feel obsessed with an idea. (This can make one jealous in love.) Be ready for a surprise invitation!

PISCES

(Feb. 19-March 20)
This is a restless day for you. Fortunately, you might attract money or favors from others to you. Romance will be affectionate, definitely. You also might be attracted to competitive sports, social activities, the arts and playful times with kids. Enjoy your day!

— Georgia Nicos

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BRIDGE

N-S VULNERABLE
NORTH
♦ 8 5
♥ J 10 8
♦ K 8 4
♣ A J 9 5 2

WEST
♠ Q 10 7 4 2
♥ A 9 2
♦ 10 5
♣ Q 6 3

EAST
♠ J 9 3
♥ 7 5 4 3
♦ Q J 9 6 3
♣ 7

SOUTH (D)
♦ AK 6
♥ K Q 6
♦ A 7 2
♣ K 10 8 4

The bidding:

SOUTH **WEST** **NORTH** **EAST**
1 ♣ Pass 3 ♣ Pass
3 NT All Pass
Opening lead — ♣ 4

Cy the Cynic says that statements starting with "Please don't take this the wrong way" have a zero-percent success rate.

When Cy was North in my club's penny game, he watched South go down at 3NT. West led a spade: five, jack, king. South then took the A-K of clubs. When East threw a diamond, declarer lost a club to West's queen. He ducked West's return of the queen of spades and won the third spade but had only eight tricks. West got in with his ace of hearts to cash two spades.

"Please don't take this the wrong way," Cy said to his partner, "but your play was wrong."

"What do you mean?" South growled. "I would usually make overtricks."

South should lead a heart at Trick Two; if dummy's jack wins, he shifts to clubs for nine sure tricks. If West grabs the first heart to continue spades, South ducks and wins the third spade. Then he takes the king

of clubs and leads to dummy's jack. If East could win, South would lose at most two spades, a heart and a club.

DAILY QUESTION

You hold:
♦ Q 10 7 4 2 ♥ A 9 2
♦ 10 5 ♣ Q 6 3

Your partner opens one diamond, you respond one spade, he bids two clubs and you return to two diamonds. Partner then bids two spades. What do you say?

ANSWER: Your two diamonds showed at most nine points, and partner would have passed if he saw no chance of game. With a minimum such as K J 3, 3, A Q 7 4 2, K 7 5 2, he would have raised your one spade to two. Bid four spades. Partner may hold K J 5, 3, A K 7 6 3, A J 5 2.

— Frank Stewart

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SUDOKU

Complete the grid so that every row, column and 3x3 box contains every digit from 1 to 9 inclusively.

		9	4		8	5		
4					5	2		
5				7		3		
			1			7	9	
	3		5	9	4		8	
	9	2			3			
		7		3				6
			2	4				9
		5	8		7	1		

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★☆☆☆☆

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PREVIOUS SUDOKU SOLUTION

8	9	3	2	6	1	5	4	7
4	1	7	5	8	3	9	2	6
6	5	2	4	9	7	3	8	1
2	4	1	7	5	9	8	6	3
7	8	9	6	3	4	1	5	2
5	3	6	1	2	8	7	9	4
9	7	8	3	4	6	2	1	5
3	6	5	8	1	2	4	7	9
1	2	4	9	7	5	6	3	8

SCRABBLEGRAMS

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E

I

O

U

V

T

C

R

N

1st Letter Triple

RACK 1

E

U

Y

R

S

G

R

RACK 2

I

O

X

L

N

B

L

RACK 3

O

O

U

T

P

D

S

Double Word Score

RACK 4

PAR SCORE 155-165
BEST SCORE 214

FOUR RACK TOTAL
TIME LIMIT: 20 MIN

DIRECTIONS: Make a 2- to 7-letter word from the letters in each row. Add points of each word, using scoring directions at right. Finally, 7-letter words get 50-point bonus. "Blanks" used as any letter have no point value. All the words are in the Official SCRABBLE® Players Dictionary, 5th Edition. SOLUTION TOMORROW
For more information on tournaments and clubs, email NASPA - North American SCRABBLE Players Association info@naspaplayers.org. Visit our website - www.scrabbleplayers.org. For puzzle inquiries contact scrgrams@gmail.com

08-25

PREVIOUS SCRABBLEGRAMS SOLUTION

B	L	U	E	C	A	P
L	A	R	G	I	S	H
E	C	O	N	O	M	Y
A	N	N	U	A	L	

RACK 1 = 76

RACK 2 = 61

RACK 3 = 70

RACK 4 = 6

PAR SCORE 150-160

TOTAL 213

ACROSS

- Cherry centers
- Eco-friendly commuting option
- Big blowout
- 2026's "The Odyssey," for one
- Workplace inspection org.
- Pry bar, e.g.
- *Broad-brimmed topper made of straw
- New Zealand native
- Olympic swimmer Torres
- Mauna .. Hawaiian volcano slightly taller than Mauna Loa
- Soapy tub gunk
- *Dry-cured meats from Smithfield
- Bartending tool
- Chatted privately online, for short
- Greek god of war
- Owlet's home
- Smells

DOWN

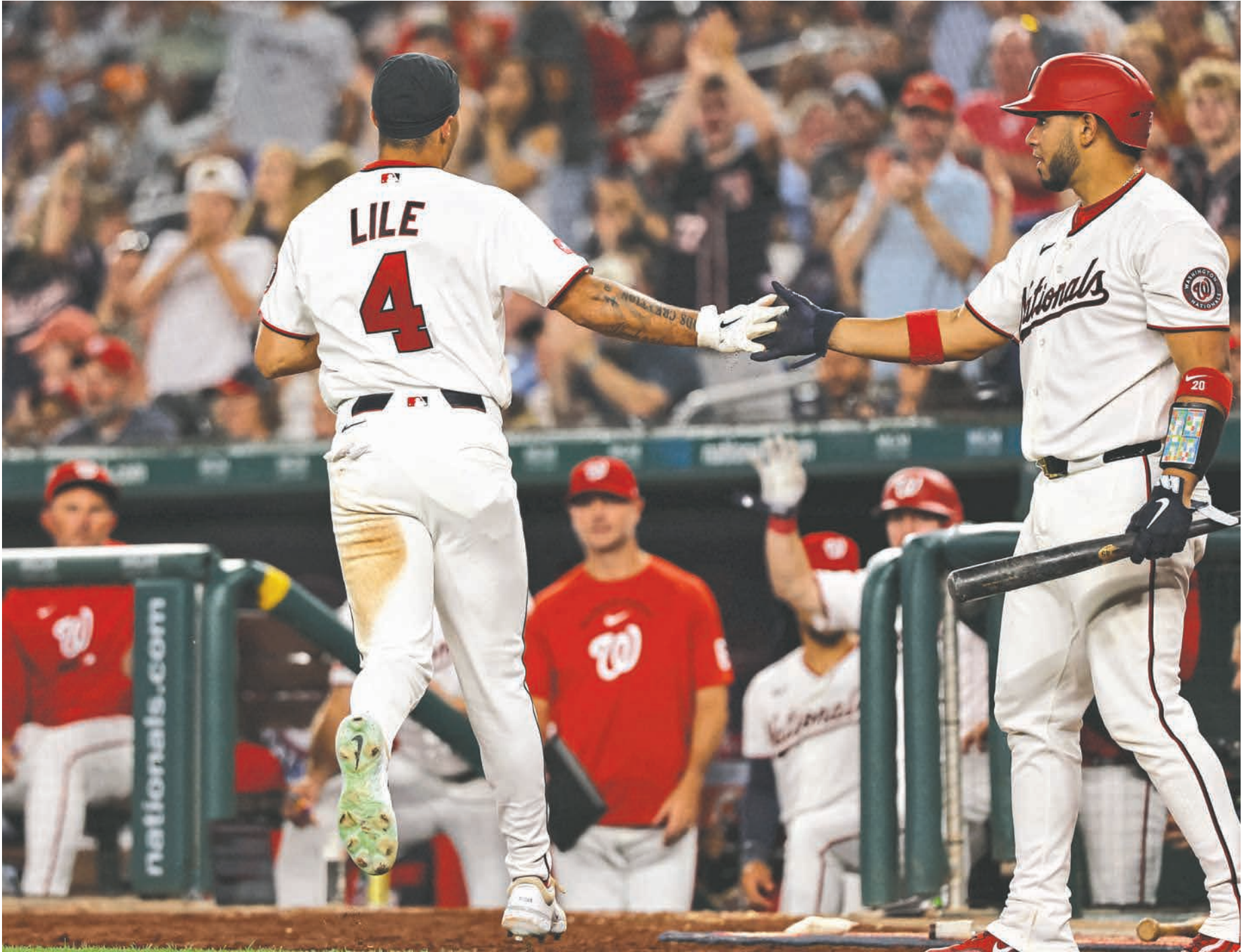
- __ talk: motivational chat
- Apple tablet since 2010
- Writer/actress Fey
- Woolen wraps
- Feathery wrap
- Sorta
- Tan kin
- Gobbled up
- Racial justice movement letters
- Like a dog who's ready for a walk
- Healthy fat with a high smoke point
- Skin care product
- Cuts back a bit
- Major water pipe
- Provide support
- Russo of "Major League"
- "Awesome!"
- Totally wild
- Creme-filled sandwich
- French dessert with fruit and ice cream

- Drive-thru device
- Timid
- Slender candle
- Massages
- Bro kin
- Catamaran feature
- __ and tear
- Web page banners
- Job applicants' submissions
- "Awesome!"
- Rural storage tower
- Broken beyond repair
- Athlete's best effort
- Accumulate excessively

- "Bless you" preceder
- Reef-dwelling Pixar character
- African antelopes
- Female deer
- __-purpose flour
- Blanc who voiced Bugs
- Chinese menu general

MONDAY'S LA TIMES SOLUTION

A	B	B	A		F	O	M	O		M	A	C	Y	S
S	E	E	R		L	A	I	C		A	W	A	I	T
K	N	E	E	P	A	T	C	H		J	E	R	K	Y
S	E	T	T	O		E	A	R	L	E		D	E	E
				H	E	R	S	H	E	Y	S	K	I	S
D	E	B	A	T	E				E	T	A			
O	R	E			D	O	R	A		I	T	S	O	K
H	I	T	S	F	O	R	T	H	E	C	Y	C	L	E
A	C	H	O	O	B	E	A	R			A	D	D	
				L	O	S			A	D	O	R	E	S
F	A	C	E	T	H	E	M	U	S	I	C			
A	D	A		P	E	S	O	S		E	T	U	D	E
K	A	P	P	A		S	O	U	L	M	A	T	E	S
E	G	R	E	T		A	L	A	I		V	I	E	S
R	E	A	C	H		Y	A	L	E		E	L	M	O



Daylen Lile drove in five runs in the Nationals' first game back in Washington after a 1-8 road trip. The team was no-hit through four innings before breaking through.

GEOFF BURKE/IMAGN IMAGES

U.S. OPEN

Federer is set for one final farewell

Five-time champion insists exhibition match won't lead to Williams-esque comeback

BY BRIAN MAHONEY
Associated Press

NEW YORK — Roger Federer is actually nervous about his tennis.

The man who won five straight U.S. Open championships during the height of his dominance is set to play again in Arthur Ashe Stadium on Tuesday night for the first time since 2019. And he's not quite sure how the game that perhaps nobody ever made look more elegant will appear now.

"I haven't played a singles set in, I don't know, [Hubert] Hurkacz at Wimbledon maybe, so it's been five years," Federer said Monday, referring to his 2021 quarterfinal loss in his last Grand Slam match. "I don't know how it's going to go tomorrow. So there is a lot of uncertainty but a lot of happiness that I can return to Arthur Ashe, a place where I have had so many beautiful moments."

It's only one set of singles in an exhibition against Andy Roddick and one set of doubles with John McEnroe against Roddick and Andre Agassi. The winner of 20 Grand Slam singles titles should be fine for those.

But a return to tennis beyond that, competing in major tennis tournaments in his mid-40s, as Venus and Serena Williams are?

"No, no, no, no. No, not at all," Federer said during a news conference. "Thanks for asking. I wasn't sure if the question was going to get asked, but I'm happy you did so I can clarify in case anybody thought."

At 45, Federer still looks fit, and said he enjoys working out in the gym. But he said he goes through long stretches where he is rarely on the court.

SEE FEDERER ON B9

U.S. Open: Federer exhibition event
8 p.m., ESPN2

Freshmen could make big impact on football field

BY STEVE MEGARGEE
Associated Press

There's a realistic possibility that each of the SEC programs in the state of Tennessee could open the season with a freshman starting quarterback.

Freshman Faizon Brandon beat out sophomore George MacIntyre at No. 20 Tennessee in a decision announced Monday. At Vanderbilt, Jared Curtis is competing with senior Blaze Berlowitz for the right to replace 2025 Heisman Trophy runner-up Diego Pavia.

"You look at the total volume of work, and he's earned the right to start," Volunteers Coach Josh Heupel said of Brandon.

Tennessee's quarterback competition had opened up when Joey Aguilar, who threw for 3,565 yards last year, was unable to get an injunction that would have granted him one more season of eligibility.

"I was planning on coming here and working hard regardless, but after I saw that he didn't get his extra year, I would say it made me want to work even harder, knowing there was a quarterback battle now," Brandon told reporters at the start of preseason camp.

Brandon threw for 6,374 yards and 79 touchdowns and rushed for 1,261 yards and 21 more scores while helping Grimsley High School of Greensboro, North Carolina, win back-to-back state titles. Brandon, who is 6-foot-4, was rated as the nation's No. 3 quarterback and No. 10 overall prospect according to composite rankings of recruiting sites compiled by 247Sports.

"We named him the starter because we believe in the work that he has put in and how he's continued to grow and play throughout training camp and the second week through the second scrimmage," Heupel said. "He's earned that right."

SEE FRESHMEN ON B9

Off the road, it's less rocky

BY DANIELLE ALLENTUCK

To get back in the win column following a brutal road swing, the Washington Nationals needed a little bit of help. Enter the Colorado Rockies' defense.

After being no-hit in the first four innings of Monday's series opener, the Nationals capitalized on two errors and several more missed plays from the Rockies as they scored five runs in the fifth inning. That inning brought their offense back to life, and they went on to a commanding 13-3 win at Nationals Park.

"Just one small mistake on their end ended up being huge," Manager Blake Butera said. "We were able to take advantage of that and capitalize, I think that's what good teams do. I was happy we could continue to roll with that momentum."

After a 1-8, three-city road trip, the victory snapped a four-game losing streak and gives Washington a confidence boost as it opens a 10-game home

NATIONALS 13, ROCKIES 3

Colorado's miscues helps Nats end skid to start homestand

stand. Daylen Lile and Jorbit Vivas each had three hits, while every player reached base multiple times.

"We all know we've gone through a little bit, or a lot a bit," Butera said. "The message after yesterday's game was let yesterday and the past several weeks sink in a little bit, take some time to digest but once we get back here, the page turns to Monday. Back here at home, we need to be ready to go and have some fun and get back to playing our game and winning some games."

It helped, too, having CJ Abrams back in the lineup after he rolled his ankle last week and missed four games. He did not

play in the field and did not take any grounders at second base — his new position — during batting practice, but he was able to run the bases well enough to hit. It was sore after the game, he said, and he had trouble changing directions quickly.

His limited presence was still felt: Abrams walked, had a hit, scored two runs and stole two bases. With 29 homers and 26 steals, he's now just the second player in Nationals history — after Alfonso Soriano in 2006 — with at least 25 of each in a single season.

"It's cool," Abrams said of the accomplishment. "Just keep going, the season is not over and we have a little bit to go."

Cade Cavalli, who's in the best stretch of his career, twirled his ninth quality start in a row. He allowed just two runs in six innings — solo shots from Willi Castro

SEE NATIONALS ON B10

Rockies at Nationals
6:45 p.m., Nationals.TV

Alvarez eyes Triple Crown — and playoff berth for the Astros

BY NOAH TRISTER
Associated Press

As the season winds down, Houston Astros slugger Yordan Alvarez will have to worry about two sets of spoilers.

THIS WEEK IN BASEBALL

The first is the more traditional type — teams that will try to beat the Astros in key games and deny them a spot in the postseason.

The other includes individual spoilers — players who could prevent Alvarez from becoming baseball's next Triple Crown winner.

Heading into Monday's games, Alvarez leads the American League with a .320 average, 36 home runs and 90 RBI. If he holds onto the top spot in all three categories, he would be the first to win the Triple Crown since Miguel Cabrera in 2012.

The biggest threats Alvarez faces all come from the AL East.

The next-highest batting averages in the league both belong to Tampa Bay Rays players: Chandler Simpson is hitting .310, and Yandy Diaz is at .306. Fortunately for Alvarez, there aren't any stealth candidates — players with high averages who don't have enough plate appearances to qualify but could by the end of the season.

The home run race is the tightest, with the Rays' Junior Camerino just one behind with 35. Ben Rice of the New York

SEE BASEBALL ON B10



TIM WARNER/GETTY IMAGES

Entering Monday's games, Yordan Alvarez was on pace to be the first Triple Crown winner since Miguel Cabrera in 2012.

THE DAY IN SPORTS

PRO BASKETBALL

Kanter Freedom, White ineligible for W’s draft

Former NBA players **Enes Kanter Freedom** and **Royce White** are not eligible for the WNBA draft, a person familiar with the decision said Monday.

The person spoke to the Associated Press on the condition of anonymity because of the sensitive nature of the situation. The person did not elaborate on the reasons for declaring the two men ineligible.

Kanter Freedom and White have declared their intention to enter next year’s draft, but the WNBA has not publicly addressed their eligibility.

The WNBA has been the subject of recent debates on whether transgender women — women assigned male at birth who transition to align with their gender identity — should be allowed to participate in the league. There has never been such a player in the WNBA.

Although the league’s collective bargaining agreement says the WNBA is restricted to women, it contains no more specific language about gender identity or sex assigned at birth. When they announced their intention to enter the draft, Kanter Freedom and White said they identified as women.

The 6-foot-10, 250-pound Kanter Freedom played 11 seasons in the NBA. White played in three NBA games. ...

Cecilia Zandalasini scored eight of her 18 points in the fourth quarter, **Gabby Williams** added 15 points, and the Golden State Valkyries beat the Minnesota Lynx for the first time in franchise history, 80-66, in Minneapolis.

Golden State (26-11) entered 0-9 against Minnesota in the regular season and playoffs since joining the WNBA in 2025.

The Valkyries led 63-57 early in the fourth quarter before going on a 14-1 run to make it 77-58. Zandalasini made her first three-pointer of the game with 4:39 left, and she added another on Minnesota’s next possession for a 16-point lead.

Veronica Burton had 14 points and nine assists, and **Tiffany Hayes** also scored 14 for Golden State.

The first-place Lynx (31-8) were without starting guard **Courtney Williams** (right ankle) in a regular season game for the first time since she joined the team in 2024, a streak of 122 games.

Natasha Howard led Minnesota with 13 points, and **Kayla McBride** added 12. **Olivia Miles** moved past **Ticha Penicheiro** to the second-most assists by a rookie in WNBA history with 225. ...

Coming off a career season, Portland Trail Blazers guard **Shaeldon Sharpe** is expected to miss six months after suffering a torn meniscus in his right knee, ESPN reported.

Sharpe, 23, averaged 20.8 points, 4.3 rebounds and 2.6 assists in 2025-26, helping Portland to its first NBA postseason appearance since 2021 even though he missed 32 games with a stress fracture in his left fibula.

TENNIS

Fonseca is latest star to pull out of U.S. Open

Brazil’s **Joao Fonseca** pulled out of the U.S. Open because of an abdominal injury, the 20-year-old said on Instagram, marking the latest high-profile absence in the men’s singles field.

The 26th-ranked player was among the hot tickets in Flushing Meadows after his sensational quarterfinals run at the French Open, where he beat **Novak Djokovic** and **Casper Ruud**.

“After undergoing tests and starting treatment for my abdomen, it became clear to me and my team that I need more time to fully recover so I can compete at a high level,” said Fonseca.

World No. 1 **Jannik Sinner** and Briton **Jack Draper** withdrew from the tournament last week with injuries. Former world No. 4 **Holger Rune** also will miss the event. ...

Serena Williams and **Carlos Alcaraz** will open the U.S. Open mixed doubles tournament against a team that features the reigning women’s doubles champion.

Williams and Alcaraz will face **Erin Routliffe** and **Lloyd Glasspool** on Tuesday in the first round of the championship, which will be Williams’s first match at the U.S. Open since 2022.

Aryna Sabalenka and **Novak Djokovic** might have an even tougher draw. The top seeds, based on having the lowest combined singles ranking in the



LINTAO ZHANG/GETTY IMAGES

Automated qualifiers

Humanoid robots play tennis at the World Humanoid Robot Games at National Speed Skating Oval in Beijing on Monday.

SPOTLIGHT: FOOTBALL

Waived by Browns, Wright is set to join LSU

BY BRETT MARTEL
AND ROB MAADDI

BATON ROUGE, LA. — After a stop in the NFL, former Mississippi tight end Dae’Quan Wright could be heading to LSU thanks to a court order that is creating havoc throughout college sports by allowing Wright and others an unexpected fifth year of eligibility.

Wright’s agent, Drew Rosenhaus, told the Associated Press on Monday that the tight end had been waived by the Cleveland Browns and, if he clears waivers, will join Lane Kiffin’s roster at No. 11 LSU.

If he joins the Tigers, Wright is believed to be the first player to return to college after playing in the NFL. He may not be the last.

At a news conference Monday, Kiffin declined to discuss any specific players, but he did say of the players who sued the NCAA: “They’re available to recruit. So, ourselves, like many places around the country, are recruiting them.”

Not doing so, Kiffin said, could lead to a situation where “we may end up playing against them.”

Wright signed with the Philadelphia Eagles as an undrafted rookie following the draft. After Philadelphia released him Aug. 11, Cleveland signed him. Wright didn’t play in the Browns’ two preseason games.

Former Mississippi tight end is believed to be first player to return to college from NFL

Wright played two seasons for Kiffin at Mississippi. Last year, he caught 39 passes for 635 yards and five touchdowns.

Wright was among a group of players who sued in a Louisiana court, saying a new NCAA rule granting five years of eligibility to most athletes should apply to him and others who were not “grandfathered” into the rule, which didn’t include those who graduated high school in 2022.

In a statement Monday evening, the SEC said it firmly opposes professional athletes returning to college sports.

“College athletes, not professional athletes, have been at the heart of the Southeastern Conference,” the statement said. “Individuals who choose to leave college athletics, sign professional playing contracts, and compete professionally should not then be permitted to return to college competition. Allowing that to occur will blur the line between college and professional sports, create significant competitive equity concerns and reduce opportunities for high school and current college athletes.”

The SEC concluded its statement by calling on Congress to pass a bill regulating college sports.

Wright and two others who played for Kiffin at Mississippi — former New Orleans Saints defensive tackle Zxavian Harris and Arizona Cardinals safety Wydett Williams — were among those granted a temporary restraining order last week. Former LSU and current Tampa Bay Buccaneers linebacker Jack Pynburn also was among the plaintiffs.

The players can regain their college eligibility if they terminate their pro contracts and repay any pro earnings.

A preliminary injunction hearing is scheduled for Aug. 31 in East Baton Rouge, Louisiana.

The SEC has its own rule barring transfers inside the conference beyond a designated window in January. Commissioner Greg Sankey sent the schools a reminder about that rule earlier this month, though there’s no certainty on how it would play into Wright’s move to LSU in the wake of the court order.

The judge in Louisiana allowed for the fifth year and also ordered the football transfer portal — normally open only in January — to reopen for a week for the players in the lawsuit.

— Associated Press

Maaddi contributed from Tampa.

TELEVISION AND RADIO

MLB	
6:45 p.m.	Colorado at Washington » Nationals-TV, WJFK (106.7 FM)
7:15 p.m.	Los Angeles Dodgers at Atlanta » TBS
7:45 p.m.	Baltimore at St. Louis » MASN, WYNY (97.9 FM), WSNB (630 AM)
9:30 p.m.	Philadelphia at Seattle » MLB Network
WNBA	
8 p.m.	Portland at Dallas » NBA TV
10 p.m.	Washington at Phoenix » Monumental Sports Network, WTEM (980 AM)
SOCCER	
Noon	Saudi Arabian Pro League: Al Khaleej at Abha » Fox Sports 2
2 p.m.	Saudi Arabian Pro League: Al Nassr at Al Ettifaq » Fox Sports 2
8:30 p.m.	Copa Libertadores round of 16, second leg: Deportes Tolima at Independiente del Valle » BeIN Sports

TENNIS	
10 a.m.	U.S. Open, qualifying » ESPN2
2 p.m.	U.S. Open, qualifying; ATP: Winston-Salem Open, early rounds; WTA: Monterrey Open, early rounds » Tennis Channel
8 p.m.	U.S. Open, Roger Federer exhibition event » ESPN2
BASKETBALL	
8 p.m.	Dunkman League, final » TNT
LITTLE LEAGUE BASEBALL WORLD SERIES	
1 p.m.	Mexico vs. Japan » ESPN
3 p.m.	Washington vs. Alabama » ESPN
5 p.m.	Canada vs. South Korea » ESPN
7 p.m.	Ohio vs. New Jersey » ESPN

16-team field, face the team of **Katerina Siniakova** and **Henry Patten** — who are the top-ranked doubles players on their respective tours.

COLLEGES

Transfer Philo to start under center for Gators

Florida football will start quarterback **Aaron Philo** in the team’s season opener against Florida Atlantic on Sept. 5, Coach **Jon Sumrall** said.

Philo, a 6-foot-1, 207-pound junior from Bogart, Georgia, edged **Tramell Jones Jr.** in a competition that began in the spring and carried into fall camp. The Gators held their second of two scrimmages Saturday, and Sumrall made the announcement two days later.

Philo seemingly had an advantage from Day 1, partly because he spent the past two seasons with Florida offensive

coordinator **Buster Faulkner**. Philo followed Faulkner to Gainesville from Georgia Tech. Philo served as **Haynes King**’s backup and appeared in eight games.

Jones served as **DJ Lagway**’s backup last season and played in two games, completing 21 of 35 passes for 191 yards and two touchdowns. ...

Northwestern named **Aidan Chiles** its starting quarterback, ESPN reported.

Chiles started 20 games for Michigan State over the past two seasons. He passed for 3,807 yards and 23 touchdowns and was intercepted 14 times while with the Spartans. ...

Former Football Championship Subdivision star **Braden Atkinson** beat out incumbent **Maalik Murphy** and fellow transfer **Brady Jones** to earn the Oregon State starting quarterback gig.

Atkinson played last season at Mercer and won the Jerry Rice

Award as the top freshman in FCS. He completed 66 percent of his passes and set single-season school records of 3,596 yards and 34 touchdown passes. ...

RJ Luis Jr., a former St. John’s men’s basketball standout who recently signed with LSU after spending time with two NBA clubs, was cleared by a court to start practicing and potentially play for the Tigers this season.

SOCCER

Rogers helps Chelsea start its season off right

Chelsea record signing **Morgan Rogers** scored in his debut, a 3-2 win over Fulham that gave new coach **Xabi Alonso** a perfect start to the English Premier League season.

Rogers, who came over from Aston Villa last month, scored four minutes before halftime when he slotted home a sweet cutback from **Maxence Lacroix**.

Brazilian **João Pedro** gave Chelsea the lead after 32 seconds, only for **Josh King** to equalize midway through the first half.

Cole Palmer, one of Chelsea’s outstanding performers on the night, made it 3-1 with 49 minutes gone when he fired home from a tight angle after running on to Pedro’s pass.

Fulham cut the deficit almost immediately — **Gonzalo García** heading down and into the net after Sanchez could only parry **Timothy Castagne**’s low shot — and it poured forward in search of a winner, but it was not to be. ...

Donyell Malen’s hat trick got Roma off to a blistering Italian league start in a 4-0 win over Fiorentina.

Malen converted three passes from **Paolo Dybala** to score in the 27th, 52nd and 60th minutes and make Roma one of nine clubs with full points after the Serie A opening weekend. Substitute **Niccolò Pisilli** completed the rout four minutes from time.

GOLF

Stanford finalizes team for U.S. at Solheim Cup

U.S. captain **Angela Stanford** filled out her Solheim Cup team with three picks, leaning on experience for two picks along with taking 35-year-old **Lindy Duncan**, who has never played in the matches or won on the LPGA Tour.

Stanford took **Megan Khang**, who will be making her fifth Solheim Cup appearance and is unbeaten in singles, and **Rose Zhang**, who played on two teams while finishing up at Stanford. Zhang won all four of her matches in 2024 in Virginia, with none reaching the 17th hole.

Duncan was among the players who lost out in a playoff at the Chevron Championship in 2025. She fell from automatic qualifying this summer by finishing out of the top 30 in her past 12 tournaments and missing the cut in four of the five majors this year.

Duncan is the oldest American to make her Solheim Cup debut since **Nancy Scranton** was 39 for the 2000 matches at Loch Lomond. Duncan joins **Auston Kim**, who made the U.S. team on points, as the only Solheim Cup rookies.

BASEBALL

Women’s league exec takes concerns public

A member of the Women’s Pro Baseball League’s board of directors is asking a Delaware court to force the fledgling organization to release records she says could reveal misuse of company funds and undisclosed conflicts of interest.

The WPBL launched Aug. 1 hoping to become the most successful pro league for women’s baseball since the All-American Girls Professional Baseball League folded in 1954. The demand for books and records, filed in the Delaware Court of Chancery, could impact the league’s ability to bring in more partners, sponsors and investors.

The legal filing says the league has refused to provide **Mina Kim**, a WPBL investor, with “books and records reasonably related” to her responsibilities as one of six members of the league’s board. The missing records could include details about money paid to an entity owned by CEO **Keith Stein** and a possible family connection between Stein and another board member.

Kim wants the Delaware court to order the WPBL to produce the outstanding material identified in the filing and award her attorneys’ fees and expenses.

The WPBL said it had provided complete information while participating fully in Kim’s request for books and records.

AUTO RACING

Hill will drive full time for RCR next season

Austin Hill will drive the No. 33 Chevrolet on a full-time basis in the NASCAR Cup Series for Richard Childress Racing beginning next season, the team said.

Hill has run 15 Cup races this season but has failed to register a top 10 finish.

However, he has 16 wins over the past five seasons driving RCR’s No. 21 Chevrolet in the NASCAR O’Reilly Auto Parts Series. He has qualified for the Chase in each of those five seasons.

RCR has long been known for developing some of the sport’s biggest stars, including **Kevin Harvick**, **Clint Bowyer**, **Austin Dillon** and **Tyler Reddick**.

CYCLING

Third stage of Vuelta is nixed because of hail

The third stage of the Spanish Vuelta ended without a winner after organizers halted it because of hail.

Riders started taking shelter in shops and restaurants by the road with about 15 kilometers (nine miles) to go on the difficult 174-kilometer (108-mile) route that was set to finish in the French Pyrenees.

Organizers neutralized the race as conditions became dangerous with ice on the road and the threat of lightning. They eventually suspended the stage and declared no winner.

Mats Wenzel of Equipo Kern Pharm and **Lorenzo Fortunato** of XDS Astana were on a breakaway at the time the race was called off. **Tadej Pogacar**, the Tour de France winner seeking a personal sweep of the Grand Tour races, remained the race leader.

From news services

NFL NOTES

Browns choose Watson over Sanders as their starting QB

FROM NEWS SERVICES

Not many thought Deshaun Watson had a chance of reclaiming the starting quarterback job with the Cleveland Browns.

Watson has ruptured his right Achilles tendon twice in the past two years and has started just 19 games for Cleveland. Owner Jimmy Haslam said at last year's owners meetings that the Browns "took a big swing and miss" when they sent three first-round picks to the Houston Texans for the controversial quarterback in 2022.

After Shedeur Sanders had a solid first half in Saturday's 31-7 preseason loss to the Buffalo Bills, a frustrated Watson — who struggled as he took the field in Cleveland for the first time in 22 months — said the boos from the crowd were "personal" and showed "dis-respect."

Despite the hurdles and a close competition with Sanders, Watson will be the Browns' starting quarterback for their Sept. 13 opener at the Jacksonville Jaguars.

Coach Todd Monken made the announcement Monday after informing Watson and Sanders.

"I took in the full body of work over the course of the offseason to training camp to the games, the joint practice, and ultimately felt like to start the season on the road, Deshaun gave us the best chance to move the ball and score points," Monken said.

Watson, a 10-year veteran, split reps with Sanders with the first unit throughout the offseason, training camp and the preseason.

The decision to start him will not be popular with Browns fans, who have booed Watson repeatedly during his time in Cleveland and have put a lot of support behind Sanders since he was drafted last year.

Monken reiterated that fan sentiment and Watson's comments did not play a role in his decision.

After the announcement, Watson took responsibility for his comments, saying his emotions got the better of him.

"I just felt like it was what was on my heart," he said. "It was never intended to go at a certain person, fan base or a certain crowd. It was just, this is how I feel. And once I got it off my chest, I felt better."

Sanders has shown steady



CAROLYN KASTER/AP

Deshaun Watson, left, is set to make his 20th start with the Browns in their opener. Shedeur Sanders, right, could get the nod this season.

progress throughout the offseason. Even though he will be on the sideline for the opener, he is likely to start at some point this season.

- **49ERS:** San Francisco owner Jed York was arrested over the weekend in Ohio and pleaded no contest to misdemeanor charges of disorderly conduct and possessing criminal tools.
- Court records show York initially was charged with engaging in prostitution, but prosecutors amended that to disorderly conduct. He was charged with possessing criminal tools for using his phone to respond to an undercover online prostitution advertisement, according to prosecutors.
- York was arrested Sunday morning at a mobile home community in East Palestine, Ohio, near where he was born and raised in Youngstown. He was released after posting a \$5,000 bond. He was sentenced to one day in jail for both offenses to be served concurrently and was credited with one day served when he pleaded no contest. He also was fined \$1,150.
- **BILLS:** A police investigation into the death of Buffalo defensive tackle Ed Oliver's 1-year-old son has resulted in no criminal findings, and the case is now considered closed, the Harris County (Texas) Sheriff's Office said.
- The closing of the case comes after the child's June 28 death was first confirmed Saturday in a statement from Bills General Manager Brandon Beane expressing condolences to Oliver.
- Police say the toddler, who was a few days shy of his second birthday, was found unresponsive in the swimming pool of a home in a neighborhood community just north of Houston. The boy was transported to the hospital where he was pronounced dead.
- **SEAHAWKS:** Rookie safety Bud Clark will be out "multiple months" with a broken right ankle

suffered in Seattle's preseason loss at the Tennessee Titans on Sunday night.

Reserve offensive lineman Mason Richman also sustained a long-term injury. The second-year guard walked off the field without assistance after getting hurt on the opening drive.

Seattle also waived undrafted rookie running back Anthony Hankerson, who could try to play in college again.

- **CARDINALS:** Arizona activated Josh Sweat from the physically unable to perform list in a sign that the talented edge rusher could be ready for the season opener against the Los Angeles Chargers.
- Arizona also waived/injured Trey Benson. The running back, drafted in 2024 out of Florida State, battled injuries for much of his first two seasons.
- **STEELERS:** Coach Mike McCarthy said Pittsburgh and fourth-

year cornerback Joey Porter Jr. are at an impasse as the two sides try to work out a new contract.

Pittsburgh also activated eight-time Pro Bowl cornerback Jalen Ramsey from the PUP list. Ramsey, 31, sustained a knee injury during the team's minicamp but did not require surgery.

- **PANTHERS:** Starting running back Chuba Hubbard is expected to be ready for Carolina's season opener against the Chicago Bears, Coach Dave Canales said.
- Hubbard strained his hamstring earlier this month in training camp and has yet to play in a preseason game while working his way back to full strength.
- **RAMS:** Offensive lineman Justin Dedich participated in practice for the first time since sustaining a hand injury around the Fourth of July.
- Los Angeles activated Dedich off the nonfootball injury list, and he practiced on a limited basis.

Signed as an undrafted free agent out of USC, Dedich emerged to become the Rams' backup guard the past two seasons, playing in 29 games and making nine starts.

- **RAIDERS:** Running back Ashton Jeanty is believed to have sprained his ankle Sunday during Las Vegas' practice in Henderson, Nevada, according to a co-report from ESPN and NFL Network.
- Jeanty dove for an attempted catch on a pass route and fell awkwardly on the indoor turf surface, per multiple reports. He stayed down before being helped from the field by trainers and medical personnel. He couldn't put weight on his right leg as he left the scene.
- **SAINTS:** New Orleans is signing former all-pro kicker Daniel Carlson after he spent eight seasons with the Raiders, his agents confirmed to NFL Network.
- The Saints have been holding a competition between kickers Charlie Smyth and Tanner Brown in training camp.
- **PATRIOTS:** New England signed veteran punter Matt Haack, a week after the Washington Commanders waived him, according to ESPN.
- Coach Mike Vabel told reporters that the Patriots would be adding a new punter after Bryce Baringer was forced to exit Saturday's preseason win over the Philadelphia Eagles with an injury.
- **COLTS:** Injured special teams coordinator Brian Mason said he intends to return to the sideline in time for Indianapolis's opener against the Baltimore Ravens.
- Mason suffered a seventh major injury to his left knee during the Colts' first preseason game Aug. 13 against the Patriots. On the game's final play, Colts quarterback Riley Leonard threw a Hail Mary pass, and multiple players rolled into Mason's legs.
- **MISC.:** The Texans acquired wide receiver Kayshon Boutte from the Patriots for safety Jaylen Reed and a seventh-round draft pick in 2028. ...
- The Saints are acquiring running back Zamir White from the 49ers for linebacker Deion Jones, ESPN reported. ...
- Tight end C.J. Uzomah announced his retirement after 10 seasons, and wide receiver Allen Robinson is retiring after 11 seasons.

Two Volunteer State gunslingers are among freshmen who could grab spotlight

FRESHMEN FROM B7

Curtis is trying to gain that responsibility at Vanderbilt.

The 6-3 freshman garnered plenty of attention after withdrawing his verbal commitment to Georgia and choosing to play for his hometown school, becoming the highest-ranked recruit ever to sign with the Commodores. Curtis was the nation's No. 4 recruit in his class, according to the 247Sports Composite.

Curtis threw for more than 9,500 career yards and rushed for more than 2,100 yards at Nashville Christian Academy, where he won a state title and was named Tennessee's Gatorade player of the year.

"The raw ability and skill, I think it's clear to everyone, from an arm strength standpoint, from a play creation standpoint," Vanderbilt Coach Clark Lea told reporters after an Aug. 16 scrimmage. "And yet this is baptism by fire. You're in an SEC training camp again getting multiple looks, you've got the full playbook that you're working through and all the checks in your hip pocket. That can slow a player like that down. He's been a little inconsistent at times, but he's also been really explosive at times, too."

Curtis is competing with Berlowitz, who started out at



CATIE MCMEKIN/NEWS SENTINEL/USA TODAY NETWORK

Freshman Faizon Brandon beat out sophomore George MacIntyre and was awarded the starting quarterback job at No. 20 Tennessee.

New Mexico State and has attempted 36 career passes.

Here's a look at some other true freshmen across the nation who could make an immediate impact:

- **Texas wide receiver Jermaine Bishop Jr.:** Bishop made enough of an impression during a scrimmage Saturday that Texas Coach Steve Sarkisian told reporters afterward, "It wouldn't surprise me at all in a couple of weeks if he has a significant role offensively for us." The 6-foot wideout from Wilis, Texas, was the nation's No. 58

prospect in his class, according to the 247Sports Composite.

- **Alabama running backs Trae'hawn Brown and EJ Crowell:** Alabama ranked 125th among Football Bowl Subdivision teams in yards per game (104.13) and 126th in yards per carry (3.35) last season. That should create some opportunity for its freshman running backs. Crowell has the best recruiting profile as a former five-star prospect ranked 15th in the 247Sports Composite, but he's been limited by an ankle injury. Brown, a



DENNY SIMMONS/TENNESSEAN/USA TODAY NETWORK

Jared Curtis, who withdrew a verbal commitment to Georgia, is in the hunt to replace Heisman runner-up Diego Pavia at Vanderbilt.

three-star recruit, has performed well enough in preseason camp to suggest he will outperform that ranking.

- **Miami offensive lineman Jackson Cantwell:** The Hurricanes must replace four starters from the offensive line that helped them reach the College Football Playoff championship game last season. Cantwell should step right in to help. He arrives from Nixa (Missouri) High as the first offensive lineman ever to be named the Gatorade national player of the year.

The 247Sports Composite ranked him as the No. 2 prospect in his class. Cantwell, a two-time state champion in the shot put, is a natural tackle who could end up starting his college career at guard.

- **Washington offensive tackle Kodi Greene:** Greene already is being penciled in as Washington's likely starting left tackle for the beginning of the season. Although Greene is from Renton, Washington, he played the last two years at Mater Dei in Santa Ana, California. The 247Sports

Composite ranked Greene third among offensive tackles and 26th overall in his class.

- **Ohio State wide receivers Chris Henry Jr.:** Nobody's producing as many future NFL wideouts as Ohio State these days. The 6-5 Henry figures to be the Buckeyes' next star. He caught four passes for 96 yards and a touchdown in Ohio State's spring game. The 247Sports Composite ranked him 14th overall and second among receivers. He should step right into a featured role while playing alongside all-American wide receiver and Heisman Trophy contender Jeremiah Smith. Henry is the son of former Cincinnati Bengals wide receiver Chris Henry, who died in 2009.
- **Michigan running back Savion Hiter:** Hiter was rated as the nation's No. 1 running back and No. 12 overall prospect in his class, according to the 247Sports Composite. He rushed for 1,455 yards and 25 touchdowns his senior year in high school after running for 1,698 yards as a junior and 1,187 yards as a sophomore. He has made enough of an impression in preseason camp to merit a featured role working alongside new teammate Jordan Marshall, who piled up 932 yards and 10 touchdowns on the ground last season.

At the U.S. Open, Federer will say goodbye to a tournament he once dominated

FEDERER FROM B7

His lengthy absence from the U.S. Open has done little to dampen his popularity, based on the amount of people around the grounds who were mentioning his name. The appearance of "Roger Federer" up on the big board ahead of his afternoon practice at Ashe Stadium, where Federer collected the trophy every year from 2004 to 2008, was a welcome sight for his fans.

The trip to New York is a stop for Federer on his way to Newport, Rhode Island, where he will be enshrined in the International Tennis Hall of Fame on Saturday.

Federer never really had the chance to say goodbye to New York as a player, because there was no

way to know his loss to Grigor Dimitrov in the 2019 quarterfinals would be his last match. He had reached the French Open semifinals and the Wimbledon final that year, falling to Rafael Nadal in Paris and then Novak Djokovic in a fifth-set tiebreaker at the All England Club.

It was easy to imagine him returning to the U.S. Open the next year and making another deep run. But after falling to Djokovic in the semifinals of the Australian Open to begin 2020, he had knee surgery that February, then another procedure in May.

He returned to play in the French Open in 2021 but had to withdraw before his fourth-round match. After the loss to Hurkacz — where he appeared struggling and



EDUARDO MUNOZ/REUTERS

Roger Federer's loss to Grigor Dimitrov in the 2019 quarterfinals ended up being his last appearance at the U.S. Open as a player.

"There is a lot of uncertainty but a lot of happiness that I can return to Arthur Ashe, a place where I have had so many beautiful moments."

— Roger Federer, five-time U.S. Open champion

lost 6-0 in the third set — Federer had another knee surgery that August and knew there would be no more comebacks.

"The knee can't do it anymore. It's tired," he recalled thinking. "The mind can't be patient even more and wait for another couple years and see what happens."

Federer knows Tuesday night won't be real tennis, joking that he and Roddick hopefully would be respectful and not try to drop-shot

each other. But it will be different from when he did return to Ashe a couple of years, back to watch.

"They gave me an ovation because they saw me on the big screen, but I just feel, like, tomorrow and I guess today, as well, and Monday next week, it really gives me a true opportunity to say thank you and goodbye, which I think is important for some," Federer said. "It's a nice thing to do, for sure."

SCOREBOARD

PRO FOOTBALL

NFL preseason

THURSDAY, AUG. 6

HALL OF FAME GAME — IN CANTON, OHIO

Carolina 33, Arizona 30

WEEK 1

THURSDAY, AUG. 13

at Cincinnati 16, Detroit 14

at Pittsburgh 28, Green Bay 9

Indianapolis 13, at New England 13

L.A. Chargers 27, at Houston 7

Arizona 27, at Las Vegas 14

Tennessee 19, at San Francisco 13

FRIDAY, AUG. 14

at Washington 20, Miami 7

Tampa Bay 24, at N.Y. Jets 16

Denver 27, at Atlanta 7

SATURDAY, AUG. 15

at Baltimore 24, Philadelphia 7

Minnesota 13, at N.Y. Giants 10

at Buffalo 29, Carolina 14

at Chicago 34, Cleveland 10

Jacksonville 24, at New Orleans 20

L.A. Rams 20, at Kansas City 12

Dallas 17, at Seattle 7

WEEK 2

THURSDAY'S RESULTS

Las Vegas 22, at Houston 20

at Chicago 34, Cleveland 10

at Los Angeles 7, Cincinnati 17

Green Bay at Denver, late

SATURDAY'S RESULTS

at Detroit 17, Washington 13

Baltimore 13, at Minnesota 3

Buffalo 31, at Cleveland 7

Atlanta 34, at Indianapolis 6

N.Y. Giants 26, at Miami 3

at L.A. Rams 34, New Orleans 0

Cincinnati at Philadelphia 6

Seattle at Kansas City, 8

New Orleans at Dallas, 8

Arizona at Green Bay, 8

Minnesota at Denver, 9

SATURDAY'S GAMES

Detroit at Indianapolis, 6

Chicago at Tennessee, 6

Titans 19, Seahawks 16

Late Sunday

SEATTLE16 0 0 0 —16

TENNESSEE3 6 0 10 —19

FIRST QUARTER

Seattle: Arrow 36 pass from Lock (Myers kick), 11:12.

Tennessee: F. Slye 3, 8:02.

Seattle: Wright 69 run (kick failed), 5:43.

Seattle: F. Myers 48, 1:20.

SECOND QUARTER

Tennessee: F. Slye 33, 5:27.

Tennessee: F. Slye 40, 1:10.

FOURTH QUARTER

Tennessee: F. Slye 43, 14:55.

Tennessee: D. Johnson 2-run (Slye kick), 5:45.

Attendance: 49,194.

	SEA	TEN
First Downs	251	277
Total Net Yards	251	277
Rushes-Yards	19-117	36-128
Passing	134	149
Punt Returns	3-14	3-3
Kickoff Returns	4-68	4-104
Interceptions Ret.	0-0	2-1
Comp.-Att.-Int.	18-25-2	21-32-0
Sacked-Yards Lost	2-14	2-14
Punts	3-47-667	4-54-0
Fumbles-Lost	1-1	1-0
Penalties-Yards	14-129	11-100
Time Of Possession	25:54	34:06

PASSING

Seattle: Lock 12-14-0-103, Milroe 6-11-2-52.

Tennessee: Ward 8-12-0-49, Taylor 7-9-0-49.

H. Hooker 2-2-0-35, Lewis 4-9-0-15.

RUSHING

Seattle: Wright 8-31, Milroe 1-16, Hankerson 5-10,

Lock 2-8, V. Jones 3, 2.

Tennessee: Chestnut 8-48, Carter 7-28, D. Johnson 10-25,

Lewis 15-33, Pollard 2-12, Spears 2-2, H. Hooker 3-minus 2.

MISSSED FIELD GOALS

Seattle: Myers 44.

COLLEGE FOOTBALL

NCAA

WEEK 0

SATURDAY'S GAMES

North Carolina State at Virginia, 3:30

North Carolina vs. TCU in Dublin, noon

San Jose State at USC, 3

Jacksonville State at North Dakota State, 5:30

Sacramento State at Eastern Michigan, 6:30

Hawaii at Stanford, 7

New Mexico State at Florida State, 7

Memphis at UNLV, 10

PRO BASKETBALL

WNBA

EAST

ny-Minnesota24 13 .649 —

y-Indiana25 14 .641 —

y-New York23 15 .605 1½

y-Washington22 15 .595 2

Chicago15 23 .395 9½

Toronto11 26 .297 13

Connecticut9 27 .250 14½

WEST

ny-Minnesota31 7 .816 —

ny-Golden State25 11 .694 5

y-Las Vegas26 13 .667 5½

Dallas22 16 .579 9

Portland15 22 .405 15½

Los Angeles13 24 .351 17½

Phoenix13 24 .351 17½

Seattle7 31 .184 24

x-Late game; y-Clinched playoff spot

FRIDAY'S RESULTS

Minnesota 94, at Washington 84

at Chicago 73, Golden State 70

Toronto 82, Portland 79 in Vancouver, British Columbia

SATURDAY'S RESULTS

at New York 109, Indiana 102

at Los Angeles 77, Connecticut 68

Atlanta 99, at Phoenix 89

SUNDAY'S RESULTS

Washington 105, at Portland 100

at Dallas 92, Seattle 70

Indiana 113, at Chicago 90

Las Vegas 88, Toronto 78 in Vancouver, British Columbia

MONDAY'S RESULTS

Golden State 80, at Minnesota 66

Atlanta at Los Angeles, late

TUESDAY'S GAMES

Washington at Phoenix, 10

Chicago at Connecticut, 7

Portland at Dallas, 8

WEDNESDAY'S GAMES

Golden State at Connecticut, 7

Toronto at Seattle, 10

THURSDAY'S GAMES

Washington at Phoenix, 10

Golden State at New York, 8

FRIDAY'S GAMES

Washington at Los Angeles, 10

Portland at Atlanta, 7:30

Connecticut at Indiana, 7:30

Toronto at Las Vegas, 10

SATURDAY'S GAMES

Chicago at New York, 1

Toronto at Phoenix, 10

SUNDAY'S GAMES

Minnesota at Atlanta, 3

Los Angeles at Seattle, 5

Golden State at Portland, 7

Connecticut at Dallas, 8

MYSTICS' NEXT THREE

at Phoenix Mercury

Tuesday 10 Monumental

at Phoenix Mercury

Thursday 10 Prime Video

at Los Angeles Sparks

Friday 10 Ion

Radio: WTEM (980 AM)

Valkyries 80, Lynx 66

Golden State17 17 21 25 — 80

Minnesota16 16 16 18 — 66

GOLDEN STATE

MINN FG FT O-T A PF PTS

Thornton 7:55 0-2 0-0 0-1 0 0 0

Zandalasini 29:32 7-17 2-2 0-1 1 4 18

Hayes 26:41 1-1 0-0 1 3 2

Burton 30:05 6-11 0-0 3-4 9 14

G. Williams 30:01 5-15 2-4 1-5 3 0 15

Salaun 27:59 5-11 0-0 2-5 3 1 12

Hayes 18:20 5-8 2-2 2-3 4 3 14

Charles 12:19 1-2 0-0 0-1 1 2 2

Chen 9:55 1-3 0-0 0-0 1 3 3

Amihere 5:04 0-0 0-0 1-2 0 0 0

Fingall 0-0 0-0 0-0 0-0 0 0 0

Jocyte 0:43 0-0 0-0 0-0 0 0 0

Sowah 0:43 0-1 0-0 0-0 0 0 0

TOTALS 200 31-71 6-8 11-23 16 80

Percentages: FG 437, FT 750. 3-Point Goals: 12-33, 364

(G. Williams 3-8, Hayes 2-3, Burton 2-4, Salaun 2-5,

Zandalasini 3-8, Chen 1-1, Charles 0-1, Sowah 0-1,

Thornton 0-2, Team Rebounds: 6, Team Turnovers: 3,

Blocked Shots: 4 (Stokes 2, Amihere, Zandalasini),

Turnovers: 6 (Hayes 2, Salaun 2, Amihere, Burton),

Steals: 12 (Burton 5, G. Williams 2, Zandalasini 2, Hayes 3,

Salaun, Stokes), Technical Fouls: None.

MINNESOTA

COLLIER FG FT O-T A PF PTS

Collier 31:39 4-10 0-0 0-7 2 0 12

McBride 33:24 2-11 6-6 0-4 1 1 12

Howard 27:42 3-8 7-10 5-7 1 13 13

Caldwell 25:21 3-5 0-0 0-2 3 9 9

Miles 27:49 3-12 1-2 0-4 5 1 8

Coffey 15:19 2-4 0-0 1-3 0 0 6

Juhasz 10:10 2-4 0-0 0-3 0 0 5

Kibby 7:25 2-3 0-0 0-0 1 5 5

Delabre 1:19 0-0 0-0 0-0 0 0 0

Kossu 7:17 0-0 0-0 0-0 1 1 0

Joklova 6:36 0-0 0-0 0-1 1 1 0

TOTALS 200 21-59 14-18 6-32 18 66

Percentages: FG 356, FT 778. 3-Point Goals: 10-30, 333

(Caldwell 3-5, McBride 2-9, Bibby 1-2, Collier 1-2, Coffey

1-3, Juhasz 1-3, Miles 1-5, Delabre 0-1, Team Rebounds:

15, Team Turnovers: 16, Blocked Shots: 4 (Coffey 2,

Howard, Juhasz), Turnovers: 17 (Miles 4, Coffey 2,

Howard 3, Bibby 2, Collier 2, Caldwell, Joklova, McBride),

Steals: 2 (Howard, Joklova), Technical Fouls: None,

At 16:01 (19,350), T: 2:04.

AUTO RACING

NASCAR Cup Series

POINTS LEADERS

Through Sunday.

1. Denny Hamlin, 1001.

2. Ryan Blaney, 924.

3. Ty Gibbs, 880.

4. Taylor Reddick, 860.

5. Christopher Bell, 738.

6. Chase Briscoe, 727.

7. Kyle Larson, 708.

8. Casey Elliott, 707.

9. Joey Logano, 682.

10. Chris Buescher, 672.

11. Carson Hocevar, 671.

12. William Byron, 644.

13. Daniel Suarez, 638.

14. Bubba Wallace, 630.

15. Austin Cindric, 595.

16. Shane Van Gisbergen, 586.

17. Ryan Preece, 555.

18. Brad Keselowski, 520.

19. Ross Chastain, 505.

20. Erik Jones, 490.

21. Michael McDowell, 484.

22. AJ Allmendinger, 456.

23. Todd Gilliland, 444.

24. Zane Smith, 442.

25. Austin Dillon, 405.

26. Riley Herbst, 402.

27. Ricky Stenhouse Jr., 398.

28. John H. Nemechek, 394.

29. Josh Berry, 386.

30. Alex Bowman, 362.

31. Noah Gragson, 334.

32. Cole Custer, 302.

33. Ty Dillon, 294.

34. Connor Zilisch, 259.

35. Cody Ware, 199.

Gettysburg museum receives rare fragments of the past



MATT MCCLAIN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

A daguerreotype of John W.C. O'Neal, a doctor from Virginia who helped Southerners find loved ones buried on the famed battlefield.

More than 40 letters from grieving families of slain Confederate soldiers were recently donated to the Gettysburg Beyond the Battle Museum

BY MICHAEL E. RUANE

In 1866, a former Confederate army officer wrote to a doctor in Gettysburg, Pennsylvania, asking him to look for the grave of his brother, who had been killed in the Civil War battle there three years earlier.

Robert H. Dungan, of Seven Mile Ford, in rural Southwest Virginia, was searching for the re-

mains of his brother, Thomas, a schoolteacher with a wife and small daughter, who had been killed on July 2, 1863.

"I would take it as a very great kindness," Dungan wrote to John W.C. O'Neal, a native of Virginia, who was known to help Southern families find loved ones buried on the Pennsylvania battlefield.

Thomas's grave might be near a stone house, under a peach tree

and marked with a board carved with his name, "Serg't T.W. Dungan, Co. D, 48th Va.," his brother wrote. He would gladly pay O'Neal for his trouble.

Dungan's missive is part of a group of rare, original letters between the country doctor and grieving families of Confederate soldiers that have just been donated to a museum in Gettysburg.

SEE GETTYSBURG ON B13

School gender policy amended

ANNE ARUNDEL FACES LAWSUIT, DEFUNDING

Under old policy, gender identity was confidential

BY KENDALL STATON

A Maryland school district has updated its gender identity policy that a lawsuit and the Trump administration claimed improperly prevented parents from accessing information about their children.

The policy from Anne Arundel County Public Schools classified a student's gender identity as confidential medical information, which the Trump administration said violated a federal law over student education records and threatened legal action if it were not changed.

The issue arose after the parents of an Anne Arundel high school student filed a lawsuit last month in which they said they learned their child was using a name and pronouns at school that didn't align with their biological sex. When the parents asked to review their child's school records, the district declined to disclose them, according to the lawsuit.

Weeks later, the U.S. Education Department announced it would partner with the Justice Department to take enforcement action against the county school system if the policy was not changed, including possible loss of federal funding.

On Wednesday, Anne Arundel Schools Superintendent Mark Bedell announced a change in policy to clarify that the district will not interfere with parents' rights to access information under the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act. The updated policy, among other things, removed language that directed staff not to disclose students' gender identity unless legally required to do so.

"No policy, guideline, or practice may limit or otherwise interfere with parental rights under FERPA," Bedell said in the statement to families. "This includes any information maintained in education records that relates to gender identity, transgender status, sexual orientation, preferred name, or preferred pronouns."

The change came just days before the start of the school year.

The Justice Department declined to comment on the district's policy change.

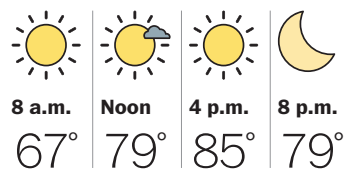
The Anne Arundel regulation allows students to go by a name or pronouns that correspond with their gender identity, not just their sex, without requiring approval from their parents. The policy tells staff to involve the student's family in creating a support plan to accommodate their gender identity "unless there is a genuine safety concern for the student's physical, emotional, or mental health safety."

Under the old version of the policy, if the district was legally required to disclose a student's gender identity, staff were directed to give the student a chance to share that information themselves. The updated policy has removed that language. It also still says gender identity, legal name or sex assigned at birth may constitute confidential medical information.

The parents' lawsuit, filed by the conservative group America First Legal and Consvooy McCarthy PLLC, seeks to repeal the policy allowing faculty to refer to students by names and pronouns that align with their gender identity rather than their sex at birth without needing parental consent. It also asks to add an opt-out option for any district rule that "facilitates or affirms a student's gender transition at school or withholds information from parents regarding such matters."

America First Legal did not respond to a request for comment about the district's revised policy.

TODAY'S WEATHER



High today at approx. 4 p.m.: 85°

Precip: 0% Wind: NW 6-12 mph

For weather news, go to B20

Bison escapes, becomes famous, gets a police escort home

Loudoun County official went door-to-door to find the animal's owner

BY DANA HEDGPETH

The iconic beast stepped past a broken fence on his farm Monday morning and roamed out into the wilds of western Loudoun County, a suburb about 50 miles from D.C. better known for having the country's highest concentration of data centers than for being a place where buffalo roam.

The escape of the 1,500-pound bison from a local farm prompted a flurry of calls to the local sheriff's office around 7 a.m. and brought out a crew of deputies and three animal services offi-

cers specially trained in large-animal rescue — one carrying a tranquilizer, just in case.

It also created a stir on social media after a resident who lives south of the small town of Purcellville posted a photo on Facebook. It showed the huge creature sitting on a grassy spot near a log on her land. The message read: "This bison is on our property. If you know to whom he may belong to, please message me."

One woman commented, "We paid all that money to go to Yellowstone when we could have just driven close to home!"

At Yellowstone National Park, a bison attacked a 65-year-old man and flung him into the air last month, marking the park's second bison attack in recent weeks. A video of the incident showed the man taking photos of the bison as it was lying on the

ground near a busy campground, when it suddenly stood and charged him.

In Loudoun, animal services officials reminded the public to keep their distance. Law enforcement vehicles followed close behind as the bison trudged along, keeping any onlookers from coming too close as the animal walked and grazed occasionally.

"They may look like furry cows, but they're definitely not," said Nina Stively, director of Loudoun County Animal Services. "Bison are the wild cousins of cows."

On social media, the bison's excursion generated plenty of comments.

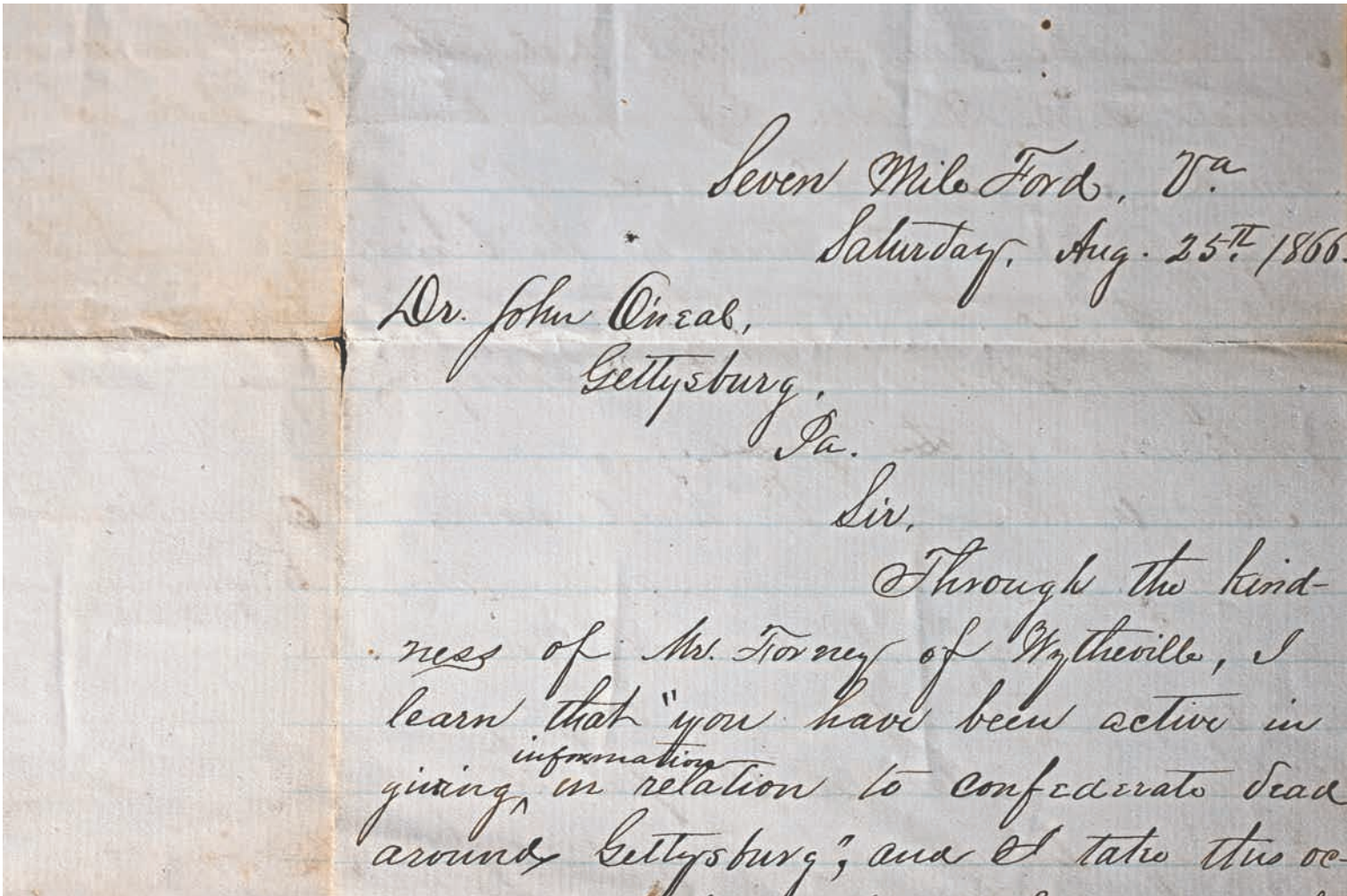
Stively's unit posted on its Facebook page: "You might have noticed an interesting parade down our gravel roads in Western Loudoun today! Our Hu-

SEE BISON ON B20



LOUDOUN COUNTY ANIMAL SERVICES

After a bison escaped from a property in Loudoun County, animal control officers spent six hours trying to coax him back to his home.



PHOTOS BY MATT MCCLAIN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

A letter from Robert H. Dungan to John W.C. O'Neal in regard to Dungan's brother, a Confederate soldier who was killed on July 2, 1863.

Families sought help locating loved ones' remains

GETTYSBURG FROM B12

There are more than 40 letters, many creased and ink-stained. They are all originals, and many of them probably haven't been seen publicly before, said Andrew Dalton, who heads Gettysburg History, and the Gettysburg Beyond the Battle Museum, to which the correspondence was donated.

"It was one of the most exciting discoveries I've ever been part of," Dalton said in a recent interview in the museum.

"I was just stunned reading the letters," he said. "Sometimes we don't get the aspect of ... humanity through the purely military accounts" of Civil War battles.

"To read these letters from mothers and sisters and wives ... it's heartbreaking," he said. "You have to feel for them."

The brother of Pvt. John Micajah Goetchius, 22, of Columbus, Georgia, whose remains were found and returned, wrote O'Neal in 1871: "You can well imagine how comforting it is to us to have them. We look upon each particle of his dust as precious."

The correspondence also illustrates some of the efforts Southern relatives made to recover the remains of their dead years after the war ended in a Union victory in 1865.

Many Confederates were buried separately in shallow graves or together in mass graves, Dalton said.

"With the Union dead, it was much easier" to gather and bury the bodies, he said. Most of them went to the National Cemetery that was quickly established in Gettysburg, or were retrieved by their families.

But officials did nothing about the bodies of Confederate soldiers, and their families had no access to the battlefield, he said. "It's the middle of the war. They can't come here and do this."

"Years and years go by, and at that point, the remains are indistinguishable," he said.

In 1869, O'Neal located the grave of Lt. Col. James Washington Hance, of the 53rd Georgia Infantry, who was killed July 2, 1863.

Six years after the battle, the grave was marked only by the name "HANCE" carved in an old cherry tree, O'Neal wrote to Hance's father, William.

O'Neal had the remains exhumed and wrote that he would send them to the elder Hance, who told O'Neal he had lost two other sons in the war.

In 1864, with the conflict still on, a woman from Portsmouth, Virginia, sent O'Neal a picture of Col. James G. Hodges, 33, of the 14th Virginia Regiment, who was killed July 3, 1863. She apparently hoped it might help identify his body, but stressed that she needed the picture back.

In December 1865, Mary L. Jones of Columbus, Georgia, asked O'Neal to help find the body of her husband, Col. John Augustus Jones, 41, of the 20th Georgia Regiment. He was killed July 2, 1863. He had been a lawyer, according to census data. They had four children.

She described his mortal head wound. She wrote that she wanted to "examine [the body] myself as I never want a doubt to arise whether it is his, or not. I want to be sure of it."

But she wondered: "Will it be possible to recognize the features? Or has it been too long." (Jones's body was eventually



Andrew Dalton, president and CEO of Gettysburg History, which oversees the museum to which the letters were donated.



A bottle of what appears to be medicine that belonged to O'Neal is displayed at the Gettysburg Beyond the Battle Museum.

"To read these letters from mothers and sisters and wives ... it's heartbreaking. You have to feel for them."

Andrew Dalton, Civil War historian

found, but it was lost when the ship on which it was being transported sank in a storm, said Dalton, the museum director.)

Almost 4,000 Confederates and just over 3,000 Union soldiers were killed in the three-day struggle at Gettysburg, accord-

ing to the American Battlefield Trust.

The battle came at the height of the war that helped end slavery in the U.S. — which the Confederacy was fighting to maintain. And it was the beginning of the end for Southern military fortunes.

In addition to the letters, the museum donation included a wooden trunk belonging to O'Neal, a sealed bottle of what appears to be medicine and his college diary from the 1840s.

The donor was Barbara Crapster-Pregont, who said she was O'Neal's great-great granddaughter. She grew up in Gettysburg but now lives in Merrill, Wisconsin.

Crapster-Pregont, a retired family doctor, made the donation in July after gathering the artifacts from a family home and garage in the Gettysburg area.

She said her family has roots in Adams County, where Gettysburg is, and Carroll County, just over the border in Maryland, going back generations. "So a lot of stuff was saved," she said in a telephone interview.

Other family members had previously donated O'Neal's items to the Adams County Historical Society, now located at the museum, she said. She believed that was the proper place for the latest donation.

"It's just what the family does," she said.

O'Neal, then 42, had a busy practice in Gettysburg when the battle unfolded on July 1, 2 and 3, 1863.

"He was kind of a minor celebrity of sorts in Gettysburg afterwards," Crapster-Pregont said. "Growing up, the stories I heard, he was always one of those larger-than-life ancestors."

Known as "J.W.C.," he was reportedly detained twice by the Confederates during the fighting, Crapster-Pregont said, and he helped treat wounded soldiers during the battle.

It was mainly after the armies left, and the surrounding countryside was strewn with the dead, that he began to compile lists of fallen Confederates and correspond with their families.

He eventually had hundreds of names in notebooks he kept, according to historian Gregory A. Coco's book "A Strange and Blighted Land."

Over the years, with the help of O'Neal and others, many were exhumed and returned to cemeteries in the South, said Timothy H. Smith, the museum's historian and director of education.

"In the end, however, many graves remained undetected," Smith said in an email. "Undoubtedly there are still hundreds of soldiers buried on the Gettysburg battlefield today."

DEATH NOTICE

DEATH NOTICE

GLAZER

LOWELL R. GLAZER (Age 95)
Lowell R. Glazer, of Pikesville, Maryland, passed away on Saturday, August 22, 2026, at the age of 95.

Lowell began his adult life serving his country in the United States Air Force, an early chapter in a life defined by hard work, determination, loyalty, and a deep sense of responsibility to his family and community.

He went on to build a highly successful career in real estate development and construction as co-founder of A & G Construction and president of Glazer Construction. Through his work, Lowell helped shape the landscape of the Baltimore area, but the legacy he built extended far beyond his professional accomplishments.

Lowell believed deeply in giving back to the community that had given so much to him. Together with his beloved late wife, Harriet, he devoted himself to strengthening many of Baltimore's most important institutions. His commitment to Sinai Hospital was particularly meaningful. He served as chairman of Sinai's Board of Directors, and the Lowell and Harriet Glazer Atrium at Sinai Hospital stands as an enduring reflection of their generosity and commitment to the hospital and the community it serves.

His Jewish faith and community were central to his life. A longtime member and past president of Chizuk Amuno Congregation, Lowell was also deeply involved with The Associated Jewish Federation of Baltimore. He had a deep and enduring love for Israel and believed strongly in supporting Jewish life both in Baltimore and beyond.

Lowell was also a devoted supporter of the University of Maryland, contributing to the university and its community in numerous ways throughout his life.

Yet for all of his professional accomplishments, community leadership, and philan-

thropy, Lowell was, above all, a family man. His family was his greatest source of pride and joy. He loved a good joke—and perhaps even more, he loved telling one—and his humor and playfulness were a constant presence at family gatherings. He believed that generosity and responsibility to others were values to be lived and passed from one generation to the next, encouraging his children and grandchildren to find causes meaningful to them and to experience for themselves the importance of giving back.

Lowell is survived by his loving daughter, Cindy (Jack) Bienenfeld; cherished sister, Vikki Caplan; his dear sister and brother-in-law, Phyllis and Leonard Attman; his adored grandchildren, Tracy (Ben) Waller, Joshua (Rayni) Bienenfeld, and Jesse Glazer Crosby (Kait); and his cherished great-grandchildren, Emilia Hattie Waller, Henry Waller, and Harrison Bienenfeld.

He was predeceased by his beloved wife, Harriet Glazer (née Lazinsky); his loving daughter, Marc Glazer Crosby; his cherished sister, Bayda (Warren) Marison; his dear brother-in-law, Alan Caplan; and his devoted parents, Sara and Myer Glazer.

Lowell leaves behind not only the businesses, institutions, and community organizations he helped build and strengthen, but, most importantly, a family shaped by his example. His legacy of generosity, leadership, devotion to Jewish life and Israel, and love of family will endure for generations.

Services were held at Chizuk Amuno Congregation, 8100 Stevenson Road, Pikesville, Maryland 21208, on Monday, August 24, 2026, at 1:00 p.m. Interment at Arlington Cemetery—Chizuk Amuno Congregation, N. Rogers Avenue.

Please omit flowers. Contributions in Lowell's memory may be made to The Associated Jewish Federation of Baltimore, Chizuk Amuno Congregation, or Sinai Hospital. See Levinson's website for Shiva details. www.sollevinson.com

When the need arises, let families find you in the Funeral Services Directory.

To be seen in the Funeral Services Directory, please call paid Death Notices at 202-334-4122.

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IN MEMORIAM

PARKS



AUDREY THOMPSON PARKS
PARKS AUDREY THOMPSON PARKS October 17, 1926 - August 25, 2008 Ma. Our hearts still ache and our tears still fall. Our lives will never be the same without you. You are forever alive in our hearts and prayers. We love you, Your Children, Ingrid and Lawrence

DEATH NOTICE

BRANSON



ALBERT E. BRANSON JR.
On Saturday, August 21, 2026 at Sibley Memorial Hospital in Washington, DC. He was 84. Brother of David Branson (Jane), Theresa McVeary (Kenneth), Robert Branson (Patricia), Vincent Branson (Marilyn) and brother-in-law of Meredith Branson (Bob). He is also beloved by 12 nieces and nephews, many cousins, and countless friends. A Mass of Christian Burial will be celebrated at St. Anselm's Abbey in Washington, DC on Saturday, August 29 at 10 a.m. A Celebration of Life will be held at Columbia Country Club at 12 noon. Interment Mt. St. Mary's Cemetery at a later date. In lieu of flowers, memorial contributions may be made to Poor Robert's Mission. www.COLLINSFUNERALHOME.com

MICKESH

DAVID MICKESH JR.
The Officers and Members of Local #10, International Union of Elevator Constructors, are hereby notified of the passing of Honorary Brother Joseph David Mickesh, Jr. on August 20, 2026. Members may call at Howe Memorial United Methodist Church, 252 S Summit Street, Crescent City FL 32112 on Saturday, August 29, 2026, at 11 am. A Celebration of Life will be held in Maryland at a later date. Admittal details will be shared once arrangements have been finalized.

MOIEN



JOEL STANLEY MOIEN
Joel Stanley Moien, 87, of College Park MD died on August 21, 2026. Joel was born on December 29, 1938 in Washington DC, beloved son of Abe and Lena Moien. He graduated from Theodore Roosevelt High School, George Washington University and Georgetown University Dental School. He served as a Captain in the US Air Force and later had dental practices in College Park and Bowie, MD.

Joel was married to the late Vilma F. Moien. He is survived by his son Michael, his daughter Rosalie Argoe (Ed), his brother Allen (Jud), and sister-in-law Mary (Barry) deceased. He is also survived by grandchildren Edward Argoe and Tanya Curtis, as well as nieces, nephews and friends. Funeral Service will be Wednesday August 26, 2026 at 11am at King David Memorial Gardens, 2712 Hollywood Rd, Falls Church, VA 22042.

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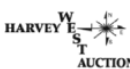
**TRUSTEE'S FORECLOSURE SALE OF
RESIDENTIAL DWELLING KNOWN AS:**
5508 EADS ST NE, WASHINGTON, DC 20019

By virtue of that certain Deed of Trust and Security Agreement dated as of January 16, 2020 and recorded among the land records of the District of Columbia as Document No. 2020008653 (the "Deed of Trust"), defaults having been made in the payment of the debt secured thereby and the covenants contained therein, and being instructed to do so by the party secured by the Deed of Trust (the "Noteholder"), the undersigned Trustees, any of whom may act, will on **September 8th, at 11:45 a.m.**, at the offices of Harvey West Auctioneers, 5335 Wisconsin Avenue, NW, Suite 440, Washington, D.C. 20015, offer for sale at public auction to the highest bidder the real property more particularly described as:

ALL THAT PIECE OR PARCEL OF LAND, TOGETHER WITH THE IMPROVEMENTS, RIGHTS, PRIVILEGES, AND APPURTENANCES TO THE SAME BELONGING, SITUATE IN THE DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA, DESCRIBED AS FOLLOWS, TO WIT: PART OF LOT EIGHT (8) AND EIGHT HUNDRED ONE (801) IN BLOCK NUMBERED ELEVEN (11) IN SAMUEL K. GEORGE AND OTHERS' SUBDIVISION OF EAST DEANWOOD, AS PER PLAT RECORDED IN THE OFFICE OF THE SURVEYOR FOR THE DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA IN LIBER COUNTY 9, FOLIO 101.

TERMS OF SALE: The property is being sold on an "AS-IS" basis without any representations or warranties of any kind, express or implied, and is sold subject to any real estate taxes, or other prior liens, encumbrances and municipal assessments, if any. A deposit of \$10,000 will be required at time of sale, such deposit to be by certified check. All conveyancing, recording, recordation tax, transfer fees/taxes shall be the purchaser's costs and obligations and must be paid at settlement. The balance of the purchase price, together with interest at the rate of 10% per annum from date of sale to date of receipt of the balance of the purchase price, must be paid in cash or by cashier's certified check and all other terms to be complied with within 30 days of auction date; otherwise deposit is forfeited and the property may be re-advertised and sold at the discretion of the Trustee(s) and at the risk and cost of the defaulting purchaser. The Trustee cannot guarantee clear title or the purchaser's ability to obtain title insurance; therefore, the purchaser may not be able to obtain financing and must nevertheless be able to pay the balance of the purchase price in full within 30 days. The Trustee shall convey a deed pursuant to D.C. Code Section 42-1903.13(c) (1) and (3) and make no further representations or warranties as to title. Purchaser must record such deed with the D.C. Recorder of Deeds within 30 days of receipt of the deed. The Trustee reserves the right in its sole discretion to rescind the sale at any time before conveyance of the deed. In the event of failure on the part of the Trustee to convey such deed, the purchaser's sole remedy shall be return of the deposit. (File # 26-00645)

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Legal Notices

ABC License: Nando's Restaurant Group Inc. trading as Nando's Peri-Peri Fairfax Corner, 11943 Grand Commons Avenue, Suite #943 Fairfax (Fairfax County) Virginia 22030, the above establishment is applying to the VIRGINIA ALCOHOLIC BEVERAGE CONTROL (ABC) AUTHORITY for a Mixed Beverage Restaurant license to sell or manufacture alcoholic beverages. May be sold. Secretary, NOTE: Objections to the issuance of this license must be submitted to ABC no later than 30 days from the publishing date of the first of two required newspaper legal notices. Objections should be registered at www.abc.virginia.gov or (800) 552-3200.

Request for Proposals - DCHFA-26-092
The D.C. Housing Finance Agency seeks a contractor to provide Real Estate Advisory Services for the Agency's headquarters building. Details: <http://www.dchfa.org/about/business-opportunities>. Responses due: September 8, 2026, 2:00 p.m.

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**TRUSTEES' SALE
OF REAL PROPERTY**

**1015 Rhode Island Avenue, NE
Washington, DC 20002
Lot 0053 in Square 3870**

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Credit Line Deed of Trust and Security Agreement, Assignment of Leases and Rents (the "Deed of Trust") dated April 3, 2024 and recorded on April 10, 2024 as Instrument No. 2024033091, 1015 Rhode Island LLC ("Borrower"), a District of Columbia limited liability company, as grantor, conveyed to Jason A. Pardo and Russell S. Drazin (collectively, "Trustees"), as trustees, securing that certain Promissory Note (the "Note") dated April 3, 2024 in the original principal amount of \$2,340,000.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and following the mailing and recordation of an Affidavit of Non-Residential Mortgage Foreclosure and a Notice of Foreclosure Sale of Real Property or Condominium Unit, at the request of the current noteholder, Trustees will sell at public auction at the office of Harvey West Auctioneers, Inc., 5335 Wisconsin Avenue, NW, Suite 440, Washington, DC 20015, on

SEPTEMBER 8, 2026 AT 10:00 AM

ALL THAT LOT OF GROUND AND THE IMPROVEMENTS THEREON (if any) situated in the City of Washington, District of Columbia, known as 1015 Rhode Island Avenue, NE, Washington, DC 20002 (Lot 0053 in Square 3870), and more fully described in the Deed of Trust.

TOGETHER WITH any and all buildings, structures, improvements or appurtenances now erected on the above-described land, including, without limitation, all equipment, apparatus, machinery and fixtures of any kind or character forming a part of said buildings, structures, improvements or appurtenances, which are not owned by any third party, upon or about the above-described land and any buildings thereon all as more particularly described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust (the "Property").

The property will be sold in an "AS IS" condition, with no warranty of any kind, and subject to conditions, restrictions, agreements, liens, and encumbrances of record affecting the same - except those encumbrances of record that are extinguished by operation of District of Columbia law by virtue of the foreclosure of the Deed of Trust. The successful purchaser recognizes that any investigation, examination or inspection of the Property is within the control of the owner or other parties in possession of the Property and not within the control of the Trustees or the noteholder. Purchaser will take title to the property subject to all taxes, water and sewer charges, and other utility charges, if any. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property.

TERMS OF SALE: ALL CASH. The Property will be offered as an entirety only. The bid which yields the highest price for the Property will be accepted by the Trustees (unless the sale is postponed or cancelled) and all bids will be provisional until acceptance. Notwithstanding the foregoing, the Trustees absolutely reserve the right to postpone the sale and/or cancel the sale at any time until the auctioneer announces that the Property is "sold" and the deposit in the required amount and form is received by the Trustees. A deposit in the amount of \$15,000.00 will be required at the time of sale. Such deposit must be by cashier's check or certified check or in such other form as the Trustees may determine in their sole discretion. In the event the deposit is less than 10% of the winning bid amount, then the deposit must be increased to 10% of the winning bid amount and delivered to the Trustees within one (1) business day after the consummation of the sale in the same form of funds as the initial deposit or in such other form as the Trustees may determine in their sole discretion. Failure to timely tender the deposit or additional deposit shall constitute a material default by the purchaser and result in forfeiture of the deposit. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash or certified funds at settlement. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money from the date of sale to the date of settlement at the applicable interest rate set forth in the debt instrument secured by the Deed of Trust. Purchaser shall be responsible for payment of all settlement costs.

The noteholder and its affiliates, if a bidder, shall not be required to post a deposit or to pay interest.

In the event that purchaser does not settle as required for any reason, purchaser shall be in default. Upon such default, the deposit shall be forfeited to Trustees and all of the expenses of this sale (including legal fees and costs, and full commission on the gross sale price) shall be charged against and paid out of the forfeited deposit. Trustees may resell the property at the risk and expense of the defaulting purchaser. The defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds or profits resulting from any resale of the property. Defaulting purchaser shall be liable to Trustees for legal fees and costs incurred by Trustees in connection with such default.

If Trustees are unable to settle as set forth herein, purchaser's sole remedy at law and in equity shall be limited to a refund of the deposit and the sale shall be considered null and void and of no effect whatsoever.

Trustees reserve the right, in Trustees' sole discretion, to reject any and all bids, to withdraw the property from sale at any time before or at the auction, to extend the time to receive bids, to waive or modify the deposit requirement, to waive or modify the requirement that interest be paid on the unpaid purchase money, and/or to extend the period of time for settlement.

Additional terms may be announced at the sale. The successful bidder will be required to execute and deliver to Trustees a memorandum or contract of the sale at the conclusion of bidding.

Jason A. Pardo, Trustee



Aug 25, 27, Sep 1, 3, 7, 2026

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**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON**

**3732 BEL PRE ROAD, UNIT #2
SILVER SPRING, MD 20906**

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated April 7, 2006, recorded in Liber 32283, Folio 438 among the Land Records of Montgomery County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$73,000.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Montgomery County, at the Court House Door, 50 Maryland Ave., Rockville, MD 20850, on

SEPTEMBER 4, 2026 AT 3:26 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Montgomery County, MD and described as Unit numbered 3732/2, in a Condominium styled "Fairways Condominium" and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind. The property will be sold subject to a prior mortgage, the amount to be announced at the time of sale, if made available to the Substitute Trustees.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$7,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 377124-2)

Andrew J. Brenner, et al., Substitute Trustees



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Aug 18, 25, Sep 1, 2026

0012524467

Montgomery County
Montgomery County
Aldridge Pite LLP
6001 Executive Blvd., Suite 200
Rockville, MD 20852
301-961-6555

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON**

**12903 CHURCHILL RIDGE CIRCLE, UNIT #11
GERMANTOWN, MD 20874**

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated December 10, 2021, recorded in Liber 64887, Folio 438 among the Land Records of Montgomery County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$270,019.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Montgomery County, at the Court House Door, 50 Maryland Ave., Rockville, MD 20850, on

SEPTEMBER 11, 2026 AT 2:23 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Montgomery County, MD and described as Unit numbered 10-11 in Phase 1, Building No. 10, in a Condominium styled, "Churchill Condominium, Inc" and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$25,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 377180-2)

Andrew J. Brenner, et al., Substitute Trustees



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Aug 25, Sep 1, 8, 2026

0012524840

Montgomery County
Montgomery County
McCabe, Weisberg & Conway, LLC
312 Marshall Avenue, Suite 800
Laurel, MD 20707
www.mwc-law.com

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY**

**20307 CABANA DRIVE
GERMANTOWN, MD 20876**

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust from Ibrahim Aw, dated October 12, 2006 and recorded in Liber 33271, folio 787 among the Land Records of Montgomery County, MD, default having occurred under the terms thereof and at the request of the parties secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustees will offer for sale at public auction at the Circuit Court for Montgomery County, at the Court House Door, 50 Maryland Ave., Rockville, MD 20850, on

SEPTEMBER 11, 2026 AT 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND AND THE IMPROVEMENTS THEREON situated in Montgomery County, Maryland and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust. The property is improved by a dwelling.

The property, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, encumbrances and agreements of record affecting the subject property, if any, and with no warranty of any kind. The property will be sold subject to a prior mortgage, the amount to be announced at the time of sale.

Terms of Sale: A deposit in the form of cashier's or certified check, or in such other form as the Substitute Trustees may determine, at their sole discretion, for \$8,000 at the time of sale. If the noteholder and/or servicer is the successful bidder, the deposit requirement is waived. Balance of the purchase price is to be paid within ten (10) days of the final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court for Montgomery County, Maryland. Interest is to be paid on the unpaid purchase price at the rate of 12.75% per annum from date of sale to the date the funds are received in the office of the Substitute Trustees, if the property is purchased by an entity other than the noteholder and/or servicer. If payment of the balance does not occur within ten (10) days of ratification, the deposit will be forfeited as liquidated damages. The purchaser agrees that the property may be resold pursuant to an order of court, waives personal service upon themselves and/or any principal or corporate designee of any documents filed regarding the failure to pay the purchase price within ten (10) days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail of said documents at the address provided by the purchaser in the Memorandum of Sale. This transaction may be subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE Rule") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, effective March 1, 2026. Purchaser will be responsible for obtaining the information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule and for providing the necessary information to the Reporting Person, as defined in the RRE Rule within (10) ten days following Ratification of the Sale or Purchaser's deposit will be forfeited and property resold. The purchaser will not be entitled to any surplus or profits arising from the resale even if they are the result of improvements made by the purchaser. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event settlement is delayed for any reason. Taxes, water rent, and all other public charges and assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges to be adjusted for the current year to the date of sale, and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Cost of all documentary stamps, transfer taxes (including agricultural transfer taxes, if applicable), and all settlement charges shall be borne by the purchaser. The sale is subject to a post sale audit of the loan, including but not limited to an analysis of whether the borrower entered into a loan modification agreement, filed bankruptcy, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. The Substitute Trustees will convey either insurable or marketable title. If the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey insurable or marketable title or, the post sale audit concludes that the sale should not have occurred, or the sale is not ratified by the court for any reason, the purchaser's sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to the refund of the deposit without interest even if the purchaser has made improvements to the property. Upon refund of the deposit, the sale shall be void and of no effect, and the purchaser shall have no further claim against the Substitute Trustees. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. The purchaser at the foreclosure sale shall assume the risk of loss for the property immediately after the sale. (Matter #24-600701).

Laura H. G. O'Sullivan, et al., Substitute Trustees



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Aug 25, Sep 1, 8, 2026

0012524853

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TUESDAY, AUGUST 25, 2026

EZ

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Montgomery County

Aldridge Pite LLP
6001 Executive Blvd., Suite 200
Rockville, MD 20852
301-961-6555

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON

524 CORAL REEF DRIVE
GAITHERSBURG, MD 20878

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated June 19, 2017, recorded in Liber 54494, Folio 36 among the Land Records of Montgomery County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$201,000.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Montgomery County, at the Court House Door, 50 Maryland Ave., Rockville, MD 20850, on

AUGUST 28, 2026 AT 3:35 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Montgomery County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$16,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 359254-4)

Andrew J. Brenner, et. al., Substitute Trustees

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Aug 11,18,25, 20260012524124

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Montgomery County

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Montgomery County

Aldridge Pite LLP
6001 Executive Blvd., Suite 200
Rockville, MD 20852
301-961-6555

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON

11104 LUND PLACE
KENSINGTON, MD 20895

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated June 17, 2004, recorded in Liber 30002, Folio 6 among the Land Records of Montgomery County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$355,000.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Montgomery County, at the Court House Door, 50 Maryland Ave., Rockville, MD 20850, on

AUGUST 28, 2026 AT 3:37 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Montgomery County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$31,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 29274-5)

Andrew J. Brenner, et al., Substitute Trustees

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Aug 11,18,25, 20260012524125

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Aug 11,18,25, 20260012524125

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McCabe, Weisberg & Conway, LLC
312 Marshall Avenue, Suite 800
Laurel, MD 20707
www.mwc-law.com

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY

2109 BLUE KNOB TERRACE
SILVER SPRING, MD 20906

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust from Joyce R. Halliday, dated March 21, 2005 and recorded in Liber 30669, folio 351 among the Land Records of Montgomery County, MD, default having occurred under the terms thereof and at the request of the parties secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustees will offer for sale at public auction at the Circuit Court for Montgomery County, at the Court House Door, 50 Maryland Ave., Rockville, MD 20850, on

AUGUST 28, 2026 AT 3:30 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND AND THE IMPROVEMENTS THEREON situated in Montgomery County, Maryland and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust. The property is improved by a dwelling.

The property, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, encumbrances and agreements of record affecting the subject property, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit in the form of cashier's or certified check, or in such other form as the Substitute Trustees may determine, at their sole discretion, for \$32,000 at the time of sale. If the noteholder and/or servicer is the successful bidder, the deposit requirement is waived. Balance of the purchase price is to be paid within ten (10) days of the final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court for Montgomery County, Maryland. Interest is to be paid on the unpaid purchase price at the rate of 5% per annum from date of sale to the date the funds are received in the office of the Substitute Trustees, if the property is purchased by an entity other than the noteholder and/or servicer. If payment of the balance does not occur within ten (10) days of ratification, the deposit will be forfeited as liquidated damages. The purchaser agrees that the property may be resold pursuant to an order of court, waives personal service upon themselves and/or any principals or corporate donees of any documents filed regarding the failure to pay the purchase price within ten (10) days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail of said documents at the address provided by the purchaser in the Memorandum of Sale. This transaction may be subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE Rule") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, effective March 1, 2026. Purchaser will be responsible for obtaining the information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule and for providing the necessary information to the Reporting Person, as defined in the RRE Rule, within (30) ten days following Ratification of the Sale or Purchaser's deposit will be forfeited and property resold. The purchaser will not be entitled to any surplus or profits arising from the resale even if they are the result of improvements made by the purchaser. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event settlement is delayed for any reason. Taxes, water rent, and all other public charges and assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges to be adjusted for the current year to the date of sale, and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to a post sale audit of the loan, including but not limited to an analysis of whether the borrower entered into a loan modification agreement, filed bankruptcy, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. The Substitute Trustees will convey either insurable or marketable title. If the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey insurable or marketable title or, the post sale audit concludes that the sale should not have occurred, or the sale is not ratified by the court for any reason, the purchaser's sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to the refund of the deposit without interest even if the purchaser has made improvements to the property. Upon refund of the deposit, the sale shall be void and of no effect, and the purchaser shall have no further claim against the Substitute Trustees. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. The purchaser at the foreclosure sale shall assume the risk of loss for the property immediately after the sale. (Matter #15-613186).

Laura H. G. O'Sullivan, et al, Substitute Trustees

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www.alexcooper.com

Aug 11,18,25, 20260012524145

850

Montgomery County

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Montgomery County

Robertson, Anschutz, Schneid & Crane, LLC
11350 McCormick Road, EP 1, Suite 302
Hunt Valley, MD 21031
470-321-7112

TRUSTEES' SALE OF
VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY
KNOWN AS
500 LONGWOOD DR
ROCKVILLE, MD 20850

Under a power of sale contained in that Deed of Trust dated January 26, 2007, and recorded in Liber 33847, folio 087, of the land records of MONTGOMERY COUNTY, with an original principal balance of \$350,000.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the appointed Substitute Trustees will offer for sale at public auction at THE MONTGOMERY COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 50 MARYLAND AVENUE, ROCKVILLE, MD 20850 ON,

SEPTEMBER 2, 2026 at 11:30 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND together with any buildings or improvements thereon situated in MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MD, located at the above address and more fully described in the aforementioned Deed of Trust.

TAX-ID# - 04-00183092

The property and improvements will be sold in an "AS IS" physical condition without warranty of any kind and subject to all conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, including any condominium or homeowners association assessments pursuant to Md Real Property Article AS11-110 and AS11B-117.

TERMS OF SALE: A non-refundable bidder's deposit of \$30,000.00 by cashier's/certified check or such other form as the Substitute Trustee may determine, in their sole discretion, required at time of sale except for the party secured by the Deed of Trust. Risk of loss on purchaser from date and time of auction. The balance of the purchase price together with interest thereon at 8.5% per annum from date of sale to receipt of purchase price by Substitute Trustees must be paid by cashier's check within 10 days after final ratification of sale. The noteholder shall not be obligated to pay interest if it is the purchaser. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event that additional funds are tendered before settlement or if settlement is delayed for any reason. All real estate taxes and other public charges and assessments to be adjusted as of the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. If applicable, any condominium and/or homeowners association dues and assessments that may become due after the date of sale shall be purchaser's responsibility. Purchaser shall pay all transfer, documentary and recording taxes/fees and all other settlement costs. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining possession of the property. Time is of the essence for the purchaser. If purchaser defaults, deposit will be forfeited and property resold at the risk and cost of the defaulting purchaser who shall be liable for any deficiency in the purchase price and all attorneys' expenses and attorney's fees of both sales. If Substitute Trustees do not convey title for any reason, purchaser's sole remedy is return of deposit without interest. This sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan secured by the Deed of Trust including but not limited to determining whether prior to sale a bankruptcy was filed; forbearance, repayment or other agreement was entered into; or loan was reinstated or paid off. In any such event this sale shall be null and void and purchaser's sole remedy shall be return of deposit without interest. File No. (25-324330)

Keith Yacko, David Williamson, Substitute Trustees

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Aug 18,25, Sep 1, 20260012523510

The Washington Post

851

Prince Georges County

851

Prince Georges County

GREENSPOON MARDER, LLP
201 International Circle, Suite 230
Hunt Valley, MD 21030

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY
KNOWN AS
136 69TH STREET
Capitol Heights, MD 20743

By virtue of a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from NAOMI T. MAYNOR, dated May 5, 2017 and recorded in book 39636, page 136 among the Land Records of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, Maryland, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No. CAEF22-30069; Tax ID No. 18-2093151) the Substitute Trust will sell at public auction PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY courthouse located at FRONT OF THE DUVAL WING OF THE COURTHOUSE COMPLEX 14735 MAIN ST, UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772 .

SEPTEMBER 3, 2026 at 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$ 18,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK, CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at five percent (5%) from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustee. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee is unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 44377.0411)

NICOLE LIPINSKI, GABRIELLE GIOVINAZZO, ERIN KENNEDY, Substitute Trustee (s)

300 E. Joppa Road
Hagerstown Plaza • Suite 1103
Baltimore, MD 21286
410-789-9797

Aug 18,25, Sep 1, 20260012523388

851

Prince Georges County

851

Prince Georges County

GREENSPOON MARDER, LLP
201 International Circle, Suite 230
Hunt Valley, MD 21030

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY
KNOWN AS
518 TAILGATE TER
Hyattsville, MD 20785

By virtue of a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from DAEMON CLARKE, dated December 11, 2023 and recorded in book 49474, page 132 among the Land Records of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, Maryland, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No. C-16-CV-25-004317; Tax ID No. 18-3739018) the Substitute Trustee will sell at public auction PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY courthouse located at FRONT OF THE DUVAL WING OF THE COURTHOUSE COMPLEX 14735 MAIN ST, UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772.

SEPTEMBER 3, 2026 at 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$ 51,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK, CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at five percent (5%) from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustee. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee is unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 25-000867-01)

NICOLE LIPINSKI, GABRIELLE GIOVINAZZO, ERIN KENNEDY, Substitute Trustee (s)

300 E. Joppa Road
Hagerstown Plaza • Suite 1103
Baltimore, MD 21286
410-789-9797

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851

Prince Georges County

Samuel I. White, P.C.
448 VIKING DRIVE, SUITE 350
VIRGINA BEACH, VA 23452

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF
VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY
KNOWN AS
11407 Cheryl Drive
Upper Marlboro, MD 20772

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust to THOMAS DORE OF COVAHEY, BOOZER, DEVAN AND DORE, Trustee(s), dated March 20, 2015, and recorded among the Land Records of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MARYLAND in Liber 37017, folio 468, the holder of the indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed the undersigned Substitute Trustees, by instrument duly recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at the PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT FRONT OF THE DUVAL WING OF THE COURTHOUSE COMPLEX 14735 MAIN ST, UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772 ON,

SEPTEMBER 3, 2026 at 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and described as follows:

ALL THAT CERTAIN PARCEL OF LAND SITUATED IN THE 15TH ELECTION DISTRICT, COUNTY OF PRINCE GEORGE'S, STATE OF MARYLAND, BEING KNOWN AND DESIGNATED AS: BEING LOT 7, BLOCK 1, PLAT 2, MARLBORO WEST, AS PER PLAT RECORDED IN PLAT BOOK NLP 147, PLAT 92, AMONG THE LAND RECORDS OF PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MARYLAND. BEING IN THE 15TH ELECTION DISTRICT OF SAID COUNTY.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record affecting same including any condominium and of HOA assessments pursuant to Md Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$20,000.00 PAYABLE ONLY BY certified funds, shall be required at the time of sale. CASH WILL NOT BE AN ACCEPTABLE FORM OF DEPOSIT. The balance of the purchase price with interest at 3.75% per annum from the date of sale to the date of payment will be paid within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale. There will be no abatement of interest for any reason. Adjustments on all taxes, public charges and special or regular assessments will be made as of the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. There will be no abatement of taxes, public charges and special or regular assessments for any reason. If applicable, condominium and/or homeowner association dues and assessments that may become due after the time of sale will be the responsibility of the purchaser. Title examination, conveyancing, state revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Time is of the essence for the purchaser, otherwise the deposit will be forfeited, and the property may be resold at risk and costs of the defaulting purchaser and the purchaser agrees to pay reasonable attorneys' fees for the Substitute trustees, plus all cost incurred, if the Substitute Trustee's have filed the appropriate motion with the Court to resell the property. The purchasers waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with such a motion and expressly agrees to the Purchaser agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. If the sale is not ratified or if the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey marketable title in accord with these terms of sale, the purchaser's only remedy is return of the deposit.

If this transaction is subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule (RRE) issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained and provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing.

The sale is subject to post-sale confirmation and audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into a repayment agreement, reinstated, or paid off the loan prior to sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest.

Trustee's File No. (89042)

Robert A. Jones, et al SUBSTITUE TRUSTEES

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448 VIKING DRIVE, SUITE 350
VIRGINA BEACH, VA 23452

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF
VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY
KNOWN AS
116 Cree Drive
Oxon Hill, MD 20745

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust to HEATHER LOVIER, Trustee(s), dated March 17, 2022, and recorded among the Land Records of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MARYLAND in Liber 47834, folio 533, the holder of the indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed the undersigned Substitute Trustees, by instrument duly recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at the PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT FRONT OF THE DUVAL WING OF THE COURTHOUSE COMPLEX 14735 MAIN ST, UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772 ON,

SEPTEMBER 3, 2026 at 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and described as follows:

LOT NUMBERED NINETEEN (19), BLOCK NUMBERED ONE HUNDRED TWENTY-TWO (122), SECTION NUMBERED FIFTEEN (15) OF THE SUBDIVISION KNOWN AS "FOREST HEIGHTS" AS PER PLAT RECORDED AMONG THE LAND RECORDS OF PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MARYLAND IN PLAT BOOK W.W.V. No. 23 AT PLAT 39.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record affecting same including any condominium and of HOA assessments pursuant to Md Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$20,000.00 PAYABLE ONLY BY certified funds, shall be required at the time of sale. CASH WILL NOT BE AN ACCEPTABLE FORM OF DEPOSIT. The balance of the purchase price with interest at 3.625% per annum from the date of sale to the date of payment will be paid within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale. There will be no abatement of interest for any reason. Adjustments on all taxes, public charges and special or regular assessments will be made as of the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. There will be no abatement of taxes, public charges and special or regular assessments for any reason. If applicable, condominium and/or homeowner association dues and assessments that may become due after the time of sale will be the responsibility of the purchaser. Title examination, conveyancing, state revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Time is of the essence for the purchaser, otherwise the deposit will be forfeited, and the property may be resold at risk and costs of the defaulting purchaser and the purchaser agrees to pay reasonable attorneys' fees for the Substitute trustees, plus all cost incurred, if the Substitute Trustee's have filed the appropriate motion with the Court to resell the property. The purchasers waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with such a motion and expressly agrees to the Purchaser agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. If the sale is not ratified or if the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey marketable title in accord with these terms of sale, the purchaser's only remedy is return of the deposit.

If this transaction is subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule (RRE) issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained and provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing.

The sale is subject to post-sale confirmation and audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into a repayment agreement, reinstated, or paid off the loan prior to sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest.

Trustee's File No. (93823)

Robert A. Jones, et al SUBSTITUE TRUSTEES

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Samuel I. White, P.C.
448 VIKING DRIVE, SUITE 350
VIRIGINA BEACH, VA 23452

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY
KNOWN AS
7061 Heather Drive
Bryans Road, MD 20616

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust to MIKE HUBER, Trustee(s), dated November 14, 2019, and recorded among the Land Records of CHARLES COUNTY, MARYLAND in Liber 14012, folio 479, the holder of the indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed the undersigned Substitute Trustees, by instrument duly recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at THE CHARLES COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 200 CHARLES STREET (IN THE BREEZEWAY BETWEEN CIRCUIT AND DISTRICT COURTS), LA PLATA, MD 20646 ON,

SEPTEMBER 3, 2026 at 12:30 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in CHARLES COUNTY, MD and described as follows:

LOT NUMBERED THIRTY-ONE (31) IN THE SUBDIVISION KNOWNAS "PLAT FOUR, PHASE 1, SECTION 4-B, STRAWBERRY HILLS", AS PER PLAT THEREOF RECORDED AMONG THE LAND RECORDS OF CHARLES COUNTY, MARYLAND, IN PLAT BOOK 46, FOLIO 321.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record affecting same including any condominium and of HOA assessments pursuant to Mid Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$20,000.00 PAYABLE ONLY by certified funds, shall be required at the time of sale. CASH WILL NOT BE AN ACCEPTABLE FORM OF DEPOSIT. The balance of the purchase price with interest at 3.625% per annum from the date of sale to the date of payment will be paid within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale. There will be no abatement of interest for any reason. Adjustments on all taxes, public charges and special or regular assessments will be made as of the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. There will be no abatement of taxes, public charges and special or regular assessments for any reason. If applicable, condominium and/or homeowner association dues and assessments that may become due after the time of sale will be the responsibility of the purchaser. Title examination, conveyancing, state revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Time is of the essence for the purchaser, otherwise the deposit will be forfeited, and the property may be resold at risk and costs of the defaulting purchaser and the purchaser agrees to pay reasonable attorneys' fees for the Substitute trustees, plus all cost incurred, if the Substitute Trustees have filed the appropriate motion with the Court to resell the property. The purchasers waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with such a motion and expressly agrees to The purchaser agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. If the sale is not ratified or if the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey marketable title in accord with these terms of sale, the purchaser's only remedy is return of the deposit.

If this transaction is subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule (RRE) issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained and provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing.

The sale is subject to post-sale confirmation and audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into a repayment agreement, reinstated, or paid off the loan prior to sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest.

Trustee's File No. (956623)

Robert A. Jones, et al SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES



HARVEY K. CASSEL
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Samuel I. White, P.C.
448 VIKING DRIVE, SUITE 350
VIRIGINA BEACH, VA 23452

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY
KNOWN AS
315 Woodside Place
Waldorf, MD 20601

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust to SAMUEL I. WHITE, P.C., Trustee(s), dated July 5, 2024, and recorded among the Land Records of CHARLES COUNTY, MARYLAND in Liber 13347, folio 268, the holder of the indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed the undersigned Substitute Trustees, by instrument duly recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at THE CHARLES COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 200 CHARLES STREET (IN THE BREEZEWAY BETWEEN CIRCUIT AND DISTRICT COURTS), LA PLATA, MD 20646 ON,

SEPTEMBER 3, 2026 at 12:30 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in CHARLES COUNTY, MD and described as follows:

SITUATED IN THE CITY OF WALDORF, COUNTY OF CHARLES, STATE OF MARYLAND: LOT NUMBERED SIXTY-FOUR (64), OF A SUBDIVISION ENTITLED "SECTION FOUR, ACTON VILLAGE" AS PER PLAT THEREOF DULY RECORDED AMONG THE LAND RECORDS OF CHARLES COUNTY, MARYLAND IN LIBER 31 AT FOLIO 121. SUBJECT TO ALL EASEMENTS, COVENANTS, CONDITIONS, RESERVATIONS, LEASES AND RESTRICTIONS OF RECORD, ALL LEGAL HIGHWAYS, ALL RIGHTS OF WAY, ALL ZONING, BUILDING AND OTHER LAWS, ORDINANCES AND REGULATIONS, ALL RIGHTS OF TENANTS IN POSSESSION, AND ALL REAL ESTATE TAXES AND ASSESSMENTS NOT YET DUE AND PAYABLE.

THE PROPERTY IS SUBJECT TO PRIOR MORTGAGES.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record affecting same including any condominium and of HOA assessments pursuant to Mid Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$20,000.00 PAYABLE ONLY by certified funds, shall be required at the time of sale. CASH WILL NOT BE AN ACCEPTABLE FORM OF DEPOSIT. The balance of the purchase price with interest at 12.25% per annum from the date of sale to the date of payment will be paid within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale. There will be no abatement of interest for any reason. Adjustments on all taxes, public charges and special or regular assessments will be made as of the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. There will be no abatement of taxes, public charges and special or regular assessments for any reason. If applicable, condominium and/or homeowner association dues and assessments that may become due after the time of sale will be the responsibility of the purchaser. Title examination, conveyancing, state revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Time is of the essence for the purchaser, otherwise the deposit will be forfeited, and the property may be resold at risk and costs of the defaulting purchaser and the purchaser agrees to pay reasonable attorneys' fees for the Substitute trustees, plus all cost incurred, if the Substitute Trustee's have filed the appropriate motion with the Court to resell the property. The purchasers waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with such a motion and expressly agrees to The purchaser agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. If the sale is not ratified or if the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey marketable title in accord with these terms of sale, the purchaser's only remedy is return of the deposit.

If this transaction is subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule (RRE) issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained and provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing.

The sale is subject to post-sale confirmation and audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into a repayment agreement, reinstated, or paid off the loan prior to sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest.

Trustee's File No. (94853)

Robert A. Jones, et al SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES



HARVEY K. CASSEL
AUCTIONEERS, LLC
300 E. Joppa Road
Hampden Plaza - Suite 1103
Baltimore, MD 21286
410-769-9797

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Frederick County

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Frederick County

McCabe, Weisberg & Conway, LLC
312 Marshall Avenue, Suite 800
Laurel, MD 20707
www.mwc-law.com

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY

200 HERITAGE COURT
WALKERSVILLE, MD 21793

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust from Mary Elizabeth Creed, dated February 9, 2023 and recorded in Liber 16331, folio 434 among the Land Records of Frederick County, MD, default having occurred under the terms thereof and at the request of the parties secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustees wiv offer for sale at public auction at the Circuit Court for Frederick County, at the Court House Door, 100 W. Patrick St., Frederick, MD 21701, on

SEPTEMBER 11, 2026 at 12:37 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND AND THE IMPROVEMENTS THEREON situated in Frederick County, Maryland and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust. The property is improved by a dwelling.

The property, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, encumbrances and agreements of record affecting the subject property, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit in the form of cashier's or certified check, or in such other form as the Substitute Trustees may determine, at their sole discretion, for \$24,000 at the time of sale. If the noteholder and/or servicer is the successful bidder, the deposit requirement is waived. Balance of the purchase price is to be paid within ten (10) days of the final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court for Frederick County, Maryland. Interest is to be paid on the unpaid purchase price at the rate of 5.875% per annum from date of sale to the date the funds are received in the office of the Substitute Trustees, if the property is purchased by an entity other than the noteholder and/or servicer. If payment of the balance does not occur within ten (10) days of ratification, the deposit will be forfeited as liquidated damages. The purchaser agrees that the property may be resold pursuant to an order of court, waives personal service upon themselves and/or any principal or corporate designee of any documents filed regarding the failure to pay the purchase price within ten (10) days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail of said documents at the address provided by the purchaser in the Memorandum of Sale. This transaction may be subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE Rule") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, effective March 1, 2026. Purchaser will be responsible for obtaining the information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule and for providing the necessary information to the Reporting Person, as defined in the RRE Rule within (10) ten days following Ratification of the Sale or Purchaser's deposit will be forfeited and property resold. The purchaser will not be entitled to any surplus or profits arising from the resale even if they are the result of improvements made by the purchaser. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event settlement is delayed for any reason. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, and all other public charges and assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, and front foot benefit charges, if applicable, to be adjusted for the current year to the date of sale, and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Cost of all documentary stamps, transfer taxes (including agricultural transfer taxes, if applicable), and all settlement charges shall be borne by the purchaser. The sale is subject to a post sale audit of the loan, including but not limited to an analysis of whether the borrower entered into a loan modification agreement, filed bankruptcy, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. The Substitute Trustees will convey either insurable or non-insurable title. If the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey insurable or marketable title or, the post sale audit concludes that the sale should not have occurred, or the sale is not ratified by the court for any reason, the purchaser's sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to the refund of the deposit without interest even if the purchaser has made improvements to the property. Upon refund of the deposit, the sale shall be void and of no effect, and the purchaser shall have no further claim against the Substitute Trustees. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. The purchaser at the foreclosure sale shall assume the risk of loss for the property immediately after the sale. (Matter #26-600394).

Laura H. G. O'Sullivan, et al., Substitute Trustees



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Aug 25,Sep 1,8, 2026

0012524852

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Calvert County

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Calvert County

GREENSPOON MARDER, LLP
201 International Circle, Suite 230
Hunt Valley, MD 21030

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY
KNOWN AS
11224 Rawhide Road
Lusby, MD 20657

By virtue of a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from RACHEL ET TA HAUTMANN AND JEAN M. SWARTZ, dated April 24, 2020 and recorded in book 5577, page 536 among the Land Records of CALVERT COUNTY, Maryland, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No. C-04-CV-26-000104; Tax ID No. 01-144782) the Substitute Trustee will sell at public auction CALVERT COUNTY courthouse located at 175 MAIN ST, PRINCE FREDERICK, MD 20678 .

AUGUST 27, 2026 at 9:30 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in CALVERT COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$ 23,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK, CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for CALVERT COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at five percent (5%) from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustee. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee is unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 25-000258-04)

NICOLE LIPINSKI, GABRIELLE GIOVINAZZO, ERIN KENNEDY, Substitute Trustee (s)



HARVEY K. CASSEL
AUCTIONEERS, LLC
300 E. Joppa Road
Hampden Plaza - Suite 1103
Baltimore, MD 21286
410-769-9797

Aug 11,18,25, 2026

0012523145

856

Frederick County

856

Frederick County

Aldridge Pite LLP
6001 Executive Blvd., Suite 200
Rockville, MD 20852
301-961-6555

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON

11639 BAUGHER ROAD A/R/T/A
11639 SOUTH BAUGHER ROAD
THURMONT, MD 21788

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated January 31, 2023, recorded in Liber 16321, Folio 474 among the Land Records of Frederick County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$530,219.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Frederick County, at the Court House Door, 100 W. Patrick St., Frederick, MD 21701, on

SEPTEMBER 4, 2026 at 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Frederick County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$52,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 378091-1)

Andrew J. Brenner, et. al., Substitute Trustees



ALEX COOPER
AUCTIONEERS
908 York Road • Towson, MD 21204 • 410.828.4838
www.alexcooper.com

Aug 18,25,Sep 1, 2026

0012524463

De Cubas & Lewis, PA
PO Box 5026
Fort Lauderdale, FL 33310

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY
KNOWN AS
6414 QUINN RD
FREDERICK, MD 21701

By virtue of a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from MELISSA J. MCDANIEL, dated December 22, 2018 and recorded in book 12793 , page 1 among the Land Records of FREDERICK COUNTY, Maryland, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No. C-10-CV-26-000421; Tax ID No. 09-226222) the Substitute Trustee will sell at public auction FREDERICK COUNTY C courthouse located at 100 W. PATRICK ST, FREDERICK, MD 21701 .

SEPTEMBER 9, 2026 at 9:45 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in FREDERICK COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$ 44,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK, CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for FREDERICK COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at 7.1090 % from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustee. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee is unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 25-05689)

THOMAS GARTNER, JUSTIN HOY, Substitute Trustee (s)



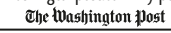
HARVEY K. CASSEL
AUCTIONEERS, LLC
300 E. Joppa Road
Hampden Plaza - Suite 1103
Baltimore, MD 21286
410-769-9797

Aug 25,Sep 1,8, 2026

0012524228

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Aldridge Pite LLP
6001 Executive Blvd., Suite 200
Rockville, MD 20852
301-961-6555

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON

5060 OLD BARTHOLOWS ROAD
MOUNT AIRY, MD 21771

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated February 23, 2008, recorded in Liber 7187, Folio 193 among the Land Records of Frederick County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$300,744.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Frederick County, at the Court House Door, 100 W. Patrick St., Frederick, MD 21701, on

SEPTEMBER 11, 2026 at 12:25 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Frederick County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$49,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 315673-3)

Andrew J. Brenner, et al, Substitute Trustees



ALEX COOPER
AUCTIONEERS
908 York Road • Towson, MD 21204 • 410.828.4838
www.alexcooper.com

Aug 25,Sep 1,8, 2026

0012524835

Robertson, Anschutz, Schneid & Crane, LLC
11350 McCormick Road, EP 1, Suite 302
Hunt Valley, MD 21031
470-321-7112

TRUSTEES' SALE OF VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY
KNOWN AS
6778 WOOD DUCK COURT
FREDERICK, MD 21703

Under a power of sale contained in that Deed of Trust dated May 7, 2014, and recorded in Liber 10067, folio 241, of the land records of FREDERICK COUNTY , with an original principal balance of \$205,155.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the appointed Substitute Trustees will offer for sale at public auction at THE FREDERICK COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 100 W. PATRICK ST, FREDERICK, MD 21701 ON,

SEPTEMBER 9, 2026 at 1:15 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND together with any buildings or improvements thereon situated in FREDERICK COUNTY, MD, located at the above address and more fully described in the aforementioned Deed of Trust.

TAX ID# - 01-019368

The property and improvements will be sold in an "AS IS" physical condition without warranty of any kind and subject to all conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, including any condominium or homeowners association assessments pursuant to MD Real Property Article AS 11-110 and AS 11B-117 .

TERMS OF SALE:A non-refundable bidder's deposit of \$19,500.00 by cashier's/certified check or such other form as the Substitute Trustee may determine, in their sole discretion, required at time of sale except for the party secured by the Deed of Trust. Risk of loss on purchaser from date and time of auction. The balance of the purchase price together with interest thereon at 5.0% per annum from date of sale to receipt of purchase price by Substitute Trustees must be paid by cashier's check within 10 days after final ratification of sale. The noteholder shall not be obligated to pay interest if it is the purchaser. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event that additional funds are tendered before settlement or if settlement is delayed for any reason. All real estate taxes and other public charges and/or assessments to be adjusted as of the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. If applicable, any condominium and/or homeowners association dues and assessments that may become due after the date of sale shall be purchaser's responsibility. Purchaser shall pay all transfer, documentary and recording taxes/fees and all other settlement costs. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining possession of the property. Time is of the essence for the purchaser. If purchaser defaults, deposit will be forfeited and property resold at the risk and cost of the defaulting purchaser who shall be liable for any deficiency in the purchase price and all costs, expenses and attorney's fees of both sales. If Substitute Trustees do not convey title for any reason, purchaser's sole remedy is return of deposit without interest. This sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan secured by the Deed of Trust including but not limited to determining whether prior to sale a bankruptcy was filed; forbearance, repayment or other agreement was entered into; or loan was reinstated or paid off. In any such event this sale shall be null and void and purchaser's sole remedy shall be return of deposit without interest. File No. (24-199554)

KEITH YACKO, DAVID WILLIAMSON, Substitute Trustees



HARVEY K. CASSEL
AUCTIONEERS, LLC
300 E. Joppa Road
Hampden Plaza - Suite 1103
Baltimore, MD 21286
410-769-9797

Aug 25,Sep 1,8, 2026

0012524172

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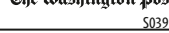
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TUESDAY, AUGUST 25, 2026

EZ

856 Frederick County	856 Frederick County
McCabe, Weisberg & Conway, LLC 312 Marshall Avenue, Suite 800 Laurel, MD 20707 www.mwc-law.com	
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY	
9120 JOHN SIMMONS STREET FREDERICK, MD 21704	

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust from Eliseo Eslabon, Jr., Walden G. Gajo and Girlie Eslabon, dated June 23, 2005 and recorded in Liber 5399, folio 123 among the Land Records of Frederick County, MD, default having occurred under the terms thereof and at the request of the parties secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustees will offer for sale at public auction at the Circuit Court for Frederick County, at the Court House Door, 100 W. Patrick St., Frederick, MD 21701, on

SEPTEMBER 11, 2026 AT 12:35 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND AND THE IMPROVEMENTS THEREON situated in Frederick County, Maryland and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust. The property is improved by a dwelling.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, encumbrances and agreements of record affecting the subject property, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit in the form of cashier's or certified check, or in such other form as the Substitute Trustees may determine, at their sole discretion, for \$79,000 at the time of sale. If the noteholder and/or servicer is the successful bidder, the deposit requirement is waived. Balance of the purchase price is to be paid within ten (10) days of the final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court for Frederick County, Maryland. Interest is to be paid on the unpaid purchase price at the rate of 5% per annum from date of sale to the date the funds are received in the office of the Substitute Trustees, if the property is purchased by an entity other than the noteholder and/or servicer. If payment of the balance does not occur within ten (10) days of ratification, the deposit will be forfeited as liquidated damages. The purchaser agrees that the property may be resold pursuant to an order of court, waives personal service upon themselves and/or any principal or corporate designee of any documents filed regarding the failure to pay the purchase price within ten (10) days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail of said documents at the address provided by the purchaser in the Memorandum of Sale. This transaction may be subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE Rule") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, effective March 1, 2026. Purchaser will be responsible for obtaining the information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule and for providing the necessary information to the Reporting Person, as defined in the RRE Rule, within ten (10) days following Ratification of the Sale or Purchaser's deposit will be forfeited and property resold. The purchaser will not be entitled to any surplus or profits arising from the resale even if they are the result of improvements made by the purchaser. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event settlement is delayed for any reason. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, and all other public charges and assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, and front foot benefit charges, if applicable, to be adjusted for the current year to the date of sale, and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Cost of all documentary stamps, transfer taxes (including agricultural transfer taxes, if applicable), and all settlement charges shall be borne by the purchaser. The sale is subject to a post sale audit of the loan, including but not limited to an analysis of whether the borrower entered into a loan modification agreement, filed bankruptcy, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. The Substitute Trustees will convey either insurable or marketable title. If the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey insurable or marketable title or, the post sale audit concludes that the sale should not have occurred, or the sale is not ratified by the court for any reason, the purchaser's sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to the refund of the deposit without interest even if the purchaser has made improvements to the property. Upon refund of the deposit, the sale shall be void and of no effect, and the purchaser shall have no further claim against the Substitute Trustees. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. The purchaser at the foreclosure sale shall assume the risk of loss for the property immediately after the sale. (Matter #2012-19403).

The property will be sold subject to a 120 day right of redemption by the Internal Revenue Service.

Laura H. G. O'Sullivan, et al., Substitute Trustees	
	
908 York Road • Towson, MD 21204 • 410.828.4838 www.alexcooper.com	
Aug 25, Sep 1, 8, 2026	0012524462
Robertson, Anschutz, Schneid & Crane, LLC 11350 McCormick Road, EP 1, Suite 302 Hunt Valley, MD 21031 410-321-7112	
TRUSTEES' SALE OF VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY KNOWN AS 13 HOOPE ROAD ST. MOUNT AIRY, MD 21771	

Under a power of sale contained in that Deed of Trust dated June 6, 2005, and recorded in Liber 5371, folio 307, of the land records of FREDERICK COUNTY, with an original principal balance of \$220,000.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the appointed Substitute Trustees will offer for sale at public auction at THE FREDERICK COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 100 W. PATRICK ST, FREDERICK, MD 21701 ON,

SEPTEMBER 9, 2026 at 1:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND together with any buildings or improvements thereon situated in FREDERICK COUNTY, MD, located at the above address and more fully described in the aforementioned Deed of Trust.

TAX ID# - 18-380269

The property and improvements will be sold in an "AS IS", physical condition without warranty of any kind and subject to all conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, including any condominium or homeowners association assessments pursuant to MD Real Property Article A§ 11-110 and A§ 11B-117.

TERMS OF SALE: A non-refundable bidder's deposit of \$27,500.00 by cashier's/certified check or such other form as the Substitute Trustee may determine, in their sole discretion, required at time of sale except for the party secured by the Deed of Trust. Risk of loss on purchaser from date and time of auction. The balance of the purchase price together with interest thereon 16.0% per annum from date of sale to receipt of purchase price by Substitute Trustees must be paid by cashier's check within 10 days after final ratification of sale. The noteholder shall not be obligated to pay interest if it is the purchaser. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event that additional funds are tendered before settlement or if settlement is delayed for any reason. All real estate taxes and other public charges and/or assessments to be adjusted as of the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. If applicable, any condominium and/or homeowners association dues and assessments that may become due after the date of sale shall be purchaser's responsibility. Purchaser shall pay all transfer, documentary and recording taxes/fees and all other settlement costs. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining possession of the property. Time is of the essence for the purchaser. If purchaser defaults, deposit will be forfeited and property resold at the risk and cost of the defaulting purchaser who shall be liable for any deficiency in the purchase price and all costs, expenses and attorney's fees of both sales. If Substitute Trustees do not convey title for any reason, purchaser's sole remedy is return of deposit without interest. This sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan secured by the Deed of Trust including but not limited to determining whether prior to sale a bankruptcy was filed; forbearance, repayment or other agreement was entered into; or loan was reinstated or paid off. In any such event this sale shall be null and void and purchaser's sole remedy shall be return of deposit without interest. File No. (26-398306ADC)

KEITH YACKO, DAVID WILLIAMSON, Substitute Trustees

Potential Bidders: For sale information, please visit
www.Auction.com or call (800) 280-2832.

	
Aug 25, Sep 1, 8, 2026	0012523054

856 Frederick County	856 Frederick County
Brock and Scott, PLLC 5431 Oleander Drive Wilmington NC, 28403	
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY KNOWN AS 2401 Graystone Ln Frederick, MD 21702	

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust to THOMAS P. DORE, Trustee(s), dated May 10, 2021, and recorded among the Land Records of FREDERICK COUNTY, MARYLAND in Liber 14977, folio 364, the holder of the indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed the undersigned Substitute Trustees, by instrument duly recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at THE FREDERICK COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 100 W. PATRICK ST, FREDERICK, MD 21701 ON,

SEPTEMBER 9, 2026 at 9:30 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in FREDERICK COUNTY, MD and more fully described in the above-referenced Deed of Trust Tax ID# - 02-187329.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record affecting same including any condominium and of HOA assessments pursuant to Md Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$30,000.00 payable in certified check or by a cashier's check will be required from purchaser at time of sale, balance in immediately available funds upon final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court of FREDERICK COUNTY, MARYLAND interest to be paid at the rate of 2.875% on unpaid purchase money from date of sale to date of settlement. The secured party herein, if a bidder, shall not be required to post a deposit. Third party purchaser (excluding the secured party) will be required to complete full settlement of the purchase of the property within TEN (10) CALENDAR DAYS of the ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court otherwise the purchaser's deposit shall be forfeited and the property will be resold at the risk and expense, of the defaulting purchaser. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser.

Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public/private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent, and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes hall be paid by purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale.

Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. If the sale is rescinded or not ratified for any reason, including post sale lender audit, or a resale is to take place for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to the refund of the aforementioned deposit. The Substitute Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if the ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the purchasers sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of their deposit, without interest.

The purchaser waives all rights and claims against the Substitute Trustees whether known or unknown. These provisions shall survive settlement Upon refund of the deposit, this sale shall be void and of no effect, and the purchaser shall have no further claim against the Substitute Trustees. The sale is subject to post-sale review of the status of the loan and that if any agreement to cancel the sale was entered into by the lender and borrower prior to the sale then the sale is void and the purchaser's deposit shall be refunded without interest. Additional terms and conditions, if applicable, may be announced at the time and date of sale.

If this transaction is subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing. File No. (26-13108)

BRENNAN FERGUSON, JOHN C. HANRAHAN, JEREMY B. WILKINS, AMANDA DRISCOLE, ROBERT OLIVERI, PAUL HEINMULLER, Substitute Trustees	
	
Aug 25, Sep 1, 8, 2026	0012524407

Under a power of sale contained in that Deed of Trust dated June 6, 2005, and recorded in Liber 5371, folio 307, of the land records of FREDERICK COUNTY, with an original principal balance of \$220,000.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the appointed Substitute Trustees will offer for sale at public auction at THE FREDERICK COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 100 W. PATRICK ST, FREDERICK, MD 21701 ON,

SEPTEMBER 9, 2026 at 1:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND together with any buildings or improvements thereon situated in FREDERICK COUNTY, MD, located at the above address and more fully described in the aforementioned Deed of Trust.

TAX ID# - 18-380269

The property and improvements will be sold in an "AS IS", physical condition without warranty of any kind and subject to all conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, including any condominium or homeowners association assessments pursuant to MD Real Property Article A§ 11-110 and A§ 11B-117.

TERMS OF SALE: A non-refundable bidder's deposit of \$27,500.00 by cashier's/certified check or such other form as the Substitute Trustee may determine, in their sole discretion, required at time of sale except for the party secured by the Deed of Trust. Risk of loss on purchaser from date and time of auction. The balance of the purchase price together with interest thereon 16.0% per annum from date of sale to receipt of purchase price by Substitute Trustees must be paid by cashier's check within 10 days after final ratification of sale. The noteholder shall not be obligated to pay interest if it is the purchaser. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event that additional funds are tendered before settlement or if settlement is delayed for any reason. All real estate taxes and other public charges and/or assessments to be adjusted as of the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. If applicable, any condominium and/or homeowners association dues and assessments that may become due after the date of sale shall be purchaser's responsibility. Purchaser shall pay all transfer, documentary and recording taxes/fees and all other settlement costs. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining possession of the property. Time is of the essence for the purchaser. If purchaser defaults, deposit will be forfeited and property resold at the risk and cost of the defaulting purchaser who shall be liable for any deficiency in the purchase price and all costs, expenses and attorney's fees of both sales. If Substitute Trustees do not convey title for any reason, purchaser's sole remedy is return of deposit without interest. This sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan secured by the Deed of Trust including but not limited to determining whether prior to sale a bankruptcy was filed; forbearance, repayment or other agreement was entered into; or loan was reinstated or paid off. In any such event this sale shall be null and void and purchaser's sole remedy shall be return of deposit without interest. File No. (26-398306ADC)

KEITH YACKO, DAVID WILLIAMSON, Substitute Trustees

Potential Bidders: For sale information, please visit
www.Auction.com or call (800) 280-2832.

	
Aug 25, Sep 1, 8, 2026	0012523054

The Washington Post

856 Frederick County	856 Frederick County
Offit Kurman, Attorneys at Law 7501 Wisconsin Avenue, Suite 1000W Bethesda, Maryland 20814 202-900-8995	
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE NON-OWNER OCCUPIED RESIDENTIAL PROPERTY	
10651 WOLFVILLE ROAD MYERSVILLE, MD 21773	

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in that certain Purchase Money Deed of Trust from Velasquez Properties, LLC to Russell S. Drazin, in trust (the "Trustee"), for the benefit of WCP Fund I LLC dated March 28, 2025, and recorded on April 11, 2025 in Book 17295, Page 418, among the Land Records of Frederick County, Maryland (the "Land Records") and subsequently assigned to iSharpe Income Solutions Trust ("Beneficiary") by Assignment of Deed of Trust dated April 1, 2025 and recorded February 2, 2026 among the Land Records in Book 17704, Page 114 and securing that certain Commercial Deed of Trust Note dated March 28, 2025 made by Velasquez Properties, LLC, as assigned to Beneficiary by that certain Allonge dated March 31, 2025 (collectively, the "Deed of Trust"). The Beneficiary having appointed Frances C. Wilburn, Esq., Jung Kim, Esq. and Leah C. Freedman, Esq., as Substitute Trustees by that certain Deed of Appointment of Substitute Trustees, dated April 28, 2026, recorded among the Land Records on May 13, 2026 in Book 17859, Page 12, default having occurred under the terms thereof and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustees, will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Frederick County, Maryland, at the Court House Door, 100 W. Patrick St., Frederick, MD 21701, on

SEPTEMBER 11, 2026 at 12:30 P.M.

Beginning for the same at a point, said point being the beginning point of a conveyance to Belya E. Summers as recorded in Liber 439, at Folio 304; thence running (1) North 56 degrees 00'00" East, 197.01 feet to a point, thence (2) North 79 degrees 29'44" East, 54.96 feet to a point, thence (3) South 32 degrees 00'00" East, 346.50 feet to a point, thence (4) South 59 degrees 30'00" West, 99.00 feet to a point, thence (5) South 37 degrees 30'00" West, 122.76 feet to a point, thence (6) North 36 degrees 52'01" West, 401.61 feet to a point of beginning, containing 1.98 acres of land, more or less.

Property Address: 10651 Wolfsville Road, Myersville, MD 21773

Parcel ID: 16-358673

TERMS OF SALE: The Property will be sold in "AS IS, WHERE IS" condition, without recourse. Neither the Substitute Trustees, the noteholder secured by the Deed of Trust, the Auctioneer, nor any of their respective agents, successors or assigns (collectively, the "Selling Parties") make any representations or warranties, express or implied, with respect to the Property, or any tenancies or parties in possession, including, without limitation, the description, use, size, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, habitability, subdivision, zoning, environmental condition, compliance with building codes or other laws (such as Americans with Disabilities Act), ordinances or regulations, fitness for a particular purpose, or merchantability of all or any part of the Property. The purchaser waives and releases the Selling Parties from any and all claims the purchaser and/or the purchaser's successors and assigns may now have or may have in the future relating to the condition of the Property, including but not limited to the environmental condition thereof. The purchaser shall assume all risk of loss or damage to the Property after the time of the foreclosure sale. The Property will be sold subject to all tenancies, parties in possession, conditions, regulations, orders, ordinances and laws, as well as restrictions, judgments, liens, assessments, outstanding taxes and all other charges, utility charges, matters, and agreements of record affecting same, if any, which the successful bidder(s), in addition to paying the bid price, will be required to pay and/or otherwise satisfy. The Property will be sold subject to any building or housing violations, easements, agreements, restrictions, terms, rights of way, filed and unfiled mechanics' and materialmen's liens, covenants, conditions, rights of redemption, and all other encumbrances having priority over the Deed of Trust, if any, lawfully affecting the Property whether or not of record, including but not limited to environmental conditions (including without limitation possible wetlands, riparian rights, critical or protected areas, and the presence of protected or endangered species) and all applicable federal, state and local laws, ordinances and regulations lawfully affecting the Property. All interested bidders are encouraged to contact the appropriate governmental authorities prior to the sale date regarding the permitted uses of the Property and the requirements, if any, for construction, completion and/or development.

The Substitute Trustees shall be entitled to remove the Property from sale prior to bidding, and reject any and all bids. A deposit of \$20,000.00 in the form of certified check or cashier's check shall be paid to the Substitute Trustees at the time and place of sale. The deposit must be increased to 10% of the winning bid amount and delivered to the Substitute Trustees within one (1) business day after the date of the auction in the same form of funds as the initial deposit. Failure to timely tender the deposit or increased deposit shall constitute a material default by the purchaser. Whenever the purchaser is also the noteholder secured by the Deed of Trust, payment of the required deposit(s) and the purchase price is made by crediting the amount thereof to the indebtedness. The balance of the purchase price shall be paid in cash or certified check at settlement, which shall be no later than fifteen (15) days after final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court for Frederick County, Maryland, unless said period is extended by the Substitute Trustees, their successors or assigns, in Substitute Trustees' sole and absolute discretion, with no obligation to extend, time otherwise being of the essence; otherwise, in addition to other remedies available to the Substitute Trustees, whether at law or in equity, the Substitute Trustees may, at their election, declare the deposit forfeited and resell the Property at the risk and cost of the defaulting purchaser. The defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds or profits resulting from any resale of the Property. The purchaser hereby agrees that in the event of any litigation between any of the Selling Parties and the purchaser related to the Property, the purchaser shall immediately pay on demand the reasonable attorney's fees and costs incurred by the Selling Parties in such action. Interest at the rate equal to the rate at which interest is currently accruing on the Note, shall be paid on the unpaid purchase price from the date of sale to the date of closing. All outstanding real property taxes, and water rent on an annual basis, including any sanitary and/or county or metropolitan district charges and any other municipal charges, utility charges, whether incurred prior to or after the sale shall be assumed and paid by purchaser. Cost of all documentary stamps, transfer taxes, recordation taxes, (including any agricultural transfer tax), recording fees, document preparation, title insurance and any and all other costs or charges of settlement shall be borne solely by the purchaser. The purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining possession from anyone in possession of the Property. Conveyance of the Property shall be by Substitute Trustees' Deed, without covenant or warranty, express or implied, unless otherwise required by statute, court rule or the Deed of Trust. In the event the Substitute Trustees are unable for any reason to convey title, the purchaser's sole remedy at law or in equity shall be to request and to receive a return of the deposit. Upon a return of the deposit, this sale shall be void and of no effect and the purchaser shall have no further claim against the Selling Parties.

This advertisement, as amended or supplemented by any oral announcements during the conduct of the sale, constitutes the Substitute Trustees' entire terms upon which such premises shall be offered for sale.

All information herein contained is believed to be accurate but is not guaranteed.

Frances C. Wilburn, Esq., Jung Kim, Esq., Leah C. Freedman, Esq. Substitute Trustees	
	
Aug 25, Sep 1, 8, 2026	0012524289

	
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856 Frederick County	856 Frederick County
Brock and Scott, PLLC 5431 Oleander Drive Wilmington NC, 28403	
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY KNOWN AS 6214 Posey Street Frederick, MD 21703	

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust to JAMES M. SACK, Trustee(s), dated May 10, 2018, and recorded among the Land Records of FREDERICK COUNTY, MARYLAND in Liber 12417, folio 238, MODIFIED ON JUNE 5, 2020 IN LIBER 13876 FOLIO 233; the holder of the indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed the undersigned Substitute Trustees, by instrument duly recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at THE FREDERICK COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 100 W. PATRICK ST, FREDERICK, MD 21701 ON,

SEPTEMBER 9, 2026 at 9:30 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in FREDERICK COUNTY, MD and more fully described in the above-referenced Deed of Trust Tax ID# - 23-59412.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record affecting same including any condominium and of HOA assessments pursuant to Md Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$42,500.00 payable in certified check or by a cashier's check will be required from purchaser at time of sale, balance in immediately available funds upon final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court of FREDERICK COUNTY, MARYLAND interest to be paid at the rate of 7.25 % on unpaid purchase money from date of sale to date of settlement. The secured party herein, if a bidder, shall not be required to post a deposit. Third party purchaser (excluding the secured party) will be required to complete full settlement of the purchase of the property within TEN (10) CALENDAR DAYS of the ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court otherwise the purchaser's deposit shall be forfeited and the property will be resold at the risk and expense, of the defaulting purchaser. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser.

Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public/private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent, and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes hall be paid by purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale.

Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. If the sale is rescinded or not ratified for any reason, including post sale lender audit, or a resale is to take place for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to the refund of the aforementioned deposit. The Substitute Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if the ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the purchasers sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of their deposit, without interest.

The purchaser waives all rights and claims against the Substitute Trustees whether known or unknown. These provisions shall survive settlement Upon refund of the deposit, this sale shall be void and of no effect, and the purchaser shall have no further claim against the Substitute Trustees. The sale is subject to post-sale review of the status of the loan and that if any agreement to cancel the sale was entered into by the lender and borrower prior to the sale then the sale is void and the purchaser's deposit shall be refunded without interest. Additional terms and conditions, if applicable, may be announced at the time and date of sale.

If this transaction is subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing. File No. (23-30910)

BRENNAN FERGUSON, JOHN C. HANRAHAN, JEREMY B. WILKINS, AMANDA DRISCOLE, ROBERT OLIVERI, AND PAUL HEINMULLER, Substitute Trustees	
	
Aug 25, Sep 1, 8, 2026	0012524016

Under a power of sale contained in that Deed of Trust dated June 6, 2005, and recorded in Liber 5371, folio 307, of the land records of FREDERICK COUNTY, with an original principal balance of \$220,000.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the appointed Substitute Trustees will offer for sale at public auction at THE FREDERICK COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 100 W. PATRICK ST, FREDERICK, MD 21701 ON,

SEPTEMBER 9, 2026 at 1:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND together with any buildings or improvements thereon situated in FREDERICK COUNTY, MD, located at the above address and more fully described in the aforementioned Deed of Trust.

TAX ID# - 18-380269

The property and improvements will be sold in an "AS IS", physical condition without warranty of any kind and subject to all conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, including any condominium or homeowners association assessments pursuant to MD Real Property Article A§ 11-110 and A§ 11B-117.

TERMS OF SALE: A non-refundable bidder's deposit of \$27,500.00 by cashier's/certified check or such other form as the Substitute Trustee may determine, in their sole discretion, required at time of sale except for the party secured by the Deed of Trust. Risk of loss on purchaser from date and time of auction. The balance of the purchase price together with interest thereon 16.0% per annum from date of sale to receipt of purchase price by Substitute Trustees must be paid by cashier's check within 10 days after final ratification of sale. The noteholder shall not be obligated to pay interest if it is the purchaser. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event that additional funds are tendered before settlement or if settlement is delayed for any reason. All real estate taxes and other public charges and/or assessments to be adjusted as of the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. If applicable, any condominium and/or homeowners association dues and assessments that may become due after the date of sale shall be purchaser's responsibility. Purchaser shall pay all transfer, documentary and recording taxes/fees and all other settlement costs. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining possession of the property. Time is of the essence for the purchaser. If purchaser defaults, deposit will be forfeited and property resold at the risk and cost of the defaulting purchaser who shall be liable for any deficiency in the purchase price and all costs, expenses and attorney's fees of both sales. If Substitute Trustees do not convey title for any reason, purchaser's sole remedy is return of deposit without interest. This sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan secured by the Deed of Trust including but not limited to determining whether prior to sale a bankruptcy was filed; forbearance, repayment or other agreement was entered into; or loan was reinstated or paid off. In any such event this sale shall be null and void and purchaser's sole remedy shall be return of deposit without interest. File No. (26-398306ADC)

KEITH YACKO, DAVID WILLIAMSON, Substitute Trustees

Potential Bidders: For sale information, please visit
www.Auction.com or call (800) 280-2832.

	
Aug 25, Sep 1, 8, 2026	0012523054

CLASSIFIED **B19**

857 Howard County	857 Howard County
Brock and Scott, PLLC 5431 Oleander Drive Wilmington NC, 28403	
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY KNOWN AS 5720 Goldfinch Ct Ellicott City, MD 21043	

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust to ROSENBERG AND ASSOCIATES LLC, Trustee(s), dated September 7, 2022, and recorded among the Land Records of HOWARD COUNTY, MARYLAND in Liber 21741, folio 7, the holder of the indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed the undersigned Substitute Trustees, by instrument duly recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at THE HOWARD COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 9250 JUDICIAL WAY, ELLICOTT CITY, MD 21043 ON,

SEPTEMBER 9, 2026 at 12:30 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in HOWARD COUNTY, MD and more fully described in the above-referenced Deed of Trust Tax ID# - 01-273930.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record affecting same including any condominium and of HOA assessments pursuant to Md Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$36,000

THE WEATHER

WASHINGTONPOST.COM/WEATHER

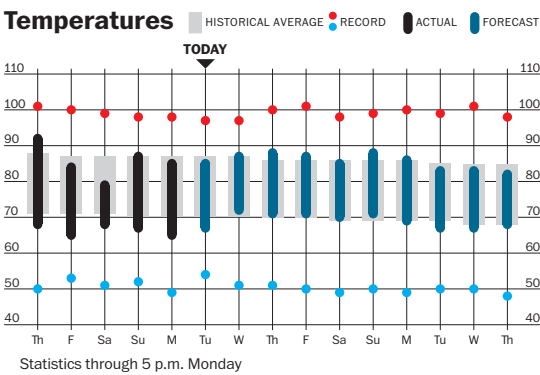
Nary a cloud in sight

Expect a warm, pleasant day, with nothing but sunshine heading your way. A high temperature in the mid-80s will be offset by a light northwesterly breeze. There's likely to be some cloud cover in the evening, when temperatures will drop into the 60s. Throughout the day and night, the chance of rainfall is almost zero.

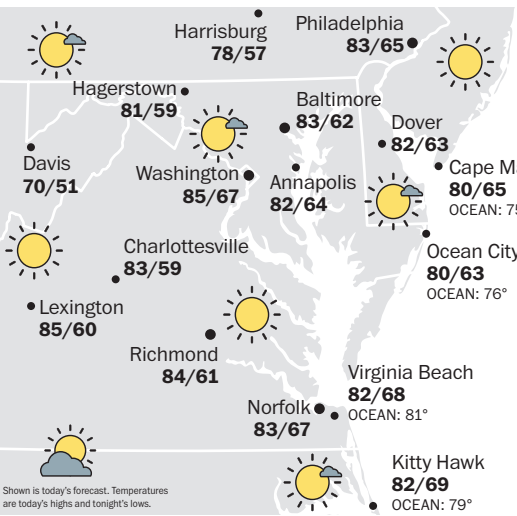
AccuWeather FORECAST

Today	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
Sunny	Partly sunny	Heavy t-storms	T-storm	Mostly sunny	Partly sunny
					
85° 67°	87° 72°	88° 71°	87° 71°	85° 70°	88° 71°
REALFEEL®: 87°	REALFEEL®: 90°	REALFEEL®: 92°	REALFEEL®: 92°	REALFEEL®: 93°	REALFEEL®: 97°
CHANCE PRECIP: 0%	CHANCE PRECIP: 25%	CHANCE PRECIP: 90%	CHANCE PRECIP: 55%	CHANCE PRECIP: 25%	CHANCE PRECIP: 25%
WIND: NW 6-12 mph	WIND: S 6-12 mph	WIND: S 6-12 mph	WIND: NNW 4-8 mph	WIND: NE 4-8 mph	WIND: SE 4-8 mph
HUMIDITY: Low	HUMIDITY: Moderate	HUMIDITY: High	HUMIDITY: High	HUMIDITY: Moderate	HUMIDITY: High

OFFICIAL RECORD



REGION TODAY



Blue Ridge: Shenandoah National Park: Today, mostly sunny. High 79. Winds north-northwest 4-8 mph. Tonight, a moonlit sky. Low 58. Winds light and variable. • **Great Smoky Mtns. National Park:** Today, partly sunny. High 71. Winds west-northwest 4-8 mph. Tonight, a moonlit sky. Low 61. Winds south 6-12 mph.

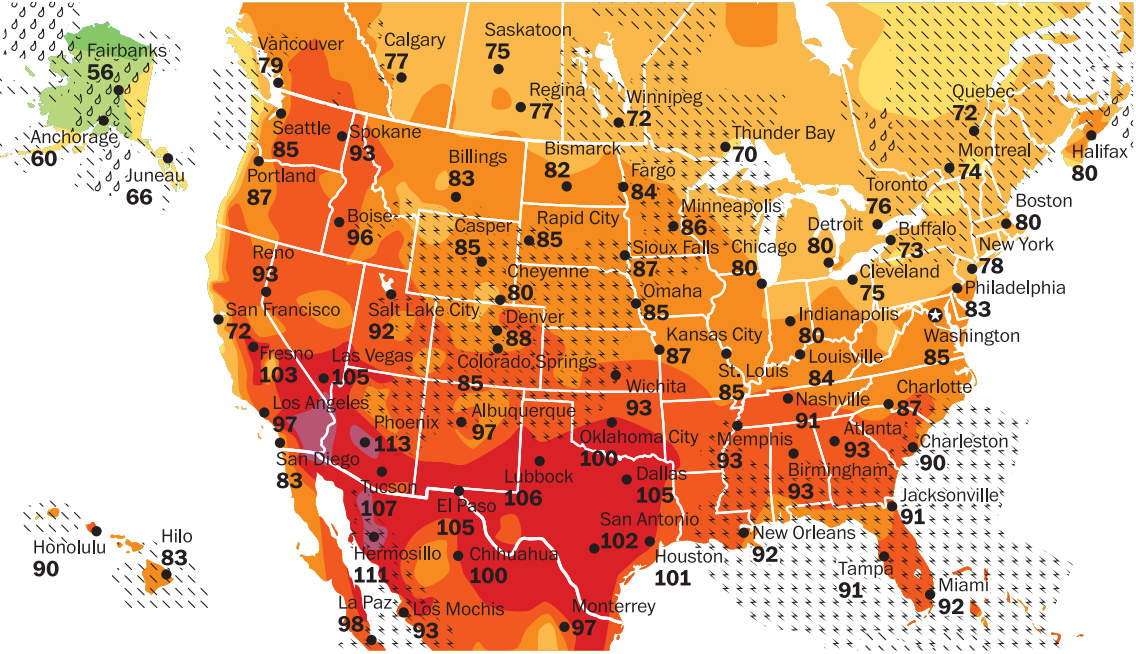
Atlantic beaches: Ocean City, MD: Today, plenty of sun. High 80. Winds west 6-12 mph. Tonight, clear. Low 63. Winds west 4-8 mph. • **Virginia Beach:** Today, mostly sunny. High 82. Winds north 7-14 mph. Tonight, a moonlit sky. Low 68. Winds west 4-8 mph.

Waterways: Upper Potomac River: Today, sunny. Wind northwest 4-8 knots. Waves less than a foot. Visibility clear to the horizon. • **Lower Potomac and Chesapeake Bay:** Today, mostly sunny. Wind northwest 6-12 knots. Waves 1-2 feet on the Lower Potomac; 1-3 feet on the Chesapeake Bay. • **River Stages:** The stage at Little Falls will be around 3.20 feet today, falling to 3.00 Wednesday. Flood stage at Little Falls is 10 feet.

Today's tides

	Washington	Annapolis	Ocean City	Norfolk	Point Lookout
High tide	1:05 a.m.	6:55 a.m.	1:56 p.m.	7:28 p.m.	
Low tide	4:07 a.m.	10:50 a.m.	3:54 p.m.	9:54 p.m.	
High tide	12:27 a.m.	6:07 a.m.	12:10 p.m.	6:40 p.m.	
Low tide	2:21 a.m.	8:22 a.m.	2:15 p.m.	8:41 p.m.	
High tide	12:09 a.m.	7:05 a.m.	12:12 p.m.	5:55 p.m.	

NATION TODAY



NATIONAL	Today	Tomorrow	Des Moines	84/68/pc	84/62/pc	Oklahoma City	100/75/pc	96/73/pc	WORLD	Today	Tomorrow
Albany, NY	75/58/t	80/63/pc	Detroit	80/60/pc	81/64/t	Omaha	85/67/t	85/59/pc	Addis Ababa	71/55/t	72/54/r
Albuquerque	97/70/t	97/66/t	El Paso	105/76/s	104/77/s	Orlando	93/76/t	91/76/t	Amsterdam	76/58/pc	76/64/t
Anchorage	60/49/r	62/48/s	Fairbanks, AK	56/46/r	57/39/sh	Philadelphia	83/65/s	85/71/s	Athens	96/73/s	94/78/s
Atlanta	93/70/t	90/72/t	Fargo, ND	84/62/pc	83/51/pc	Phoenix	113/90/s	115/91/c	Auckland	62/48/pc	64/51/sh
Austin	104/75/s	104/75/s	Hartford, CT	78/57/s	82/62/s	Pittsburgh	76/59/pc	79/62/c	Baghdad	117/91/pc	118/91/s
Baltimore	83/62/s	85/70/pc	Honolulu	90/77/sh	88/75/pc	Portland, ME	76/57/t	79/61/pc	Bangkok	94/81/r	93/82/r
Billings, MT	83/58/pc	88/62/t	Houston	101/79/pc	100/79/pc	Portland, OR	87/58/s	78/59/pc	Beijing	89/73/t	79/68/c
Bismarck, ND	82/55/s	84/49/s	Indianapolis	80/59/s	83/65/t	Providence, RI	79/60/s	80/63/s	Berlin	75/55/s	76/57/c
Boise	96/68/s	97/68/pc	Jackson, MS	93/73/t	95/75/t	Raleigh, NC	86/65/s	89/72/t	Bogota	67/50/r	67/49/r
Boston	80/64/s	80/65/s	Kansas City, MO	87/73/s	88/63/pc	Reno, NV	93/63/pc	94/61/c	Brussels	74/56/c	80/63/pc
Buffalo	73/60/s	79/64/pc	Las Vegas	105/87/s	110/87/pc	Richmond	84/61/pc	88/69/s	Buenos Aires	57/52/pc	63/56/pc
Burlington, VT	73/60/t	80/62/pc	Little Rock	97/76/s	95/73/t	Sacramento	95/62/s	98/63/s	Cairo	99/77/pc	100/77/s
Charleston, SC	90/73/t	87/74/t	Los Angeles	97/73/s	99/74/s	St. Louis	85/70/pc	92/68/t	Caracas	78/68/r	77/66/r
Charlotte, WV	81/56/pc	85/63/pc	Louisville	84/63/pc	88/67/pc	St. Thomas, VI	93/82/t	93/81/s	Copenhagen	71/56/s	70/56/s
Cheyenne, WY	80/55/t	77/56/t	Memphis	93/76/t	92/75/t	Salt Lake City	92/70/s	96/70/t	Dakar	90/79/t	88/81/r
Chicago	80/66/pc	83/65/t	Miami	92/80/t	92/75/t	San Diego	87/72/s	84/73/s	Dublin	66/59/c	68/57/sh
Cincinnati	80/58/pc	85/64/pc	Milwaukee	79/66/s	84/65/t	San Francisco	72/58/pc	75/60/t	Edinburgh	65/54/c	69/58/pc
Cleveland	75/59/s	82/63/pc	Minneapolis	86/66/c	81/64/s	San Juan, PR	92/80/r	91/80/t	Frankfurt	71/59/r	78/63/pc
Dallas	105/83/pc	101/80/t	Nashville	91/66/pc	90/72/t	Seattle	85/56/pc	76/58/pc	Geneva	81/61/pc	85/62/pc
Denver	88/59/t	86/59/t	New Orleans	92/78/t	92/78/t	Spokane, WA	89/63/pc	93/61/s	Ham., Bermuda	87/79/s	86/80/t
			New York City	78/64/s	80/70/s	Syracuse	73/59/sh	81/66/pc	Helsinki	66/51/pc	70/50/pc
			Norfolk	83/67/s	88/73/pc	Tampa	91/77/t	91/78/t	Ho Chi Minh City	92/79/r	92/80/r
						Wichita	93/72/t	93/70/pc	Hong Kong	91/82/t	89/82/t



Feel the Difference. See the Savings.

New windows can help improve comfort, reduce drafts, and increase energy efficiency—helping you save on utility costs.



50% OFF ALL WINDOW STYLES

Offer valid until 8/31/26



WINDOW NATION

START YOUR PROJECT WITH CONFIDENCE!

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Small town enthralled by wild neighbor

BISON FROM B12

mane Law Enforcement team got the call that a bison was loose and creating his own version of a farm tour through the neighborhood.

One resident posted that his daughter called him and said, "Dad, there's a million cops outside and a Bison!"

Stively first learned of the escape when she arrived at her office just after 9 a.m. One of her employees called her over to his desk.

"What you got?" she asked. "We have a bison," the staffer said.

"Where? What's it doing?" Stively asked.

"Just walking around," he said. It wasn't a typical call. Her department mostly deals with cats and dogs and "things that can go in a small carrier," Stively said, "not something that needs a double-wide trailer to be transported."

No one on her staff was immediately sure who the beast belonged to. The county maintains a database linking livestock to

their owners, but the escaped bison and his human weren't listed. Stively said area residents told dispatchers that the bison "lives at a farm down the road," but weren't sure exactly which one, so one of her staffers went door to door trying to find it.

"He was just out poking around, eating grass. He didn't feel he was anyone's emergency."

Nina Stively, director of Loudoun County Animal Services

Farmers don't need a special permit to raise bison in the county, just enough space. Stively said less than half a dozen farmers in the county raise them. As the bison roamed, the rescuers followed. "They just drove slowly behind him to keep him going in the right direction," Stively said.

"He was just out poking around, eating grass. He didn't feel he was anyone's emergency."

Six hours later, officials found the owner — thanks in part to tips from area residents and other livestock owners — and were able to help guide the bison back to where he had started his day. It had roamed about two miles from home.

The officers escorted the bison down the final stretch of road, Stively said, "and herded him onto his property."

The day's placid end avoided one of their most feared scenarios. The officers did not want to have to use a tranquilizer, Stively said, because the bison would have become agitated and probably would have charged.

Despite their size, the vast animals are remarkably agile and quick. They can run up to about 35 mph. They don't have good vision and feel easily threatened, Stively said. But it all turned out peacefully.

It's "what we do," Stively said. "We try to make sure people and animals live harmoniously together."



The 1,500-pound bison makes his way home to "a farm down the road" with help from local authorities.